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MOVING TO END WEST ASIA CRISIS

US and Iran signal deal near, differ on its terms

Rebuffed Iranian drone attack on Indian ships leaving Hormuz, unacceptable, says US President**Parisa Hafezi, Steve Holland & John Irish**
*Dubai, Washington, Paris, June 12***E. EXPLAINED****Nuclear plan fate, sanctions relief key**

As the US and Iran look to sign a deal to end their military conflict, the stumbling block appears to be the division over the specific terms regarding the dismantling of the Iranian nuclear programme and sanctions relief. There remain gaps between what Washington says Iranians have agreed to do and what Tehran insists it has the right to retain.

Pakistan, which has for weeks sought to broker a deal, said a final text of a peace agreement between the United States and Iran had been reached, although there was no immediate confirmation from Washington or Tehran.

"Pakistan is now working

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

3 ATTACKS IN 4 DAYS NEAR OMAN

India summons top US diplomat second time to protest strikes on ships

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, June 12

FOR THE second time in less than 48 hours, India Friday summoned the US charge d'affaires (CDA) and lodged a "strong protest" over the series of attacks by US naval forces on commercial vessels carrying Indian mariners in the Gulf of Oman.

On Thursday, the government confirmed the death of three Indian seafarers, reported

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



US charge d'affaires Jason Meeks at the MEA, Friday. ANI

THE BIG PICTURE

Khan Sir's rise, his reckoning

PAGE 15



The wife and children of one of the victims at the Air India crash site in Ahmedabad, Friday. BHUPENDRA RANA

At crash site, families and friends sift for memories and a life that once was

Leena Misra, Brendan Dabhi & Parimal A Dabhi
Ahmedabad, June 12

SITA PATNI and Amanda Donaghey sat beside each other at the foot of the burnt shells of the medical college hostel buildings on Friday, grieving for their sons.

Donaghey, a British national, held a collage of her son's photographs that read "Memories of Fiongal", as she accepted

condolences with folded hands. Fiongal Greenlaw-Meek, 39, and his partner Jamie, 45, were returning to London after celebrating their wedding anniversary in India. They were among the 241 who died when Air India's Ahmedabad-Gatwick Boeing 787 Dreamliner crashed shortly after take-off on June 12 last year.

AIR INDIA CRASH
a year later

Sita Patni's 13-year-old son, Aakash, had been sleeping on the pavement next to the family's tea stall when the plane crashed nearby, into the hostel mess of BJ Medical College. Fiery debris from the crash fell on Aakash, who was among the 19 killed on the ground. Patni's arm still bears

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

**NATION**
WAIT FOR ANSWERS CONTINUES AS AAIB SAYS INVESTIGATION STILL UNDERWAY

PAGE 9

Happening today

● **PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA** Modi will begin a high-profile official visit to France. He will also be attending the G7 meeting there next week.TRACK THIS AND MORE ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM**Business as Usual**
By EP UNNY

Stand-up comedy show row: KEM probe finds MBBS student remarks fell short of standards

Has submitted apology, disciplinary action under consideration: Hospital**Purnima Sah & Mohamed Thaver**
Mumbai, June 12

A DAY after Maharashtra Cyber Police registered an FIR against stand-up comedian Pranit More and two audience members, including MBBS student Sejal Pawar, over remarks made during a show, a preliminary inquiry by Mumbai's KEM Hospital found that Pawar's comments were "objectionable and insensitive" and fell short of the standards of

dignity, empathy and professional responsibility expected from a medical student.

KEM Hospital authorities said Pawar had submitted a written apology acknowledging that some of her statements were inappropriate and may have caused distress. Officials said disciplinary action, including temporary suspension, could be considered depending on the inquiry's findings, though transferring a student to another institution is not

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

● MET WITH NEAR-FATAL ACCIDENT IN HIMACHAL MOUNTAINS

Mountains, ministries, military aircraft: Op to save Deadpool cinematographer after paragliding crash

PAGE 1
anchor**Hina Rohtaki**
Chandigarh, June 12

WHEN DOCTORS at PGIMER, Chandigarh, examined a foreign national with severe spinal injuries on June 9, he was registered simply as an "unknown patient".

Few at the hospital knew that the man lying on the stretcher was George Richmond, an acclaimed British

cinematographer whose credits include the Hollywood blockbuster Deadpool and Wolverine. Fewer still knew that just a day before a near-fatal paragliding accident in the high Himalayas, he had been a guest at the Patiala residence of former Punjab chief minister Captain Amarinder Singh.

What began as the rescue of the unidentified foreign tourist injured in a remote mountainous region near Manali soon evolved into a multi-agency operation involving the Himachal Pradesh government, district



George Richmond went down near Deo Tibba; an IAF helicopter was used to evacuate him



administrations, the Indian Air Force, senior political leaders and doctors across two states. Richmond, 54, had arrived

in India as part of a six-member foreign expedition group. According to former MP Preneet Kaur, Richmond was known to

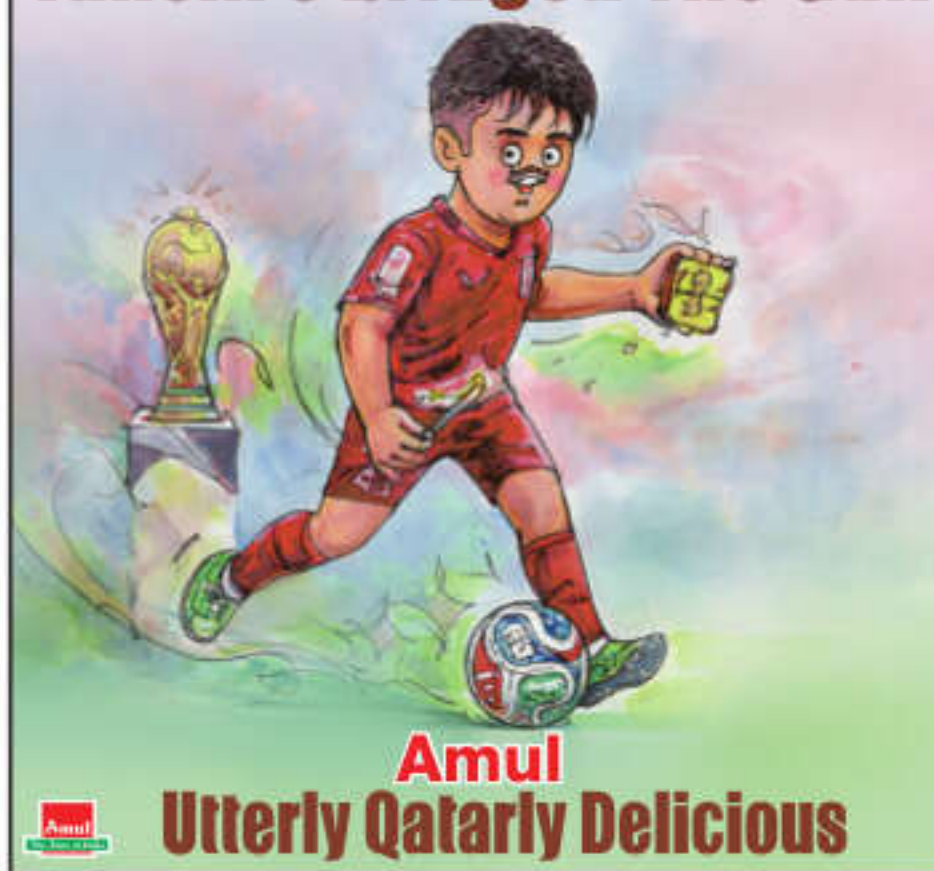
her son, Raninder Singh, through college friends abroad, and stayed with the family in Patiala before leaving for Himachal Pradesh on June 3.

"My son knew them from his college days. He stayed with us for a night before heading to Himachal the next morning. A common friend had brought the group, and they had a guide with them. After they left, we had no idea what had happened until we learnt about the accident. It is very unfortunate," Kaur said.

After reaching Himachal

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Tahsin's bridged The Gulf

**Amul**
Utterly Qatariy Delicious

daCunha/AB/1108

Jaspal Rana, always aiming for the perfect shot, dies at 49

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, June 12

ONE OF the things shooter Jaspal Rana loved explaining about his complex sport was the trigger pull. He would show videos of his most famous ward, Manu Bhaker, and then painstakingly explain the almost invisible movements that produce the perfect shot. To most, it would sound vague but for Rana, it was everything. He could admire a "beautiful shot", he often said, even if it missed the bullseye.

It was a quirk that said a lot about him. For all his reputation as a straight-talker and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Legendary shooter Jaspal Rana guided Manu Bhaker to her Olympics double bronze. PTI

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Union Home Minister Amit Shah, J&K L-G Manoj Sinha and NSA at a meeting on the upcoming Amarnath Yatra, in New Delhi, Friday. PTI

Shah tells agencies to ensure foolproof security during Amarnath Yatra

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 12

UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah on Friday directed the security agencies to establish a multi-layered security grid along the Amarnath Yatra route while ensuring adequate facilities for pilgrims.

Chairing a meeting on the preparedness for the Yatra starting on July 3, Shah said the Centre was committed to ensuring the highest level of security and a smooth pilgrimage.

The Amarnath Yatra is one of the country's one of the most significant annual pilgrimages, drawing lakhs of devotees each year. The 57-day pilgrimage to the 3,880-metre-high cave shrine in the Himalayas requires a massive security deployment, with the Central and Union Territory agencies working in close tandem. Pilgrims travel through the traditional 48-km Nunwan-Pahalgam route in Anantnag district and the shorter but steeper 14-km Baltal route in Ganderbal district.

During the meeting, Shah also asked the CAPFs, Jammu

and Kashmir Police and other security agencies that they should work in close coordination to put in place a foolproof security system. Shah called for the extensive use of drones, CCTV cameras, surveillance systems and other modern technologies to strengthen arrangements. He also directed that senior officers of various CAPFs and the Jammu and Kashmir Police remain deployed at camp sites to continuously oversee the situation during the Yatra.

Shah also reviewed preparedness related to registration, accommodation, health services and disaster management, and said all essential services for pilgrims must be ensured. Shah further asked officials to register local persons and animals associated with the Yatra, issue them QR code-based identity cards, and organise camps for the health screening of animals.

Movement of pilgrim batches, he said, should be regulated strictly in line with weather conditions and forecasts. He also directed that security should also be strengthened at key tourist locations.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM] US, Iran

closely with both sides to finalise the next steps," Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif said in a post on X.

Leaked terms of the proposed memorandum of understanding outlined by Western, Pakistani and Iranian sources Friday appeared to favour Iran, drawing criticism from US President Donald Trump, who called the reports inaccurate.

While there were minor differences in the accounts, all appeared to offer Tehran much of what it has demanded so far, with Trump appearing to win little of what he has sought, beyond the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, which Iran shut after the US and Israel launched attacks in February.

Trump said leaked comments on a deal did not represent what had been agreed to. "The terms that Iran leaked out to the fake news have nothing to do with the terms that were agreed to, in writing," Trump

wrote on his Truth Social platform.

"Very dishonorable people to deal with," he said of the Iranians.

(ENS adds: In the post, he also said, "Also, their totally re-buffed drone attack last night against Indian ships leaving the Hormuz Strait is totally unacceptable. They better get their act together, and fast.")

However, shortly afterwards, Trump reposted a social media post by Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi, in which Araghchi said a memorandum to end the war had never been closer – and also warned against speculation over its contents until it was finalised.

A Western source, an Iranian source and a Gulf source said a key issue yet to be resolved was language on ceasing hostilities in Lebanon. Iran has demanded Israel end a campaign against Iran's allies, the Hezbollah militia.

Under the terms of the text described by other sources to Reuters, the US would immediately begin providing Iran with

billions of dollars in unfrozen assets, and waive sanctions on its oil exports, in return for Iran opening the strait.

Discussion of Iran's nuclear programme would be set aside for a 60-day period of talks on a final settlement, there would be a discussion of war reparations to Tehran, and the dropping of longstanding demands for curbs on Iran's missile programme, the sources said.

Washington has previously demanded Iran give up its stockpile of highly enriched uranium. But none of the versions of the text reviewed by Reuters includes mention of it, and the sources said the demand had been explicitly excluded for now.

But a senior US official, describing the agreement, said that the uranium stockpile "will be destroyed and removed" and Iran's nuclear programme would be dismantled.

"None of their money released until they perform. Strait of Hormuz will be open. No Iran funding of terrorist groups," the official said. "This is what they have agreed to. This is a perform-

ance-based deal."

Vice President JD Vance said on X: "First, the Iranians are not receiving any cash, and no funds are being released for simply signing a deal or attending a meeting."

The deal ensures economic benefits would only flow to Iran if it meets its obligations under the agreement, he said.

A Western source said that if language can be agreed, the memorandum could be signed as soon as Sunday by Vance and Iran's parliament speaker, Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf, with Geneva for now seen as the likeliest venue.

Despite jointly launching the war with the United States, Israel has so far been excluded from the negotiations, and Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said his country would not be party to the memorandum.

Netanyahu has repeatedly clashed with Trump in recent weeks over US demands that Israel curb military action in Lebanon to let Washington reach a deal with Tehran.

– REUTERS

Top US diplomat

missing a day earlier from MT Settebello after it was attacked — of the 24 Indians on board, 21 were rescued. Also Thursday, US forces fired Hellfire missiles into the engine room of MT Jalveer, a Guinea-Bissau-flagged tanker, near the Oman coast. All 20 Indian seafarers on board were safely evacuated.

CDA Jason Meeks was summoned to the Ministry of External Affairs where K Nagaraj Naidu, Additional Secretary (Americas division), conveyed India's concerns.

The MEA, which usually doesn't use the word "summoning" for calling in foreign diplomats, said in a statement: "The US Charge d'Affaires, Mr Jason Meeks, was summoned to the Ministry of External Affairs today. A strong protest was lodged

with him regarding the continuing attacks by US naval forces on commercial vessels carrying Indian mariners in the Gulf of Oman, which have already resulted in the tragic and avoidable loss of three Indian lives."

The MEA again "conveyed its deep concern over the use of lethal and deadly force against civilian shipping. Such actions are unacceptable and undermine the safety, security and stability of international maritime commerce in a sensitive region at a difficult time".

"The US Charge d'Affaires was requested to convey India's strong concerns to his authorities and to ensure that US forces operating in the region take all necessary measures to prevent the loss of civilian life," it said.

Meeks was first summoned

on Wednesday following an attack earlier in the day by American forces on MT Settebello.

The war in West Asia, triggered by the US-Israeli attack on Iran on February 28 and the subsequent naval blockade near the Strait of Hormuz, have jeopardised Indian lives and livelihoods, apart from the economic impact. Since Indian seafarers are part of the global shipping industry, they have become casualties in the ongoing conflict. At least 13 Indians have been killed since the start of the war, and one remains missing.

The sense in Delhi is that such attacks cannot go unchallenged. Maritime security and the safety of seafarers are a major concern in the Strait of Hormuz area.

The strait is the key channel through which 20 percent of the global energy supply passes in large carriers. Qatar, UAE, Kuwait have all been negatively im-

pacted by the closure of the strait, and that has led to a global rise in prices of oil and gas, and impacted the supply of LPG to India and other countries.

The attacks on commercial vessels, the resumption of military strikes by US and Iran and the issue of maritime security frame both diplomatic and economic challenges for G7 leaders meeting next week at Evian-les-Bains in eastern France – Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Donald Trump will be among world leaders at the meeting. Modi is undertaking an official visit to France and Slovakia from June 13 to 18.

In April, the Indian government had summoned the Iranian envoy to lodge a protest over the targeting of Indian vessels, and had conveyed "deep concern". This was after the Iranian navy fired on passing vessels, two of them India-flagged carriers.

Crash site

the burns she sustained while trying to save her son. Behind the grieving mother on Friday were photographs of Aakash, with visitors coming to pay their respects. A large poster announced a bhajan event on Friday evening in the New Lakshminagar flats, where the family lives, barely 50 metres from the crash site.

Family members and loved ones of several victims of the tragedy gathered on Friday at the crash site in the Meghainagar area of Ahmedabad to mark one year since the crash. Police allowed family members to walk past the cordon, into the site. Navigating the heap of debris that is still there, the mourners walked up to piles of earth, burnt metal, and rubber, to spend a few quiet minutes.

Wearing a beige thobe, Dr Salim Mister arrived by train from Bharuch to pay homage to his wife, Sajeda, who was a passenger on the plane. Walking to the site on the sultry afternoon, the sweat on his face merged with tears.

"*Eek saal ho gaya* (a year has passed)..." She was going to be with my daughter, who was pregnant and settled in London," he says. Mister has three daughters, two of whom are settled in London, and a son, who is in Canada.

"We are keen to know what will come out in the final investigation report... The pilot must have naturally tried till the end to save [the passengers], and his own life was also at stake," he tells *The Indian Express*.

Another man grieving the loss of his wife in the crash was

Gunjankumar Naran Chaudhary. His wife, Jaymini, had come back to India from London to visit her parents and was returning to the UK when tragedy struck. She was two months pregnant at the time.

"On June 8, I had ordered a birthday cake for Jaymini from Patel bakery in Valsad, where she had gone to visit her parents. She was going to come back home to London on June 12. That day, I lost everything — my partner of 12 years and my child who had not yet been born," says Chaudhary, tears welling up in his eyes as he visited the crash site. In his mid-thirties, Chaudhary travelled from Kalol in Gandhinagar with a picture of his wife and prayed at the spot.

The couple, who had been together for the last 12 years — two years of engagement and 10 years of marriage — had initially put off plans to have children as they looked to move to the UK. In 2022, both secured jobs there: Gunjan in a chemical firm and Jaymini in a healthcare company.

"On May 8, 2025, Jaymini had come home for the first time since we left India together in 2022. I had visited once back in 2024, so this was my second visit. We had not spent a single moment apart since we had been together, but since I had to go back to the UK early due to lack of leave, I left on May 21, and Jaymini was to follow on June 12. This was the first time I had left her side, and this happened," says Chaudhary.

Filmmaker Milan Sharma and family came to the site and placed a photograph of his sister, Anju, on the boundary wall of the hostel buildings. A year earlier, Milan and Anju had travelled from Vadodara to

Ahmedabad to catch flights to different destinations. While Milan was headed to Mumbai for work, Anju was flying to London to meet her elder daughter, Nimmi. He recalls that his sister had, at 1.09 pm, put a status on social media, saying, "*Aadmi kuch nahi, ek khilana hai* (Man is nothing but a toy)."

"My flight to Mumbai was at 11.45 am and Anju's flight, AI 171, was scheduled for 1.10 pm, but was delayed. I landed in Mumbai at 1.15 pm, and when I came out of the airport at 1.50 pm, I heard about the crash," Milan told *The Indian Express*.

Anju, 56, was one of nine siblings — eight sisters and a brother. Their elderly parents live in Haryana. She lost her husband in 2021, and has two daughters: Nimmi, who lives in the UK, and Honey, who is in India.

Milan recalls having spoken to her on the flight. She had ordered a masala dosa but wasn't in the mood to eat it. "Anju did video-called our mother from the airport, but she could not pick up the call, and she regrets it to this day," he says.

Mukesh Patni, who drives an autorickshaw, arrived to pay homage to his mother Jiviben, 68, whose poster hung outside the crash site.

"My mother lived in a small hut nearby. When the plane crashed, she was alone and cooking a meal. I learned about the crash on social media and immediately rushed, but my mother had died by then," says Patni. "Today, I came to pay my respects to my mother and all others killed in the crash. We have received compensation, but we want to know the reason behind the crash. The investigation report is not out yet."

a senior Himachal Pradesh government official said.

Given the difficult terrain and the urgency of Richmond's condition, assistance from the Indian Air Force was sought. In an late-evening operation, an IAF helicopter evacuated him from the remote location and flew him to Bhuntar at 7.10 pm.

From there, the Kullu district administration coordinated his transfer to the Civil Hospital in Kullu before arranging his onward movement to PGIMER, Chandigarh, where specialised treatment was available.

At PGIMER, doctors carried out a detailed assessment and subsequently operated on Richmond. Medical experts said he had suffered a cervical spine injury that resulted in quadriplegia, characterised by muscle weakness in both arms and legs.

Rescue op

Pradesh, Richmond and his companions set out on an expedition in the Kullu-Manali region, which included trekking and paragliding. During the outing, Richmond suffered a serious accident, sustaining severe injuries to his cervical spine.

According to sources, Richmond crashed in rugged mountainous terrain near Deo Tibba while participating in a long-distance cross-country flying excursion from Bir Billing in Kangra district. Fellow paragliders alerted local authorities, triggering an extensive search-and-rescue operation in difficult terrain. Bir Billing, considered the paragliding capital of India, is popular among foreigners who like to

take long flights.

As information about the accident reached Punjab on the afternoon of June 8, Amarinder and Raninder contacted authorities and sought assistance from the Himachal Pradesh government.

Kaur said she also reached out to her relative, Himachal Pradesh Public Works Minister Vikramaditya Singh, who helped coordinate the response.

"Permissions for helicopter movement were coordinated through the local administration, including the Deputy Commissioners and SDMs. Everyone worked together and did a fantastic job," she said.

"What we were told was that they had been trekking before paragliding and then the incident took place. Multiple district administrations were roped in,"

Jaspal Rana dies at 49

fighter, Rana was fundamentally a shooting obsessive. A nerd who dedicated his life — first as an athlete, then as a coach — chasing perfection in a sport where success is measured in millimetres.

Rana died on Friday at age 49. He was travelling as a coach with the Indian team at the shooting World Cup in Munich, which concluded on May 31.

Doctors said Rana experienced an acute heart attack and had been "travelling and continued to experience chest pain before arriving at the hospital in very critical condition".

Dr Balbir Singh, Group Chairman, Cardiac Sciences at Max Super Speciality Hospital in New Delhi, said the "artery responsible for the heart attack was completely blocked". After treatment, Rana "had recovered significantly and was fit for discharge today (Friday). However, he unfortunately suffered a sudden cardiac rupture while asleep, which led to his demise," he said in a statement.

Tributes poured in, led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who hailed his "unwavering commitment to excellence, discipline and service to the sporting world".

Rana spent much of his life doing two things exceptionally well: shooting with pistols and speaking his mind. In many ways, his glorious career was a study in contradictions.

He possessed the stillness required of an elite pistol shooter but carried himself with the energy of a man constantly ready for a fight. He could be warm and encouraging to young shooters, but blunt to the point of discomfort when confronting authority.

The son of a war veteran-turned-politician from Uttarakhand, Rana, who also dabbled in politics, emerged as one of Indian sport's brightest young talents in the early 1990s with an Asian Games gold medal.

What followed was one of the most decorated careers Indian shooting has seen. Across Asian Games, Commonwealth Games and world-level competitions, Rana accumulated medals with remarkable consistency.

In 2006, at the Asian Games in Doha, he produced one of the finest performances of his career, winning three gold medals and a silver while equalling the world record in the 25m Centre Fire Pistol event. An Olympic medal eluded him because his pet event wasn't part of the Games.

Yet, statistics alone don't fully capture the shooter Rana was.

Those who competed with him often spoke about his instinctive understanding of pistol shooting. Abhinav Bindra, paying tribute, described him as "intense and gifted".

Rana possessed a rare ability to deliver under pressure and unbreakable confidence in his own methods. He belonged to a generation that largely learned through repetition, discipline and self-belief rather than sports science and data analytics. He trusted the feel for the sport and was unapologetic about it.

That certainty often split beyond the range.

Indian shooting has witnessed its share of political battles over the years, and Rana was seldom a passive observer. He could be combative, particularly when he felt standards were being slipping or athletes were being shortchanged. At various points, disagreements with administrators and coaches pushed him to the margins of the national set-up. He was not always easy to accommodate, but neither was he willing to compromise for convenience.

His greatest contribution to Indian shooting may ultimately have come after he put the pistol down.

Long before India became a shooting superpower, Rana invested deeply in junior development. He became the junior coach in 2012, and in the decade that followed, many of India's international pistol shooters — from Manu to Saurabh Chaudhary — passed through systems he helped build or influence.

The most visible chapter of his coaching career arrived through his association with Manu, the only Indian athlete to win two medals at a single edition of the Olympics. "I feel God sent him to me," Manu had said after her medals.

Rana, who was ostracised by the Indian shooting fraternity after the Tokyo Olympics because of his outspokenness, would have had the urge to scream "told you so" after Manu won those medals. But he sat alone in his hotel room — he didn't have the accreditation to stay with the athletes — and binged on crisps, already plotting for a better-coloured medal at Los Angeles 2028.

That, perhaps, was the most Jaspal Rana thing of all. Even at the summit, he was already searching for the next perfect shot.

Stand-up show row

permissible under National Medical Commission norms.

The hospital authorities have also called Pawar's parents to the institute on Saturday to counsel her in their presence. The hospital is also considering seeking assistance from relevant authorities and social media platforms to remove objectionable clips circulating online.

The hospital's action came even as Maharashtra Cyber officers said they would send the viral video clips for forensic examination and summon the accused for questioning. Investigators would also review some of More's earlier shows and online content, an officer said.

Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis, meanwhile, said the government is not opposed to stand-up comedy or comedians but it must not cross the "line of decency". "I personally watch stand-up comedy. It is a form of entertainment. But when you live in a society, certain dignity has to be maintained. When that line of decency is crossed, it affects others and amounts to an infringement on their freedom," he said.

KEM Hospital dean Dr Harish M Pathak said the institution set up a preliminary fact-finding committee after receiving multiple complaints regarding remarks made by Pawar during an online comedy show. "The committee reviewed the complete video recording and interacted with the student. The preliminary fact-finding report has now been received by the Dean's office," Pathak said.

The inquiry also follows the circulation of another video from October 2025 in which Pawar allegedly made disparaging remarks about KEM Hospital, her professors and fellow students.

Institute strongly disapproves of any conduct or public communication that undermines the dignity of patients, deceased persons, their families,

the medical profession, or the reputation of the institution," Pathak said. He added that the matter would be dealt with through due process in accordance with National Medical Commission guidelines, university norms and institutional disciplinary rules.

The issue also reached the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation's Public Health Committee on Friday, with committee chairman Harish Bhandigre seeking details of the inquiry from the dean. Describing Pawar's remarks as "unfortunate and condemnable," Bhandigre said such comments could undermine awareness efforts around body and organ donation. "People donate organs and bodies for a noble cause. For a medical student to make such statements is regrettable and unfortunate," he said.

Police on Thursday registered an FIR against More, Pawar and another audience member Himanshu Jangra. More has been booked for uploading the content while Pawar and Jangra have been accused of making objectionable remarks during separate crowd-work interactions. The case has been registered under Sections 75(1)(iv), 75(3), 294 and 353(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, along with provisions of the Information Technology Act.

The controversy erupted after videos featuring Pawar and Jangra went viral on social media. In one clip, Pawar allegedly made insensitive remarks about male cadaver donors. In another, Jangra is heard making a remark suggesting entitlement to physical intimacy in return of Rs 370 spent on chicken biryani during a date.

The issue was also discussed at a meeting in the dean's office attended by several BMC corporators and former Mumbai mayor Kishori Pednekar. Pednekar criticised Pawar's remarks and sought strict action.

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Another fire in Delhi, 3 of family die in early morning blaze

Pragynesh
New Delhi, June 12

THREE MEMBERS of a family were killed and their two relatives remain critical after a fire ripped through a six-storey residential building in South-east Delhi's Tughlakabad Extension early Friday.

The victims were identified as Pankaj (28), his sister Soni (20) and grandmother Sushila Devi (70). Pankaj's younger sister Moni (18) and mother Guddi (50) are being treated for injuries. Police said that initial inquiry suggests that an electrical short circuit on the ground floor may have triggered the fire.

The flames subsequently engulfed several parked vehicles, including three scooters, two motorcycles, one bicycle and an electric scooter that was reportedly being charged at the time.

However, officers said the exact cause of the blaze will be established only after a probe.

An FIR on the charge of causing death by negligence has been registered, said Govindpuri police station.



The lane where the fire started on Friday. VIVEK PRAKASH KRISHNA

Police said a PCR call regarding the blaze was received at the police station around 2.24 am. Local police personnel immediately rushed to the spot. Fire tenders, CATS ambulances and other emergency responders were also mobilised.

The fire quickly spread through the building, trapping several residents inside due to heavy smoke. Eight occupants were evacuated from different

floors and shifted to Safdarjung Hospital and AIIMS Trauma Centre for treatment.

By 4.25 am, the fire had spread from the ground floor parking area to all six floors of the building. While the ground, first and second floors were completely gutted, the upper floors suffered partial damage.

The building had 10 to 12 flats, two on each of the floors. A factory was operating on the third floor, said local residents.

While all flats had balconies on the opposite side of the building, the entrance where the fire started was located in front of the building. "Bikes and scooters were parked on the ground floor parking lot. The fire broke out there and spread to all vehicles," said Prince, a local resident.

"I saw three girls coming from the gate of the adjacent building. They had jumped to the terrace of the next building," said Ashish (45), a resident of the same area.

"While the building lacked proper ventilation, a factory was functioning inside it," he added.

Two years after father, son and daughter die

Pragynesh
New Delhi, June 12

TWO YEARS ago, when Subhash died of cancer, his family moved out of the house they shared with his elder brother Suresh in Tughlakabad's Railway Colony in Southeast Delhi. His wife Guddi, son Pankaj, and daughters Soni and Moni rented a third-floor flat in Tughlakabad's Gali 1, lined with ramshackle buildings.

On Friday morning, Suresh waited near the same road, watching Delhi Fire Services (DFS) personnel bring out the bodies of his brother's family. Pankaj, Soni and their maternal grandmother were among those killed after a fire broke out in the parking lot on the ground floor of the six-storey building earlier in the day.

"It was my responsibility to look after them. Now they are gone. Pankaj had just got a job. They needed more space, that's why they had moved out," Su-



Building that caught fire at Tughlakabad Extension. VIVEK PRAKASH KRISHNA

resh said. Pankaj was working at a mobile repair shop, while Soni worked at a boutique in Udyog Vihar.

"Both worked very hard to meet the medical expenses of their mother, who suffered from a speech impairment and often fell sick. They also paid the educational expenses of their youngest sister Moni, who had enrolled in a BA course this year, said Suresh.

"I was asleep when I got a call around 3 am. Moni is still in the hospital. I will have to tell her that her brother and sister are no more," he said.

Near the burn ward of Safdarjung Hospital, meanwhile, sat Guddi, the brother-in-law of Mumtaz (24), who was at her home on the fourth floor of the building, when smoke started to enter her kitchen.

"Her husband Deepak had

gone to Agra for work... Around 3 am, I got a call from my brother, saying that there was a fire at his house, and Mumtaz is trapped," he said.

By the time he reached Tughlakabad from Madan Pur Khadar, Mumtaz had been rescued and shifted to hospital. "She was brought down from the balcony... The neighbours were trying to douse the flames with water," he said.

One of them was Saurav Sharma (35). The scream of his 16-year-old daughter woke him up — "Papa, smoke is coming out from the next building."

By the time Saurav reached the window, the electricity had been cut. The burning building stood barely a few feet away from his house. "An elderly man on the second floor was screaming for help... While I called the DFS and then went downstairs, my daughter got a saree and threw it towards the man. He used it to climb down," said Sharma, who works for a private

firm in Gurgaon.

Renu Bhutani (45), Saurav's neighbour, was watching Crime Patrol, when the screams began. Realising that the terrace offered the only escape route, she and her son Manav climbed to the roof of their four-storey building. "Since the building on fire is six-storey, my son got two ladders. We tied them together and reached the terrace of the burning building. The terrace door was stuck, so Manav broke it open," said Renu.

As the door opened, thick smoke billowed out. Unable to breathe, they broke open two water tanks with stones and let the water flow into the building to reduce the smoke.

"We then poured water on ourselves and rushed down the stairs. We heard the screams of two girls on the fourth floor, and of a couple on the third. We broke open their gates and brought them out through the same route we used to enter the building," Renu said.

Heat, dust storm, then rain: Decoding Delhi-NCR's 'erratic' weather in June

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, June 12

AFTER DAYS of punishing heat, Delhi-NCR woke up to cooler air and rain on Friday. Late night, too, the entire region was placed under a red alert, as a powerful thunderstorm system swept across North India, bringing strong winds, lightning, duststorms and widespread rainfall. As per IMD, Palam in Delhi recorded gusts up to 76 kmph.

The timing, however, raised a question: How did the Capital cool down just as the emergence of El Niño, a climate phenomenon linked to weaker monsoons and hotter weather over parts of India, was confirmed?

To understand why Delhi's weather has swung repeatedly between intense heat, dust storms and thunderstorms this pre-monsoon season, it is important to look at both the weather systems shaping conditions across North India and the broader climate signals emerging elsewhere.

The immediate reason was a fast-moving squall line, a chain of intense thunderstorms, which developed over Punjab on Thursday evening and travelled eastwards across Haryana into Delhi-NCR overnight.

The system brought light to moderate rainfall to many parts of Punjab and Haryana, accompanied by strong winds, including gusts reaching 111 kmph in Sangrur. Southeastern winds gusting up to around 65 kmph prevailed over Delhi.

Krishna Mishra, a senior scientist at the India Meteorological Department (IMD), explained that a squall line is a fast-moving, continuous line of thunderstorms that can extend across hundreds of kilometres. Such systems are capable of producing intense but short-lived weather, including torrential rain, lightning, straight-line winds and, at times, hail.

Temperature drop

The squall had a direct impact on temperatures.

Safdarjung, Delhi's base weather station, recorded a minimum temperature of 22.8 degrees Celsius, 5.2 degrees below normal and 7.2 degrees lower than the previous day.

Palam recorded 21.6 degrees Celsius, 6.5 degrees below normal, while Lodhi Road and Ridge recorded 22 degrees Celsius and 20.9 degrees Celsius respectively. Across the city, minimum temperatures fell by around 7-8 degrees Celsius within 24 hours.

The maximum temperatures saw a significant dip as well: Ayanagar recorded a high of 33.2 degrees Celsius, eight degrees below normal; followed by Pusa, which saw a six degrees dip at 34.7 degrees Celsius. Safdarjung recorded a

• Skywatch



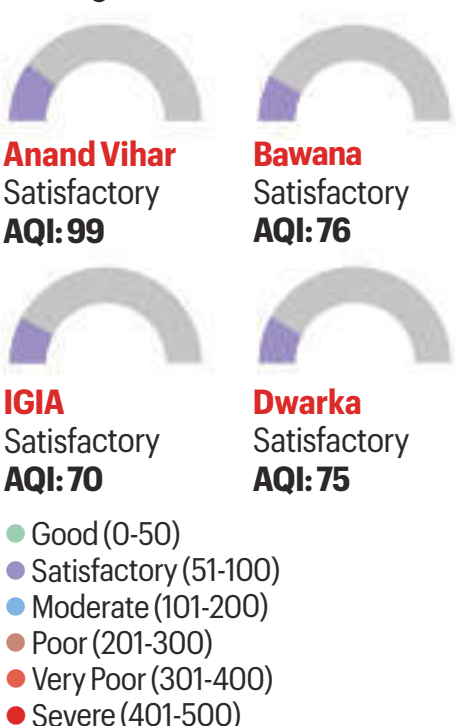
Forecast: June 13, 2026
Partly cloudy sky. A spell of very light to light rain likely.

MAX: 36-38
1.9°C below normal

MIN: 22-24
6°C below normal

• **Sunrise:** 5:23 AM (June 14)
• **Sunset:** 7:20 PM (June 13)
• **Moonrise:** 4:01 AM (June 14)
• **Moonset:** 5:36 PM (June 13)

• AQI Tracker



high of 34.6 degrees Celsius, five notches below normal.

The combination of cloud cover, rainfall and rain-cooled winds contributed to the sharp drop in temperatures.

Unusual weather?

In recent weeks, Delhi has experienced repeated episodes of heat, dust storms, thunderstorms and abrupt temperature fluctuations as western disturbances interacted with moisture-laden winds and intense surface heating. Such conditions, however, are typical of the transition period before the monsoon, which is expected to have an onset over Delhi on June 30.

The IMD, late Friday, warned that duststorms and thunderstorms accompanied by moderate to heavy rainfall and lightning are very likely across the entire Delhi-NCR, with winds of 60-80 kmph gusting up to 100 kmph. The warning, issued shortly after 11 pm, covered Delhi and adjoining districts of Haryana, western Uttar Pradesh and eastern Rajasthan.

El Niño

The larger climate shift could play a role in coming months over Northwest India's weather. As per the US National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA), there is a 63% chance of a very strong El Niño during November-January, potentially placing the event among the strongest observed since reliable records began in 1950.

INDUSTRY PLAYERS RAISED MATTER WITH EXCISE DEPT

Capital witnesses comeback of popular beer labels this summer amid govt checks on brand push

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, June 12

DELHI IS witnessing a comeback of some of India's most popular and widely consumed beer brands this summer with the Excise department maintaining a close watch at not just the stocks of the government vends, but also the sales figures, industry insiders said.

Over the last few years, popular brands largely went missing from the shelves of government-run stores in the city due to "brand push" and "monopoly" of vendors running the government outlets, according to a senior official.

After the liquor policy brought by the previous AAP government faced legal challenges, the government had introduced old excise regime in 2022, allowing only government liquor shops in Delhi run by four corporations — Delhi Tourism & Transportation Development Corporation Ltd (DTTDC), Delhi Consumer's Cooperative Wholesale Store (DCCWS), Delhi State Industrial and Infrastructure Development Corporation Ltd. (DSIIDC), and Delhi State Civil Supplies Corporation Limited (DSCSC).

However, the demand for popular brands pushed the consumers to neighbouring states like Haryana and Uttar Pradesh, which impacted Delhi's excise revenue, according to officials. The trend, however, is now reversing on the sales charts of all the four government corporations that run around 700 liquor shops in Delhi.

Brand push at the vendor-level, according to industry insiders, had led to the replacement of popular brands with those from Nepal and Bhutan, among others. A senior Delhi government official said, "After the issues of brand push were raised by the industry players,

• WHAT SELLS IN THE CAPITAL

	Total	National brands	Others	% National brand share	% Others
May 2026	1,112,761	5,96,351	5,16,410	54	46
May 2025	10,10,524	2,47,143	7,63,381	24	76
May 2024	11,52,736	4,35,208	7,17,528	38	62

Top 5 popular beer brands in May 2026
Light beer: Budweiser, Kingfisher Ultra Gold, Corona, Kingfisher Ultra Fine Large, Hoegaarden Belgian White
Strong beer: Kingfisher, Budweiser, Foster Australian, Thunderbolt, Tuborg
Draught beer: Budweiser, Medusa, Six Fields Blanche, Hoegaarden, Kingfisher

SOURCE: DATA COLLATED FROM 4 GOVT CORPORATIONS

the Excise department has been keeping a close eye. It also conducts surprise inspections to keep a tab."

Vinod Giri, Director General of Brewers Association of India (BAI), said, "The share of well-known national brands used to be 80% when private shops were there in the city. It started falling after private retail was removed and rampant brand pushing of unknown brands by staff of government-owned shops began. It fell to as low as 24% last May. This May, it has improved to 54% due to stricter watch on brand pushing by the excise department."

Another industry insider said, "Staff at retail vends may have been pushing these brands because of the higher profit margins on Bhutanese and Nepalese beer labels as import duty is not levied on them."

May and June make the peak season for sales of beer in the city. This year, according to the government data, May saw an increase in sales of beer by about 10% compared to previous year with 11,12,761 cases sold this year as compared to 10,10,524 cases during the same period last year.

Popular brands are among top-sellers. As per the data, na-

tional brands with 5,96,351 cases sold this May, compared to 2,47,143 last year. Data also shows that the share of other lesser-known brands was 62% in May 2024 and it sharply increased to 76% last year. This year, it's down to 46%. (see box)

Officials in the Excise department said that pushing a particular brand at the retail-level is not permitted. "If a customer goes and asks for a specific label, the staff should provide that. The department is closely monitoring the situation," an official said.

Giri, however, expressed concern that the moment the Excise department takes its eyes off, brand-pushing will be back in full swing. "Long-term solution to brand push lies in bringing back private shops as an alternative, display of stocks outside the shops and converting all shops into self service walk-ins," he said.

Asked how many liters or bottles are there in each case, a senior official said, "Usually, it is 650 ml bottles multiplied by 12. It could also be 330ml x 24, and cans 500 ml x 24."

The current excise policy, which has already been extended multiple times, is in force until March 2027.

TWO SHOOTINGS IN DELHI AND HARYANA

Lawrence gang's new global face — Harry Boxer who issued 'threats' to Salman, Ranveer

Alok Singh
New Delhi, June 12

HARRY BOXER is fast emerging as one of the most talked-about new faces in the Lawrence Bishnoi gang. In the space of just a few months, security agencies said, he has moved from relative obscurity to becoming a key operator allegedly operating gang activities from abroad, with his name now surfacing in cases stretching from North India to North America.

How did this happen? Investigators pointed to a power vacuum that followed a series of setbacks for the Lawrence network. In its chargesheet filed in the murder of Punjabi singer Sidhu Moosewala, the NIA had said the gang boasted of nearly 700 shooters across India even with Lawrence lodged at Sabarmati Central Jail in Ahmedabad.

At the time, Goldy Brar, widely regarded as Lawrence's right-hand man, allegedly orchestrated Moosewala's murder. His subsequent split from the gang, coupled with the arrest of Lawrence's younger brother Anmol, weakened the organisation — creating room for newer figures to step in.

Boxer's growing prominence became visible once again in connection to two shootings in Delhi and Haryana.

Two audio clips began circulating on social media early Thursday. One was linked to a shooting at singer Guru Randhawa's gym in Delhi's Paschim Vihar; the other to the murder of gym trainer Kapil Redhu outside his gym at Hansi, Haryana.

Police said Boxer claimed responsibility for both attacks. In the recordings, he alleged that he had told Randhawa to stay away from actor Salman Khan, and that the shooting was intended as a warning after the singer allegedly ignored his



CCTV camera footage shows the attacks in Delhi and Haryana's Hansi (left); Harry Boxer.

advice. Boxer also claimed that Redhu was killed because he was allegedly involved in planning a recent shootout in Shekhpura and Dhani Purnia in Haryana. Threatening to target others connected to the case, he warned that any police action against his family members in Rajasthan would make him "more dangerous".

Police said they are still verifying the authenticity of the audio clips.

Boxer, whose real name is Hari Chand Jaat, hails from Narayanpur in Rajasthan's Alwar district and comes from a farming family. He graduated from a college in Bansur and prepared for recruitment examinations for the police, Army and Staff Selection Commission. "After he became involved in criminal activities, his parents disowned him," a police officer said.

Police said Boxer has been absconding since 2022 and is suspected to have fled to the US through Nepal in 2024. He has been accused in cases involving the assault of a retired IAS officer and a police officer in Rajasthan as well as a firing incident outside a Jaipur club.

According to a senior officer of the Delhi Police Special Cell,

Boxer is wanted in at least six cases in Delhi, including extortion and firing incidents targeting businessmen and gym owners. Last August, he allegedly demanded Rs 5 crore from a Delhi-based businessman, after which two of his alleged associates were arrested. Boxer also faces more than two dozen criminal cases across Punjab, Haryana and Rajasthan.

Boxer first drew international attention last August after shots were fired at comedian Kapil Sharma's café in Canada. An audio clip attributed to Boxer surfaced, in which he allegedly warned film producers, directors and actors against working with Salman. He also claimed affiliation with the Lawrence gang.

The gang has long held a grudge against Salman over the 1998 blackbuck poaching case in Jodhpur. Following a shooting incident outside the actor's Mumbai residence last year, allegedly carried out by Lawrence gang members, the actor's security was significantly enhanced.

Sources said Boxer's rise has coincided with an intensifying feud between the Lawrence faction and rival groups led by Goldy Brar and Rohit Godara.

• IN WAKE OF MALVIYA NAGAR B&B FIRE

Streets go quiet in Humayunpur, MCD cracks down on food joints

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, June 12

GLOWING NEON signs of the rooftop cafes and restaurants no longer light up the streets of Humayunpur in South Delhi's Safdarjung Enclave. The area, which is known among food buffs for the nightlife it offers, along with flavours from Northeast, Nepal and Tibet, now wears a subdued look.

The reason — Humayunpur this week witnessed a crack-down from the MCD, with notices on violations pasted outside more than 20 restaurants. A majority of these establishments are located on rooftops or in the basement.

The action followed a major fire last week at a bread and

breakfast facility in Hauz Rani area of Malviya Nagar, which killed 23 people, including 14 foreign nationals.

As many popular eating joints in Humayunpur — among the Capital's major food hubs — continued to have their shutters down on Friday, the staff working at the restaurants were staring at an uncertain future.

Among the popular outlets that have shut down are Chak-Khum, Tuoi Moi Eats, Soul Plate, Lha Kitchen, Haomee Cafe, The Roof Eatery and Pema's.

On June 9, according to restaurant owners, MCD officials pasted sealing notices outside their premises. "...Total violation of permissible/sanctioned use of the said property..."



Closed outlets at Humayunpur. MISHAL MUSSADDIQUE

against the Master Plan-2021/ Zonal Plan/ Sanctioned plan and amounts to misuse of premises under reference," read the notices.

This pertains to 'mixed use

regulations' in the Delhi Master Plan 2021, which has set guidelines for commercial activities within residential areas. The properties have been found to be allegedly violating the guide-

lines, according to the notices.

Amugha (28) from Nagaland is now working part-time at the Boba Tea shop after the rooftop dining cafe where he was employed was shut down.

"We got no prior warning. There was a fire in Malviya Nagar, so we had to shut down. That's what the boss told us. I am helping out here at the Boba for now. But I hope the restaurant will open up soon, and I can go back to work," said Amugha, who has been working in the area for three months now.

Lha Kitchen, a popular outlet offering Himalayan cuisine, was among the handful of restaurants that opened on Friday. The MCD notice is still pasted outside the shop. The staff said they are not sure which of the

rules have been violated.

An employee at a well-known Manipuri cuisine restaurant claimed that some restaurants have opened with the permission of building owners.

According to him, restaurants operating out of rooftops and basements are mainly being targeted and surveilled.

The Indian Express reached out to the South MCD office seeking to know the total number of restaurants that have received such notices, but did not receive a response.

Much like Hauz Rani, Humayunpur is a densely-packed residential and market area, which consists of narrow alleyways, tangled overhead wires and buildings located extremely close to each other.

TO IMPROVE PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT, ADDRESS LOCAL ISSUES IN TIME-BOUND MANNER

Delhi Police chief orders traffic DCPs to hold foot patrols during weekend

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, June 12

TO STRENGTHEN visible policing by deploying officers and marked vehicles in public spaces while also addressing traffic bottlenecks at the ground level, Delhi Police Commissioner Satish Golchha has directed district and traffic DCPs (deputy commissioner of police) to carry out joint foot patrols every Saturday and Sunday, and on two additional days each week from 5 pm to 8 pm.

According to a circular issued by Golchha on Thursday, the exercise is intended to improve direct public interaction, regulate traffic, remove temporary obstructions and encroachments, and address local issues in a time-bound manner.



Satish Golchha

trict-level field officers and traffic officers, with the two additional DCPs to be decided by the concerned DCPs in consultation with their concerned JCP (joint commissioner of police) of ranges.

It added that during the des-

ignated period, DCPs, Additional DCPs, and ACPs (assistant commissioner of police) from district police and traffic police are expected to remain in the field and treat the exercise as a compulsory field duty, rather than a routine formality.

The objective, the circular noted, is to ensure direct supervision and immediate corrective action on the ground.

During the foot patrols, officers have been asked to interact with traders, resident welfare associations (RWA), Market Welfare Associations (MWA), residents and members of the public; identify and remove temporary encroachments and general obstructions; address traffic bottlenecks and ensure smooth vehicular movement and inspect vulnerable points, public places, markets and congestion-prone stretches.

Golchha has directed all district DCPs to consult the concerned DCP (Traffic) and prepare a weekly joint patrolling plan. "A separate record should be maintained for each exercise, including the date and time of patrolling, names and ranks of officers present, area and route covered, MWAs and RWAs contacted, legal action taken, encroachments removed, action against illegal parking, and traffic bottlenecks identified," the circular said.

It was also directed that as far as possible, no office work, meetings, conferences, or indoor reviews should be scheduled during this period so that officers can devote the time exclusively to field presence.

VACCINE-DERIVED POLIO VIRUS DETECTED

Survey to cover around 30,000 households across Ghaziabad

Drishti Jain
Ghaziabad, June 12

NEARLY A week after a vaccine-derived polio virus (VDPV) was detected in a sewage sample in Ghaziabad, authorities on Thursday surveyed 5,421 homes having 2,590 children below the age of five, as part of an extensive door-to-door survey covering around 30,000 households in 12 localities.

Two of the 12 such localities – Bulandshahr and Shastri Nagar – have been completely surveyed, officials in the Health department said. Besides Bulandshahr and Shastri Nagar, the other areas being surveyed are Raj Nagar, Daulatpura, Panchvati Kot village, Ghukna, Hindon Vihar, Kaila Bhatta, Mirzapur, Vijay Nagar 1, Vijay Nagar 2 and Kharati Nagar, home to around 1.5 lakh people.

The virus was detected in a sample collected from the Vijay Nagar sewage pumping station

on June 5. Following this, the District Surveillance Unit mapped the sewage drainage network and identified 12 localities falling within the affected area.

The survey began on Tuesday and is being closely monitored by the Uttar Pradesh government, the National Centre for Disease Control (NCDC) and the World Health Organization (WHO).

Officials said that the detected strain is largely non-virulent and has so far remained contained. "Similar instances have been reported earlier in Varanasi and Meghalaya. Routine sample collection and tests are conducted every fortnight," an official said.

Polio is a highly infectious disease that primarily affects children and can lead to paralysis and, in severe cases, death. Vaccination remains the only effective protection against the disease.

India was declared polio-

free by the WHO in 2014, making it one of the 11 countries in South East Asia, which have been certified free of wild polio virus.

According to the WHO website, apart from routine immunisation, India conducts acute flaccid paralysis surveillance, along with environmental surveillance, which involves regular collection and testing of sewage samples from selected sites from across the country to detect polio virus in faecal matter.

According to WHO, VDPVs are extremely rare. In addition to being reported among immunocompromised individuals, VDPVs may also develop in areas with low population immunity, as per WHO.

Vaccine derived polio virus originates from oral polio vaccine, which contains a weakened live polio virus. After vaccination, it can briefly replicate in the gut and be excreted in stool.

Saket G Block Metro station work begins

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, June 12

PRELIMINARY CONSTRUCTION work for the proposed Saket G Block Metro station – a key interchange on Delhi Metro's upcoming Golden Line corridor – has started, with activities related to the substructure, including piling, pile cap construction and pier works, currently underway, the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) said on Friday.

The station is part of the 8.385-km Lajpat Nagar-Saket G Block section of the Golden Line, which is scheduled to be completed by June 2029. The corridor will have eight stations – Lajpat Nagar, Andrews Ganj, Greater Kailash I, Chirag Dilli, Pushpa Bhawan, Saket District Court, Pushp Vihar and Saket G Block.

According to a DMRC spokesperson, the integrated interchange station at Saket G Block will be elevated and provide paid-area connectivity through a common concourse. It will have four platforms, including an island platform, facilitating movement in both directions and allowing seamless transfers between Metro corridors. They added that the corridor is expected to improve connectivity across several residential, commercial and institutional areas of South Delhi. Localities around Greater Kailash, Chirag Dilli, Pushp Vihar and Saket will get direct Metro access, while schools, government offices and business districts along the route are also expected to benefit.

A major feature of the project is its interchange connectivity. Lajpat Nagar will be a triple-interchange station, with passengers



Work ongoing at the site. EXPRESS

being able to switch between Golden Line, Violet Line and Pink Line. Chirag Dilli station will connect with Magenta Line, while Saket G Block will provide an interchange between Golden Line and proposed Aerocity-Tughlakabad corridor.

The spokesperson said these interchange facilities are expected to reduce travel time for commuters from South Delhi areas such as Tughlakabad, Vasant Kunj and Greater Kailash.

Further, the corridor will introduce India's first three-coach Metro line. Designed primarily for short-distance urban travel, each train will be able to carry around 900 passengers – around 300 passengers per coach.

The spokesperson said the improved connectivity is expected to boost property values in areas such as GK, Saket and Pushp Vihar, while strengthening South Delhi as a hub for commerce, education and government services. The corridor is part of Phase IV expansion, which has six routes – Janakpuri West-RK Ashram, Majlis Park-Maujpur, Aerocity-Tughlakabad, Lajpat Nagar-Saket G Block, Inderlok-Indraprastha and Rithala-Narela. The entire Phase-IV network is expected to be completed by 2029.

EYE ON MONSOON PREPAREDNESS

Gurgaon civic body plans to expand rainwater harvesting infrastructure

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, June 12

IN A pilot initiative that aims to replenish groundwater and curb waterlogging during monsoon, the Gurugram Metropolitan Development Authority (GMDA) has floated a tender for the construction of rainwater harvesting structures across the city. Five rainwater harvesting systems, said officers, will be initially developed in areas under GMDA jurisdiction, spanning Sectors 1 to 57.

According to GMDA officials, the project will serve as a demonstration model for integrating rainwater harvesting with urban stormwater management in sectors prone to

waterlogging.

The proposed systems are designed to be built along major roads and green belts to capture and channelise stormwater runoff, which aims to reduce water accumulation on carriage ways while facilitating groundwater recharge. The exact locations will be finalised based on priority requirements and site feasibility. The authority gradually plans to replicate the model at additional locations across Gurgaon, officials added. The initiative is part of a broader monsoon preparedness drive by the authority, which includes the desilting of master stormwater and surface drains to ensure the free flow of water, officials said.

"Simultaneously, GMDA

teams are clearing debris and leveling green belts across major city corridors. These corridors include the stretches from Signature Chowk to Atul Kataria Chowk, Subhash Chowk to Hero Honda Chowk, Subhash Chowk to Millennium City Centre, the IFFCO Chowk to SPR corridor, and Gurugram University Road. At several of these locations, the green belts are being lowered to act as natural "green drains" to facilitate quicker drainage", a GMDA spokesperson said.

The infrastructure push by the GMDA runs parallel to municipal efforts by the MCG which has been working to operationalise the city's existing water conservation network.

Mahatma Jyotiba Phule Rohilkhand University
Bareilly - 243006

INVITATION FOR RATE CONTRACT PROPOSALS FROM VARIOUS MANUFACTURERS FOR THE SUPPLY OF CHEMICALS/ GLASSWARES/ PLASTIC WARES IN THE FINANCIAL YEAR 2026-27

Sealed Proposals are invited for rate contract with various Manufacturers for the supply of Chemicals / Glasswares/ Plastic Wares in the financial year 2026-27.

The sealed proposals with a copy of price list for current financial year along with details of terms and conditions must reach to the office of **Dean, Academics, M.J.P. Rohilkhand University, Bareilly - 243006, U.P.** by registered/speed post on or before **30-06-2026**.

Interested manufacturers may submit the proposals as per details given above.

REGISTRAR

Parachute
ADVANCED

PROTEIN SHAMPOO

coconut milk & aloe vera
DAMAGE REPAIR
3X SOFTER HAIR
no parabens

PROTEIN SHAMPOO

Jio Mart

Drug unit busted in Outer Delhi: Police trace money trail, question accused

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 12

A DAY after the Delhi Police's Anti-Narcotics Squad unit of the North district busted a drug manufacturing unit in Outer Delhi's Swaroop Nagar area, the officials from the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) and Anti-Narcotics Task Force (ANTF) carried out a joint interrogation of the accused. The two accused arrested on Thursday have been remanded to three days police custody, said officers.

Raja Banthia, DCP North said, "Didier Romeo, one of the accused arrested during the raid, came to India in 2021 on a business visa. Martin Ajva, the other accused, came to India in 2023 on a medical visa."

On Thursday afternoon, a Nigerian woman, identified as Stella Pius, died after allegedly jumping from the fourth floor of the building when the raid was being carried out. An officer said, "When the police team entered her flat, Stella allegedly jumped from

the balcony. She was immediately shifted to the government hospital in Burari, where she was declared brought dead," the officer said.

Officers said the embassy has been informed about her death and the post-mortem examination will be conducted once the approval is received.

Police said they are conducting a comprehensive investigation into the unit, including a parallel financial probe to trace the money trail and identify all individuals linked to the operation. Investigating teams are also working to establish the source of the chemicals and determine how they were procured.

"Preliminary findings suggest that this may be part of a larger drug trafficking network operating in the city. All angles are being examined, and further action will be taken based on the evidence that emerges during the investigation," the DCP said.

Shri Narendra Modi
Hon'ble Prime Minister of India
& President, CSIR

RISE
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Dr. Jitendra Singh
Hon'ble Union Minister of State (I/C) for Science and Technology and Earth Science,
Minister of State in the PMO, Personnel, Public Grievances & Pensions,
Department of Atomic Energy, Department of Space
and Vice President, CSIR



Class Act

IN HIS first trip to Delhi, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay is learnt to have met senior ministers with respect and humility. During his meeting with Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, he is learnt to have praised her and said Tamil Nadu feels proud that a Tamil woman handles the Central government's finances. Only after that, did he take out a note from his pocket to list a few demands, but then immediately requested the minister if he could get his officials in.

Friends First

IT WAS a nostalgic and memorable occasion for Comptroller and Auditor General of India K Sanjay Murthy as he attended the felicitation ceremony of CCCC National Cryptic Crossword Contest 14.0. The event was presided over by his batchmate and Bihar RERA Chairman Vivek Kumar Singh, a former IAS officer of the Bihar cadre. The gathering rekindled old memories, as Murthy and Singh belong to the same 1989 batch of the Indian Administrative Service. Over the past two decades, Singh has played a pioneering role in promoting cryptic crossword competitions in schools and nurturing a crossword community in the country.

Planning of cities should be for the people: Minister

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 12

THE BRICS Urbanisation Forum concluded in Delhi on Friday, with the adoption of a declaration on inclusive, sustainable and liveable cities, Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal said. Addressing a press conference, the Minister said the BRICS countries had accepted India's proposal to set up a BRICS Urban Research and Knowledge Network. Speaking about the deliberations, he said: "Urban development cannot be limited to just infrastructure, but it starts with our people. The planning of cities should be for the people." Lal said the member nations also recognised the need for stronger local authorities and organisations, and the growing role of digital innovation in improving governance, planning and citizen-centred services. While this was the fourth BRICS Urbanisation Forum hosted by India, it was the first time that the participants were ministerial-level dignitaries.

TMC unravels, Naveen goes all out to shore up BJD

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, June 12

AS THE TMC unravels following its debacle in the West Bengal Assembly elections, Biju Janata Dal (BJD) president Naveen Patnaik in neighbouring Odisha has intensified efforts to put his house in order. In an unusual move, Patnaik, 79, held a nearly three-hour long deliberations with the BJD's losing candidates of the 2024 Assembly and Lok Sabha elections to firm up the party's roadmap for revival. Amid questions over the BJD's future due to various factors — including Patnaik's age, his health issues, and the defection of a slew of leaders to the ruling BJP — Patnaik convened the meeting in Bhubaneswar Wednesday — his first such exercise

Rebel TMC MPs ready plan, look to meet Speaker Monday

Manoj CG
New Delhi, June 12

CLAIMING TO have secured the support of 19 of the Trinamool Congress (TMC)'s 28 Lok Sabha MPs, the rebel party MPs are likely to meet Speaker Om Birla on Monday to urge him to recognise them as a separate bloc and allow them to sit alongside the MPs of the ruling BJP-led NDA in the House.

The dissident TMC MPs would urge Speaker Birla to recognise them as the "real TMC", Cooch Behar MP Jagadish Chandra Barma Basunia, one of the rebel MPs, told *The Indian Express* on Friday.

He said their faction wants senior party MP Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar to be recognised as its leader in the Lok Sabha and Satabdi Roy as the deputy leader.

Basunia said West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari would be in Delhi Sunday, when he would hold a meeting with the TMC rebel MPs. Their bid to extend support to the NDA will further boost the BJP in Parliament, neutralising the challenge from the third-largest Opposition party in the House.

The TMC is imploding in the wake of its debacle in the Assembly elections last month.



TMC office operating from official house of MP Partha Bhowmick seen locked and bereft of party posters in New Delhi Friday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

TMC chief Mamata Banerjee seems to have effectively lost control of her Legislature Party after about 60 of the party's 80 MLAs formed a separate bloc and elected Ritabrata Banerjee as their leader. An encore in the Lok Sabha would mean a split in the TMC's Parliamentary Party as well.

Basunia told the Express that while 19 party MPs have backed the rebel faction so far, their "door is open for any other MP who wants to come". He added: "We want to be recognised as the real TMC, we want to sit separately, and we want to be part of the NDA."

He said that the rebel MPs have decided to chart a separate course because of the "high-

handedness" of Abhishek Banerjee, the party national general secretary and Mamata's nephew.

"Everything was fine when Mamata Banerjee was in control of the TMC. When the leadership went into the hands of Abhishek Banerjee, the party became some sort of a corporate entity. He treats leaders and workers like servants. Everyone is angry, be it MLAs or MPs. You have seen that three of the Rajya Sabha party MPs have quit already. He is not accessible, so everyone is angry."

On why the MPs want to align with the NDA, Basunia said: "People have elected all of us to be MPs till 2029. In Bengal, the BJP has won. The BJP is al-

ready at the Centre. If we want to take up some developmental work in our constituencies, we need the support of the BJP. We are responsible to the people who elected us. We decided to form a faction so that we can do something for the people."

Asked whether the dissident TMC MPs and MLAs would approach the Election Commission (EC) to seek recognition of their faction as the "real TMC", Basunia said they would urge the Speaker to recognise them as a separate bloc first and then they will approach the EC. "*Avashya jayenge* (will definitely approach the EC)," he said.

Meanwhile, senior TMC MP and Mamata loyalist Kalyan Banerjee skipped a daily meeting she held at her Kalighat residence in Kolkata Friday. This came a day after Kalyan said that Mamata must choose between Abhishek and her trusted party leaders who are "unhappy" with him.

Another veteran TMC leader and Mamata lieutenant, Anubrata Mondal, the former Birbhongstrongman, also reportedly hit out at Abhishek, blaming him for the party's plight. He also held the political consultancy firm I-PAC for the TMC's poll defeat.

FIR against Mamata over 'provocative remarks' during poll campaign

Sweetie Kumari
Kolkata, June 12

AN FIR was registered against former West Bengal Chief Minister and TMC supremo Mamata Banerjee for allegedly making provocative remarks during the last Assembly election campaign, a senior officer said on Friday.

According to police, the FIR was registered at the Hare Street Police Station on the basis of a complaint filed by Tushar Kanti Das, a resident of Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose Road at the Netaji Nagar Police Station on May 20. The complainant also sought legal action against Banerjee.

It was alleged that Banerjee had made a comment regarding a specific community, without naming it, where she claimed that if a particular community unites, they would lead to chaos, police said.

The case was initially registered as a "zero FIR", and was transferred to the Hare Street Police Station as the place where the TMC supremo had allegedly made the comments comes under its jurisdiction, police said.

"The complainant claimed that even though no community was mentioned by name, the comment could disrupt communal harmony. The complainant also claimed that Banerjee's comment was responsible for several incidents of post-poll violence and communal unrest in Kolkata and its adjacent areas. Based on this complaint, the Hare Street Police Station has taken action and registered a zero FIR," said an officer.

'When people like Saayoni turn, who do you trust? ... it is very upsetting'

Ravik Bhattacharya
& Premankur Biswas
Kolkata, June 12

IN A WIDE-RANGING interview with *The Indian Express*, Trinamool Congress (TMC) MP Mahua Moitra weighs in on the rebellion by her parliamentary colleagues and party MLAs in West Bengal, why she is "hurt" by her fellow MP Saayoni Ghosh, and the party's future. Excerpts:

The TMC appears to have completely collapsed within a month of losing power in West Bengal as MPs and MLAs desert the party in droves. How did it come to this situation?

One, greed and treachery have no limits. Second, the BJP was desperate since the drubbing on the floor of the Lok Sabha (during the debate on delimitation legislation in April), when they did not get the two-thirds majority... by hook or by crook, they want to get another 40-50 MPs... they want to do it through *jod-tod* (breaking parties).

They have three things at their command. They have their agencies, which create fear and intimidation. Second, they will make sure nobody touches you, nobody can do business with you. They're spreading the myth that the public is angry with Trinamool. The TMC got 2.6 crore votes and the BJP 2.9 crore votes. The difference was only 30 lakh and 30 lakh voters are under adjudication. They're trying to do what we call in Bengali, '*ek ghore kore dewa* (ostracise)'.

Can the rebels claim to be the 'real TMC'?

They want to choose the Leader of Opposition (LoP) in Bengal. So, Suwendu Adhikari will be CM and the LoP. This is a new system of democracy.

In the Lok Sabha, all of us were elected because of Mamata Banerjee. Till a month ago, Kakoli (rebel MP Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar) and Satabadi (Roy) campaigned for our candidates. There is not one ounce of uncertainty about who the party is. The party is Mamata Banerjee. Everything is good about Mamata di, but she is extremely emotional and forgiving. But you are fighting a party like the BJP that is neither emotional nor forgiving. They are ruthless. Then we should also become ruthless. Loyalty has no price for them.

The law is clear in Subhash Desai versus the Principal Secretary of Maharashtra that you cannot create a faction or a bloc.



MAHUA MOITRA
TRINAMOL CONGRESS MP

You have to have two-thirds of the legislature party and merge with the BJP. Let all of these people merge with the BJP. Let them resign and seek a mandate on BJP tickets.

The trigger in West Bengal was the alleged signature forgery in the letter declaring Sovandeb Chattopadhyay as the LoP. Did a mistake occur?

If the 60 MLAs who rebelled had such a big problem with Abhishek or Mamata di, they should have done what Suwendu (Adhikari) did. He realised he would not be able to become the number two in the party and so moved to the BJP. In 2021, he defeated Mamata di, fought for the next five years and is now the CM. You can like him, or you can hate him, but there is nothing wrong with that model.

If these people (rebels) hated Abhishek and Mamata di, they could have refused to contest on Mamata Banerjee's ticket. But they did not have the guts. If you are 60, apply for the symbol now. You can be Trinamool either if you have the symbol or if you have the leader. You don't have the leader; you have the symbol.

Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, who is leading the rebellion among the MPs, says she was pained at the way she was removed as Chief Whip, despite a 40-year relationship with Mamata Banerjee.

You live in Barasat, which is supposed to be the heart of the crime syndicate... What were you doing with your eyes shut?

You are calling up people and saying, 'Bhupender Yadav wants to meet you.' (Narendra Modi wants to meet you.' That's why they're going with you. If you call and say, 'I, Kakoli, want to meet you', then nobody is going to come to you.

What did you make of the meeting of Mamata and Abhishek Banerjee with the Congress?

Why Eknath Shinde may feel ripple effects of TMC rebellion

Vallabh Ozarkar
Mumbai, June 12

THE REBELLION within the Trinamool Congress (TMC) in West Bengal could have consequences far beyond the state's borders as it threatens to dilute the parliamentary leverage that Shiv Sena chief and Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde retained within the NDA even after the BJP's sweeping victory in the 2024 Maharashtra Assembly election.

After the 2024 Lok Sabha elections, the Sena, with seven MPs, emerged as the NDA's fourth-largest constituent of the alliance after the Telugu Desam Party (TDP) and JD(U). At a time when the BJP had fallen short of a majority on its own, Shinde's MPs gave him influence that extended beyond Maharashtra.

The 2024 Assembly elections dramatically altered the BJP-Sena equation. The BJP won 132 seats — more than double the Sena's tally of 57 — and reclaimed the Chief Minister's post with Devendra Fadnavis at the helm, while Shinde became Deputy Chief Minister.

With the BJP no longer dependent on the Sena for political survival in Maharashtra as it also enjoys the support of 41 MLAs of the Sunetra Pawar-led NCP, Shinde's principal bargaining



With an uneasy relationship in Maharashtra, Shinde's 7 MPs had greater political value

chip increasingly lay in Delhi. It is this leverage that could now come under pressure.

A rebel bloc of around 20 TMC MPs backing the NDA would provide the BJP with an additional source of parliamentary support. While the BJP may not immediately require those numbers to sustain the government, the availability of an alternative bloc would reduce its dependence on existing allies and, consequently, their negotiating power.

For Fadnavis, the Bengal rebellion could bring an indirect political advantage. A BJP less dependent on allies in Parliament is also likely to be less constrained by them in state-level power equations.

Shinde's own rise was made possible by a rebellion within a

I was not in that room; so, I don't know what transpired. But with recent happenings — see what happened to Meenakshi Natarajan in Madhya Pradesh and what they have done with seven AAP MPs in the Rajya Sabha — the INDIA alliance parties should put their egos aside. It is a question of survival. The combined mandate of the Opposition is more than that of the BJP. It's just a question of getting together and fighting one-to-one. Otherwise, we're all dead.

What is the TMC's future?

Merit and hard work matter, but loyalty is important. Some things have really hurt me. Saayoni (Ghosh) is like my child, like my sister...

Maybe it's a combination of fear and other things... Because I can vouch that she's not a disloyal, profiteering person... Look at what the party has given her in only five years... When people like that do that (think of jumping ship), it's very, very upsetting...

What will Mahua Moitra do next?

No party is perfect; my party is not. But as a platform to fight the fascist forces, this is the best option for me. I will stick to it...

Shouldn't the party have acted against corrupt leaders before the elections?

I agree. But like I said, when a person like Saayoni does a volte-face, who do you trust? Akhruzzaman (rebel MLA) was with me in the High Court filing the Bakrid petition (against cattle slaughter rules)... What do you do when people lie blatantly on your face?

Everyone who's gone has got something to hide. Had they gone over for the love of Modi, they should have been like Kangana. Kangana says, 'I love Modi.' There's nothing wrong with that. What have these people gone for? Love for Modi, whom they hated for so long?

You and Kalyan Banerjee had a public fallout last year. But you're still in a party where he's the Chief Whip. Are you okay with that?

I have the greatest respect for the courage and loyalty he is showing... During the difficult days, I will accept anything from you, but when the good times return, we may fight; no problem. Today, I am very much in line with Kalyan Banerjee and we are working together.

regional party that strengthened the BJP both in Maharashtra and at the Centre. "The Maharashtra model" created a new ally for the BJP while weakening a regional rival. Now, a similar rebellion in another regional party could produce the opposite effect for Shinde himself.

The importance of the Sena's seven MPs extended beyond arithmetic. After the 2024 Lok Sabha elections reduced the BJP to 240 seats, every NDA ally acquired greater significance in Parliament. The Shinde-led Sena supported several politically significant initiatives of the Modi government, including the Waqf (Amendment) Bill and the One Nation, One Election proposal. The support of Sena's MPs contributed to the NDA's parliamentary strength and reinforced Shinde's standing as the head of one of the alliance's key partners.

The relationship between Shinde and Fadnavis has been marked by uneasy coexistence since the 2022 split in the undivided Shiv Sena. Although the BJP backed Shinde as CM after the rebellion, tensions over power-sharing never fully disappeared. The relationship became even more unequal after the 2024 Assembly election.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Model arrested at Mumbai airport with 11.8 kg of hydroponic weed

Express News Service
Mumbai, June 12

THE AIR Intelligence Unit (AIU) of the Customs Department arrested a 29-year-old woman who is a model at Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport for allegedly carrying 11.824 kg of hydroponic weed valued at Rs 11.82 crore in the illicit market. The woman came from Bangkok, officials said.

The suspect, Harsha Sunny, arrived at the Mumbai airport from Bangkok on a Thai Airways flight at around 4 am on June 11. "She is a model, and had travelled to Bangkok a week ago for work related meetings. During her stay, she frequently visited a restaurant for dinner where she befriended an Indian national. The man requested her to carry gifts and chocolates for his family members in Mumbai. She was unaware of the alleged contraband concealed in the package," said defence advocate Prabhakar Tiwari.

According to the customs of official, based on Advance Passenger Information System profiling, officers of AIU intercepted her and conducted her personal search but no contraband was found. Subsequently, Customs officers examined her baggage. During an inspection of the checked-in trolley bag, AIU officials discovered 12 vacuum-sealed packets concealed inside with a green-coloured substance. The substance was checked, and it was confirmed to be hydroponic marijuana.

UP woman jumps into river to end life during mock drill, rescued

Shruti Gupta
Lucknow, June 12

A JOINT mock drill for flood preparedness in Bahraich turned real as relief personnel rescued a woman who had jumped into Ghagra river in a bid to end her life. Upon her rescue, it was found she had jumped into the river from Sanjay Setu after allegedly being harassed by her husband and in-laws. A case was filed against the accused.

The joint mock drill was being held by the Bahraich Disaster Management Committee and local police teams on the banks of the river on Thursday, to prepare for flood and disaster response situations ahead of monsoon. Around noon, they spotted something floating in the river. The rescue personnel recognised it was a woman, and divers rushed to her rescue.

(The writer is an intern with The Indian Express)

Content of national importance in I&B's draft rules for TV, radio

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, June 12

TV CHANNELS should air 30 minutes of content daily between 6 am and 11 pm on themes of national importance, private FM stations should broadcast at least an hour of programme of "social relevance", and appointments of key managerial personnel should be made after security clearance: These are some of the draft rules the Information & Broadcasting (I&B) ministry has published for the telecommunications sector.

The draft Telecommunications (TV, Radio and Associated Services) Rules, 2026, consolidate various existing guidelines governing television, radio, and related services, replacing the regulatory framework that operated under the Telegraph Act of 1885. Stakeholders have been invited to submit comments on the draft rules by July 27.

The proposed rules will cover television channels, Direct-to-Home (DTH) services, Head-end-in-the-Sky (HITS) platforms, teleport, private FM radio, community radio stations, news agencies supplying footage to TV, and Internet Protocol TV (IPTV) services under the Telecommunications Act, 2023.

El Niño emerges in Pacific Ocean, to intensify during SW monsoon: IMD

Anjali Marar
Bengaluru, June 12

THE EL NIÑO phenomenon in the equatorial Pacific Ocean, which influences weather patterns worldwide, including the Indian monsoon, has developed, the India Meteorological Department said on Friday. It is expected to strengthen further during the southwest monsoon season, the IMD said in its El Niño Southern Oscillation (ENSO) bulletin.

El Niño, during which the surface waters of the equatorial Pacific Ocean, off the north-western coast of South America gets unusually warm, is known to suppress rainfall over the Indian region, besides causing a variety of impacts on global weather events. It is because of this El Niño that IMD has forecast a below-normal rainfall for the ongoing monsoon season.

The IMD declaration came a day after the emergence of El Niño was made public by the US-based National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA). "El Niño would peak during the November-January period," NOAA had said in its monthly ENSO bulletin. NOAA has predicted the El Niño strength to reach its peak and touch the 'very strong' category during November-January 2027. "Very strong" El Niño is cate-



Fire Brigade personnel participate in a rescue drill at Girgaon Chowpatty as part of preparations to tackle emergencies during monsoon, in Mumbai on Friday. PTI

gories and alternating phases. When the temperature in one of the regions along the equatorial Pacific Ocean region, known as a Niño 3.4 region, surpasses 0.50°C, an El Niño is declared.

"El Niño developed over the past month (May), as confirmed by the above-average sea surface temperatures across the central to eastern equatorial Pacific Ocean. The latest weekly Niño 3.4 index value was +0.7 degree Celsius," NOAA said. The temperatures along other regions of the equatorial Pacific Ocean measured +0.7°C and +2.1°C along the easternmost region.

The IMD, similarly, noted a

surge in the sea surface temperatures along both the Bay of Bengal and the Arabian Sea during May. "In comparison to sea surface temperatures recorded in April, positive (above normal) temperatures were predominantly evident along the eastern Indian Ocean, northern Arabian Sea and northern Bay of Bengal during May," the IMD said.

Like El Niño in the Pacific Ocean, India is also affected by its Indian Ocean counterpart, known as the Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD). This, too, has three phases: positive, neutral and negative. The IMD said that during the southwest monsoon season, IOD would continue to remain in the neutral phase. This phase commenced in early 2026 and is expected to remain so for most part of the year.

Since an episode of El Niño can last anywhere between a few months to up to two years, the peak of El Niño generally coincides with the winter season along the northern hemisphere. Over India, many El Niño years in the past have seen subdued monsoon rainfall and extreme temperatures. This year, the IMD has forecast below-average rainfall during the ongoing southwest monsoon season mainly due to El Niño. The country-wide seasonal rainfall is expected to be 10 per cent short of normal. Except northeastern India, all other geographical regions of India will receive below normal rain during June-September. Climatologically, during El Niño years, northeast and extreme southern India receive normal rain while the rest of the country suffers below-normal rain. Due to subdued rain, the monsoon season may also see a spike in temperatures.

INQUIRY COMMISSION REPORT NOW MISSING, CASE REGISTERED THIS WEEK

Probe panel chief: Report on 2008 killing of VHP leader in Kandhamal 'mentioned conversion, Naxal activity'

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, June 12

THE REPORT of the Justice A S Naidu Commission, which probed the circumstances surrounding the killing of Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) leader Laxmanananda Saraswati and four of his disciples in Odisha's Kandhamal district in August 2008, contained references to religious conversion among several factors that contributed to social tensions in the region, Justice Naidu told *The Indian Express*.

The two-volume report, running over 1,500 pages, was submitted to the Odisha government in December 2016. The commission examined around 300 witnesses and received 825 affidavits during the course of its inquiry. The alleged disappearance of the report from the Chief Minister's Office during the transition of power in June 2024, when the current BJP government took over from the previous BJP regime, had triggered



Laxmanananda Saraswati's killing in August 2008 led to communal violence in Kandhamal in which 39 people were killed. FILE

a political controversy, and a case was registered based on a complaint filed by the state government. This week, the Bhubaneswar-Cuttack Police Commissionerate initiated an investigation into the case.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Justice (ret'd) A S Naidu, who headed the one-member

commission, said the report referred to religious conversions among tribal and Scheduled Caste communities as one of the factors behind social tensions in Kandhamal.

"Religious conversion was only one of the issues examined by the commission. The report also dealt with Naxal activities,

social stigma, socio-economic issues, geographical isolation of tribal communities and disputes relating to the issuance of Scheduled Caste certificates," Naidu said. The commission was tasked with throwing light on the circumstances that led to the killing of the VHP leader. Justice Naidu said the commission had highlighted "systemic failures" and made recommendations to the government to prevent similar incidents in future.

Laxmanananda Saraswati, who was 84 when he was killed, had been working in Kandhamal since the late 1960s and had established an ashram at Chakapada. The killing triggered large-scale communal violence in the district, leaving at least 39 people dead. A sessions court in Kandhamal in October 2013 convicted eight people in the VHP leader's murder case, including Maoist leader P Rama Rao alias Uday, and sentenced them to rigorous imprisonment for life.

Justice Sarat Chandra Mohapatra was initially appointed

to head the inquiry into the circumstances that led to the killing, but Justice Naidu took over after Mohapatra's death in 2012.

As part of the current investigation into the alleged disappearance of Justice Naidu's probe report, sources said a special police team visited the state secretariat and recorded statements of officials. Police Commissioner S Dev Datta Singh said investigators were collecting evidence to determine when the reports went missing, who was responsible for their custody and whether there was any motive behind their disappearance. The issue has also sparked a political row. Odisha Revenue Minister Suresh Pujari accused the previous BJD government of "intentionally" making the reports disappear to conceal administrative lapses.

BJD leader Munna Khan questioned why the matter is being raised nearly two years later and alleged a political motive behind the BJP government's action.

• BRIEFLY



Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan with delegates of the BRICS nations at Mandu Fort near Indore on Friday. PTI

MADHYA PRADESH

At BRICS meet, Chouhan bats for joint push on food security

UNION AGRICULTURE and Farmers Welfare Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Friday called upon BRICS nations to work together to empower small and marginal cultivators, ensure food security and promote sustainable agricultural development. He stressed that challenges confronting the agriculture sector, including climate change and growing pressure on natural resources, could be effectively addressed only through collective efforts. "If small farmers become stronger, global food security will automatically become stronger," he said at the meeting being held under India's presidency of the grouping. Chouhan was chairing the inaugural session of a two-day meeting of agriculture ministers of BRICS countries in Indore. PTI

Asaram's bail extension plea in HC withdrawn

SELF-STYLED GODMAN Asaram Babu on Friday withdrew his plea before the Gujarat HC seeking an extension of temporary bail, nearly seven months after he was first released in November 2025 after his sentence was suspended for six months. A division bench of Justices Gita Gopi and LS Pirzada was told by Asaram's advocates that he wished to withdraw the plea. "Under instructions, I may be permitted to withdraw the application for extension of temporary bail," the counsel submitted. ENS

Noida man held for Kannur student's death

THE CRIME branch, which is probing the alleged suicide of a first-year BDS student of Kannur National College, has arrested a Uttar Pradesh native who allegedly worked as a telecaller for an illegal loan app firm, officials said on Friday. The accused, Saurav Kumar, 24, is a Noida resident. Nithin Raj from Thiruvananthapuram had died on April 10 after falling from a building on the college campus. Kumar had repeatedly contacted Raj in his capacity as a telecaller, demanding repayment of the loan. PTI

Four sites on Nicobar west coast identified for coral translocation, says Zoological Survey

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, June 12

CORAL COLONIES and giant clams that will be impacted due to the work on the transshipment port proposed at Galathea Bay as part of the Great Nicobar Island (GNI) mega project will be translocated to four sites on the west coast of the islands, the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) has said.

ZSI informed this to the committee overseeing the implementation of biodiversity-related issues as part of the project's environmental management plan during its fourth meeting, held on November 7, according to its minutes made public by the Andaman and Nicobar Island Integrated Development Corporation Ltd (ANIIDCO) on June 10.

The minutes stated that ZSI has identified "four new translocation sites on the west coast of Great Nicobar Islands and (will) undertake the translocation of coral colonies and Giant Clams from the project impact area as per EC (Environmental Clearance) and CRZ (Coastal Regulation Zone) clearance conditions prior to the commencement of project works". Systematic data on "translocated colonies with GPS tags to each colony to monitor its survival" will be maintained, it added.

The biodiversity-related committee has been formed in compliance with the specific conditions laid down by the Environment Ministry while granting EC to the project. This committee is tasked with overseeing wildlife conservation plans and actions to mitigate the project's impact on the endemic Nicobar Megapode, leatherback marine turtles, saltwater crocodiles, Nicobar Macaque, Robber Crab, coral translocation, and other birds found only on the island.

Two other committees, on pollution-related measures and to oversee welfare issues related to Shompen and Nicobarese

tribal communities, have also been formed. At the time of the project's appraisal for EC, as well as during the challenge against the project before the National Green Tribunal (NGT), ZSI had submitted it would translocate 16,150 coral colonies from the peninsular part of Galathea Bay.

While the Centre has maintained that no corals are found on the eastern flank of Galathea Bay, which is the site of the transshipment port, this claim was contested before the NGT. The government's maps and reports on the Island Coastal Regulation Zone (ICRZ) Plan were relied upon to show the presence of corals in the project area, and argue that their translocation is not a permissible activity under law.

However, the NGT, in its February 16 order this year, ruled that the ICRZ Notification, 2019, was not violated and directed the Centre to protect coral reefs along the coastal stretch, in compliance with the specific conditions laid down in the project's EC. ZSI also said in the November 7 meeting that it will obtain approvals under the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972, before handling Schedule-I species, such as coral colonies and giant clams.

Meanwhile, the Wildlife Institute of India, which has been entrusted with the conservation of Nicobar Megapode and Leatherback Turtles, said during the meeting that a survey had found 141 leatherback turtle nests. It did not specify the survey period. The committee's biodiversity expert, Deepak Apte, suggested that satellite tagging of turtles should be prioritised to track their movements before the commencement of project work.

The Salim Ali Centre for Ornithology and Natural History informed the monitoring committee that a pilot survey of endemic and tree-cavity-nesting birds has been completed in GNI, while another on Coconut Crabs is currently in progress.

Cong attacks Governors over BJP event attendance in Jaipur

Express News Service
Jaipur, June 12

THE CONGRESS has accused the Rajasthan and Gujarat Governors of impropriety after the two attended a BJP Kisan Morcha event in Jaipur, terming it a "murder of democracy". Rajasthan Governor Haribhau Bagade and Gujarat Governor Acharya Devvrat were present at the 'Natural Farming Workshop' organised by the BJP Kisan Morcha at Jaipur's Sawai Mansingh Indoor Stadium on Friday.

Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma, his deputy Prem Chand Bairwa, Union MoS for Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Bhagirath Choudhary, BJP state president Madan Rathore, BJP state General Secretary (Organisation) Ajaya Kumar and Kisan Morcha state president Kailash Choudhary were among those present on the occasion.

Congress state president Govind Singh Dotasra said that the presence of the Rajasthan and Gujarat Governors at the BJP's political event "raises serious questions about constitutional propriety and impartiality". "Governors are impartial custodians of the Constitution, not promoters of any political party. Using constitutional offices in this manner at a BJP political



Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma with Governors of Rajasthan and Gujarat Haribhau Bagde and Acharya Devvrat, respectively, at the 'Natural Farming Workshop' in Jaipur on Friday. ROHIT JAIN PARAS

event is nothing short of murdering democracy," he said.

Dotasra also questioned why Rajasthan Agriculture Minister Kirodi Lal Meena was not invited to the event. "The government should explain if there was such seriousness about farmers' interests, why was he kept away?" He asked whether the government has distanced itself from Meena "after crores of corruption came to light under the guise of raids".

Days ago, the ACB had lodged an FIR and arrested Rajasthan State Seeds Corporation director Jugal Kishore and others for allegedly extorting money in lieu of facilitating the return of seized seed stock.

"Is the Governor the custodian of the Constitution or BJP's programme in-charge? The oath for a constitutional position is taken in allegiance to the Constitution, not to any political party," Congress general secretary Jaswant Gurjar said.

BJP spokesperson and former MLA Ramlal Sharma said the event was a public awareness programme. "It was organised by Kisan Morcha, but it's a worldwide issue concerning nature. In such a scenario, we have to return to our traditional knowledge systems when it comes to agriculture, and decrease our dependence on chemical fertilisers," he said.

SC junks Natarajan plea over RS paper rejection: ‘Election petition is remedy’

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, June 12

THE SUPREME Court Friday dismissed Congress leader Meenakshi Natarajan's challenge to the rejection of her Rajya Sabha nomination from Madhya Pradesh, and granted her the liberty to file an election petition.

Natarajan's nomination papers were rejected on June 9 by the Rajya Sabha election returning officer who, after receiving a complaint from the BJP, ruled that she submitted an incomplete affidavit in Form 26 and "concealed material facts" relating to a case registered against her in Telangana. On Thursday, all three BJP candidates were declared elected unopposed from Madhya Pradesh.

Stating it was not inclined to entertain Natarajan's plea, the bench of Justices P.K. Mishra and A.S. Chandurkar cited the law laid down in the 1952 judgement in N.P. Ponnuswami vs. Returning Officer, that the appropriate

remedy in election matters was an election petition.

"The principles laid down in Ponnuswami has been followed by this court in all election-related disputes whenever an attempt is made to invoke this court's or the high court's writ jurisdiction to interject during the process of conduct of election and on every occasion, this court has rejected such an attempt keeping in view the principle contained in Article 329 (b) of the Constitution of India," it said.

According to Article 329 (b), no election to either House of Parliament or to the House or either House of the state Assembly will be called in question except by an election petition presented to such authority and in such manner as may be provided for by or under any law made by the appropriate legislature.

The bench said the arguments of Senior Advocate Abhishek Manu Singhvi, who appeared for Natarajan, that "in a



Meenakshi Natarajan was the party's RS candidate from MP

case of this nature where rejection of nominations is glaring and manifest, this court must step in to cure the defect, otherwise the very sanctity of the election process would be affected, cannot be accepted in view of the law laid down in Ponnuswami."

"If this court accepts such an argument to find out glaring cases which are required to be interfered with under Article 32 or 226 of the Constitution of India and the other set of cases in which the rejection is not so improper prima facie, relegating them to avail the remedy of an

election petition, this court would be reading some principle which is not provided for under Article 329. We are afraid that any such interpretation that in some of the matters this court can entertain a petition wherein a candidate's nomination paper has been rejected, while leaving some others to avail the remedy of the election tribunal, should not be encouraged," it said.

"In view of the above, we are not inclined to entertain this petition under Article 32 of the Constitution of India, which fails and is hereby dismissed," the bench said, adding that Natarajan can avail the remedy of an election petition should she wish to.

Challenging the returning officer's decision, Singhvi had argued that Section 33A of The Representation of the People Act required only those cases to be disclosed in which charges had been framed.

He contended that only a notice had been issued to Natarajan

under Section 223 of BNS in what was essentially a private complaint, and the court had not yet taken cognizance of the complaint.

"The order passed by the RO is bizarre. If there is no cognizance, there is no case in the eye of law. Even if there is cognizance, I have to disclose after charges are framed. This is rank injustice," Singhvi said. "In this way a level playing field can be made non-level, then there cannot be any election in this country," he said.

Senior Advocate Mukul Rohatgi and Advocate Kanu Agarwal, appearing for the three BJP candidates who were elected unopposed, and Senior Advocate D.S. Naidu, representing the Election Commission, said details of all cases had to be disclosed, not just those in which charges had been framed.

Article 329, Rohatgi said, barred judicial interference in electoral matters once the election process had commenced.

CMs of BJP-ruled states hail 12 years of transformation of country under PM Modi

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, June 12

THE BHARATIYA Janata Party on Friday organised media interactions across the country to highlight the transformation the country has witnessed during the 12 years of the Narendra Modi government.

Chief ministers of BJP-ruled states addressed the media, hailing the policies of the PM and contrasting his stint with those of his predecessors.

Modi on Wednesday became the longest-serving elected Prime Minister of India in his third consecutive term, breaking the record of 4,398-day tenure of the first Prime Minister, Jawaharlal Nehru.

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said Modi was "not only the longest serving, but the finest serving" PM of India, who enhanced the country's stature globally and brought a "360-degree transformation".



UP CM Yogi Adityanath in Lucknow on Friday. PTI

accounts, construction of toilets under the Swachh Bharat Mission, housing for the underprivileged, Ayushman Bharat health insurance and programmes such as Mudra, Stand-Up India, Start-Up India and Digital India.

"For the first time, the country has seen not only planning but also effective implementation by taking all stakeholders along and turning programmes into mass movements," he said.

In Patna, Bihar CM Samrat Choudhary said under PM Modi's leadership, India has become the world's fourth-largest economy. "When Modi announced demonetisation in 2016, the entire nation stood behind him. During the COVID-19 pandemic, people across the country heeded his advice to stay indoors during the lockdown. Now, amid another global crisis triggered by the war in West Asia, people trust Modi's ability to steer the country through the situation," said Choudhary.

Congratulating Modi on the milestone of becoming the country's longest-serving prime minister, Choudhary said, "New India is confidently establishing its identity on every global platform. Under his leadership, India has leapfrogged from the

11th-largest economy in the world to the fourth-largest."

Gujarat CM Bhupendra Patel said multiple initiatives, flagship projects, and good governance measures introduced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi over the last 12 years must be leveraged to build a developed India. He expressed confidence that driven by people's trust and support, the successful track record of Modi's good governance will continue to receive the backing of the nation's 140 crore citizens in the years to come.

In Dehradun, Uttarakhand CM Pushkar Singh Dhami said 12 years of Modi government was dedicated to public welfare, good governance and the upliftment of the poor. Addressing the media, Dhami extended his greetings to the PM on behalf of the people of Uttarakhand, wishing him a long and healthy life. He said while the Congress kept raising slogans to eradicate poverty for decades, the Modi government successfully lifted 25 crore people out of poverty.

Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini at an event in Chandigarh said the 12 years of the Narendra Modi government have been marked by trust, development, good governance, and public welfare, asserting that India has entered a new era under the prime minister's leadership.

Anyone trying to disrupt NEET retest to face full might of law: Govt

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 12

THE FULL might and weight of the law will fall on any person trying in any manner to distort, disrupt or tamper with the integrity or smooth conduct of the NEET-UG retest, Cabinet Secretary T.V. Somanathan said on Friday.

Somanathan reviewed the preparation for the NEET retest, which is scheduled for June 21. In his meeting with the National Testing Agency (NTA) Director General Abhishek Singh, Somanathan focused on the secure and smooth conduct of the retest, and noted that the Centre, state governments and district administrations are working closely to hold the retest.

Ahead of the retest, Somanathan has also held review meetings with secretaries of the Central government, and chief secretaries of the states to assess arrangements.

Sources said the focus is on a whole-of-government approach to ensure that the retest is conducted without a hitch.

Centre seeks 2-layer CRPF, CISF cover for NEET re-exam

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, June 12

AHEAD OF the NEET-UG 2026 re-examination on June 21, the Centre has sought deployment of a two-layer security cover involving CRPF and CISF personnel to secure the transportation and handling of confidential examination material, including question papers and OMR answer sheets.

The material will be moved from origin hubs in Hyderabad and Ahmedabad to around 551 hub cities across the country through a hub-and-spoke network using both air and road routes, an official said.

"As per the deployment plan, security arrangements for the movement of question papers are to remain in place from June 11 to June 19, while deployment for the return movement of OMR sheets and other exam material will be required from the evening of June 21," the official added.

The central armed police forces were roped in after the

NTA director requested the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) for additional security. "The MHA informed that a two-tier security arrangement was required, particularly for the transportation and handling of exam material. CRPF and CISF personnel have now been asked to provide the second layer of security at hubs, airports, helipads and other critical locations, besides accompanying consignments on aircraft and helicopters operating across different hub levels," the official said.

Personnel carrying service weapons during air travel have been asked to deposit them before boarding, in accordance with IAF security procedures, and have them returned at the destination airport. "The CRPF and CISF headquarters have been asked to nominate a nodal officer for coordination with the Department of Posts and the NTA, while state-wise single points of contact are also to be designated for coordination with postal and field units," the official added.



Destination Dhaka

India's new High Commissioner to Bangladesh Dinesh Trivedi enters the neighbouring country through the Petrapole-Benapole land border. He was accompanied by his wife, Mrinal. "Nice to be here," Trivedi said as he was received by senior Bangladeshi and Indian High Commission officials.

European weapons used against India: Jaishankar

Press Trust of India
Helsinki, June 12

EUROPEAN COUNTRIES sell weapons that are used against India, but New Delhi has never done anything to endanger Europe's security, External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar has said.

His sharp remarks came in response to a question on India allegedly adopting a "morally ambiguous" position on the Russia-Ukraine war during an interactive session held in Finland on Thursday.

Speaking at the Kultaranta Talks, the minister also said the US had "specifically" asked India to buy Russian oil to stabilise the global energy market after the outbreak of the Ukraine conflict in 2022. "No European



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar participates in a discussion with Finland Foreign Minister Elina Valtonen and UAE Assistant Foreign Minister Lana Nusseibeh in Helsinki. ANI

country has been attacked with Indian weapons. I wish I could say that for European weapons vis-a-vis India. So keep that in mind," Jaishankar said.

"Europeans sell weapons which are used to attack India. Not now. For many, many years,"

he said in an apparent reference to the long-standing supply of military equipment by several European countries to Pakistan.

"We Indians have never done anything to endanger Europe," Jaishankar added.

Defending India's energy ties

with Moscow, Jaishankar said New Delhi did not buy a significant amount of Russian oil before 2022 and turned to the Russian market only after the Ukraine conflict disrupted global energy supplies.

"When we started, we didn't buy a significant amount of Russian oil until 2022. Circumstances compelled us to get into that market," he said.

The minister said Russia had been a reliable supplier at a time when energy markets were under severe strain and India, like other countries, purchased oil based on price and availability. Recalling the situation following the outbreak of the Russia-Ukraine war, Jaishankar said the US had encouraged India to purchase Russian crude to help

prevent turmoil in global energy markets. "At that time, the US specifically asked India to buy Russian oil to stabilise the world markets," he said. The external affairs minister also criticised the US' double standards and its "on-and-off" sanctions on Russian oil.

"After having first put tariffs on us last year for buying Russian oil, the US then again lifted its sanctions on Russian oil. So let's not pretend that there is some great principle involved here.

"If it is on, off, on, off, and do it when it suits us and don't do it when it doesn't suit us... We are all adults in the room. We know what the game is. So I don't think making this about sanctimony is really warranted," he said.

From KG to PG, Odisha announces 'free and universal' education

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, June 12

STUDENTS TAKING admission in government colleges and universities in Odisha will no longer have to pay fees, with the state government announcing that education will be "free and universal".

Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi Friday announced free education from kindergarten to postgraduate level ("KG to PG") as the BJP government completed two years in office.

"Probably Odisha is the first state in the country to make such a provision in the education sector. It will immensely benefit the scholars especially the economically backward section," Majhi said. Officials said the decision is likely to benefit more than 10 lakh students.

Education up to Class 10 is already free in Odisha. The new measure is expected to help students who struggle to pursue higher education because of financial constraints.

While fees in government colleges and universities are relatively low, the move will cost

the state exchequer nearly Rs 30 crore annually.

Majhi also announced that the government will appoint more than 45,000 teachers in the coming years to improve educational quality, in addition to the over 26,000 teachers recruited during the past two years.

To expand higher education capacity, he said four new universities will be set up in the state soon and budgetary provisions have already been made.

Highlighting the achievements of his two-year-old government, Majhi stressed infrastructure development as a driver of economic growth and employment generation. He cited ambitious projects including the coastal highway, two expressways connecting southern and northern Odisha, and the Bhubaneswar-Cuttack-Puri-Paradip Economic Region (BCPPER).

Responding to opposition criticism over the law-and-order situation, Majhi said concerns were "more political in nature". "There is no crime where the accused has not faced action," he said.

TCS employee dies by suicide, FIR against two women staff

Pune: A 48-year-old TCS employee died by suicide at his residence in Bhosari area of Pimpri Chinchwad due to alleged harassment caused by two women colleagues and a man not linked to the company.

Police identified the victim as Amit Abhay Bramhe. His 19-year-old son lodged the FIR at the Bhosari police station on June 9.

As per the FIR, Bramhe worked with TCS in Hinjewadi. Before he died by suicide at his home around 4 pm on June 2, he left a suicide note in which he blamed the two TCS staffers and another man, according to the FIR.

The police booked the three under Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) sections 108 (abetment of suicide), 3 (5).

Senior police inspector Sandip Ghorpade of Bhosari police station said, "We have initiated a probe in this case. We have issued a notice to TCS authorities to investigate the two accused women."

Ghorpade added that a search was underway for the third accused. **ENS**

‘If I close my eyes, can see those bodies... hope not to witness such a scene again’

Parimal A Dabhi
Ahmedabad, June 12

ON THE first anniversary of the crash of Air India AI171 flight in Ahmedabad on Friday, even as the BJ Medical College paid homage to the 260 persons – including four of their resident doctors – some of the doctors who narrowly escaped or survived the accident shared their experiences.

The college attached to Ahmedabad Civil Hospital organised a programme to pay tributes to the crash victims.

Anand Khasatiya (28), a student of MD Microbiology, told *The Indian Express* that before having lunch, he went to the hostel room along with his roommate Danish Dave when he heard an "extremely loud" sound.

"We wondered if it was a plane crash or what? Then within seconds, it crashed into



Outside the hostel buildings that were struck during the plane crash, in Ahmedabad on Friday. BHUPENDRA RANA

our building. We heard something was passing by (our building) and then the crash. The bed on which we were sitting started trembling... Then we came to the hall (of the IBHK accommodation), and by then smoke had started seeping inside," Khasatiya said.

Khasatiya and his friend then went to the ground floor.

"There was so much fire and smoke that we could not see anything clearly. When we came out, some vehicles there had caught fire. And then we were trying to leave the place through a safe passage and on the way we found a security man who was sitting on the ground floor on a chair. His hands and hair were burning,

We brought him to a safe place," Khasatiya said.

Another medical student, Bhagirath Chavda (22), had a close call when he had just left the mess building after lunch minutes before the crash.

Chavda, a final year MBBS student, said, "I had just finished my lunch and was going to my hostel... when I heard the loud noise... I did not even imagine it could be a plane crash."

Vipul Ahir (29), a student of Forensic Medicine, said, "Soon after the crash, our department head had asked us all to reach the postmortem room along with our equipment." He was involved in carrying out postmortem of the dead bodies. "Even today, if I close my eyes, I can see those bodies in front of me... We do not want to see such a scene again ever," said Ahir.

Investigation still underway: AAIB

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, June 12

THE WAIT for answers to what really caused the Air India flight AI 171 to crash in Ahmedabad on June 12 last year has grown longer. The investigation into the Boeing 787-8 accident that claimed 260 lives has not concluded yet and the analysis of the gathered evidence and various tests is still on, the Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) said on Friday, the first anniversary of one of India's worst-ever aviation disasters.

The probe agency also assured that it was committed to a "thorough, independent, objective, and evidence-based" investigation, but didn't comment on when the final report would be released.

On Friday, the AAIB issued an interim statement on the progress of the probe, which is prescribed under international

“We remain committed to a thorough, objective determination of the causes of the accident and to further enhancing aviation safety.”

RAM MOHAN NAIDU,
CIVIL AVIATION MINISTER

norms if the final investigation report is not ready within a year of the accident. Shortly before the AAIB statement, Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu posted on X that the probe was still on, confirming that the final report was still elusive. According to officials in the know, the final report may take a few months more. Complex air crash investigations can, in some cases, take years.

"Over the past year, the investigation team has under-

taken an extensive and rigorous examination of all relevant technical, operational, organisational and human factors associated with the accident. This effort has been supported by accredited representatives, technical advisers and subject matter experts from relevant organisations. Significant progress has been made in the examination and analysis of aircraft systems, flight data recorder, engine-related components, maintenance and operational records, and other evidence relevant to the investigation," the AAIB said.

"The evidence gathered and the results of various examinations are currently being analysed in a comprehensive and integrated manner. Additional technical evaluations and specialist examinations, wherever considered necessary, will continue to be undertaken to ensure that all findings and conclusions are supported by verified evidence and sound scientific analysis...", it added.

According to the agency, the final report will be released upon "completion of all investigative activities and the requisite international review and consultation processes prescribed under" International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO) Annex 13, but did not provide a timeline for the final report. ICAO Annex 13 lists international standards and recommended practices for aircraft accident investigations.

"Today, as we mark one year since the tragic Air India Flight AI-171 accident, we remember with profound sorrow those who lost their lives and extend our heartfelt condolences to their families and loved ones. The investigation continues with diligence and professionalism in accordance with established national and international procedures. We remain committed to a thorough and objective determination of the causes of the accident and to further enhancing aviation safety," Naidu posted on X.

One year after AI 171 crash, questions persist

JUNE 12 marked the first anniversary of the Air India flight AI 171 crash, which claimed 260 lives in Ahmedabad: 241 of the 242 people on board and 19 on the ground. Under international aviation norms, the final investigation report into an air disaster should be made public “as soon as possible and, if possible, within 12 months”. While this timeline is not legally binding, it seems that India’s Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) will need more time to release its final findings about the Boeing 787 Dreamliner that crashed. At the same time, the information in the public domain, particularly the preliminary report released on July 12 last year, raises concerns about the handling of the case.

The first concern relates to the manner in which the AAIB released its preliminary report: At 1 am, unsigned, and without a press briefing at which questions could be addressed. The second pertains to the report’s content. It had only a single paraphrased exchange between the pilots regarding the fuel switches, rather than the full cockpit voice recorder transcript or audio. The limited information released and the questions left unanswered have fuelled speculation of pilot error. Meanwhile, Boeing and the 787 Dreamliner programme have faced recurring technical concerns, including lithium-ion battery failures, fuselage manufacturing defects, and electrical system problems. A US-based aviation safety advocacy group, citing whistleblower testimony submitted to the US Senate, alleged that the aircraft involved in the Ahmedabad crash had experienced multiple technical issues during its service life. Against this backdrop, the concerns raised by the Federation of Indian Pilots — selective disclosure of information, the apparent absence of key subject-matter experts from the investigation and an inadequate examination of a possible electrical or systems failure — deserve serious attention.

For the victims and their families, a rigorous and transparent investigation is the minimum that justice demands. Four families have filed lawsuits against Boeing and aircraft-parts manufacturer Honeywell, alleging negligence, while the father of one of the pilots has sought a court-monitored inquiry. These developments speak of erosion of confidence in the investigative process. Restoring that trust must be a priority. AAIB’s interim statement on Friday said the final report will be released “upon completion of all investigative activities”. The Civil Aviation Minister, too, has posted on X that the investigation continues. Every authority involved should ensure that no line of inquiry is left unexplored and no legitimate question goes unanswered. Establishing the truth about AI 171 is essential not only for accountability but also for aviation safety and public confidence. Until the final report is released, conclusions must remain guided by evidence, not conjecture.

Amid rising inflation, vigilance holds the key

IN RECENT weeks, there has been much concern over the direction of inflation in the economy and the implications for monetary policy. Last week, when the Monetary Policy Committee kept interest rates unchanged, the RBI pegged inflation at 5.1 per cent for the year, up from its earlier assessment of 4.6 per cent. For the first quarter, it had projected 4.2 per cent. The latest data from the National Statistics Offices show that while retail inflation edged slightly upwards to 3.93 per cent in May, from 3.48 per cent in April, it was marginally lower than expectations. This also puts inflation in the quarter so far at 3.7 per cent, slightly lower than the central bank’s expectation.

Food inflation rose to 4.78 per cent, up from 4.2 per cent the month before, with tomatoes and ginger seeing a sharp surge. With weak rainfall delaying kharif planting, the outlook in this category is uncertain. In the non-food category, the rise in energy prices at the retail level (petrol, diesel, commercial LPG cylinders) seems to be reflecting in transportation — of goods and personal vehicles — and restaurants. Energy price adjustments are continuing — recently, domestic LPG prices were raised by Rs 29. Prices of other key inputs are expected to continue feeding inflationary pressures, while supply-chain and energy disruptions pose upside risks. Household inflation expectations are also firming up, with three-month and one-year-ahead expectations rising by 80 basis points and 50 basis points respectively.

The global environment continues to be in flux. On Thursday, the European Central Bank raised interest rates by 25 basis points amid concerns that the energy shock is beginning to spill over into the larger economy. Other central banks — the US Federal Reserve and the Bank of England — are scheduled to hold meetings next week. In the US, consumer prices rose at an annual rate of 4.2 per cent, complicating matters for the new Fed chair. The MPC’s next meeting will be in August. By then, there will probably be some indication of the flows being mopped up through the FCNR (B) route. Another month of price data will also be available, and there will be some clarity over the underlying growth momentum. These will shape the MPC’s decision.

A champion shooter, a master mentor

INDIAN SHOOTING has produced Olympic champions, world champions and celebrated coaches. But there was only one Jaspal Rana — outspoken, occasionally controversial, often brilliant and always deeply invested in the sport. Rana, who died on Friday, was a champion long before Olympic medals made shooting a national obsession. He won an Asian Games gold in 1994, and over the next decade, his cabinet would be brimming with medals. He couldn’t win an Olympic medal because his pet event, centre-fire pistol, wasn’t in the Olympics.

After his competitive career ended, Rana became the junior India coach, shaping a generation of shooters and helping lay the foundations for India’s rise as a global power in the sport. In a sport increasingly shaped by technology, analytics and specialised support teams, Rana remained a believer in fundamentals. He was uncompromising on discipline and hard work — these traits helped Manu Bhaker become the first Indian athlete to win two medals at the Paris Olympics.

Rana didn’t shy away from demanding answers. When the GST was introduced, and shooting equipment was put in a high tax bracket, he spoke up for the shooters. Officialdom didn’t always take his views kindly. They blamed his “negative influence” for the poor show at the Tokyo Olympics. Three years later, in Paris as Bhaker’s coach, he was vindicated. For three decades, Indian shooting could count on one certainty: Jaspal Rana would have an opinion, and he would not hesitate to share it. More often than not, the sport was better for it.

The summer of ’86, and a World Cup in a different world

GROWING UP next to an all-purpose sports facility — the epicentre of our young lives in Rajkot’s railway colony in the 1980s — we had our own football heroes. There was Rafiq Baloch, a strapping Siddi boy, with tree-trunk legs. Parsotam, endearingly called Pasiyo, was a fearless defender with goal-scoring ambitions. And the delightful Ahmed, a compulsive dribbler, loved dodging goalkeepers and tapping the ball in the goal.

They all played for our team — the modestly named Jagiwan Ram Railway Institute. We rarely won the local league since other sides from outside our township — Young Challengers Club and Youth Club — were more consistent but less watchable. For context, we were Rajkot’s Liverpool.

Back in the day, our exposure to the world of football was primarily through the written word. Englishman Brian Glanville, the finest football writer ever, was our guide. He took us to iconic stadiums around the world, informed us about the ball skills of greats and sparked our young minds to imagine what they did on fields oceans away. His beautifully crafted, impressively authoritative articles regularly appeared in *Sportstar*, that sporting bible of our youth. We would rub our cheeks against its glossy pages for that soothing, smooth feel before devouring the magazine from cover to cover.

Once in a while, if it was our lucky day, the Films Division-produced Newsreel that used to be shown before movies in theatres would feature a few seconds-long video clips of international football. It was a wink-and-miss

sporting opportunity that came your way in dark cinema halls with un-cushioned wooden seats. To say that we, nestled in our comfortable cocoon, were cut off from the world would be factual — not an attempt to romanticise remoteness.

And then it all happened during that magical summer of 1986 when footballing greats, and even a God, graced our living room every night. We had watched Ravi Shastri drive his team mates in an Audi at MCG a year back but that was not at our home. Watching live sports from your own couch was new to us. As far as eye-openers go, Mexico ’86 was epic — it burnt new, permanent footballing images into our retinas, rewriting the old ones.

Poor Baloch, Pasiyo and Ahmed, they were pushed out of our mind space by Maradona, Sócrates, Platini, Zico, Lineker, Laudrup... the list was unending. To date, Mexico ’86 is counted as the most memorable and eventful of World Cups. Hand of God, greatest goal ever, heartbreaking results and that thrilling climax where Valdano latched on to Maradona’s measured through-ball to break the 2-2 deadlock in the final against Germany. As the Argentines hugged Maradona, the world, including the recent converts from Rajkot, wanted to jump into the television to be part of the happy huddle.

Our colony’s first tryst with top-level football was delightful and also insightful. It gave a chance to witness how national teams build fanbases in distant lands. How those uninitiated into international



SANDEEP DWIVEDI

The big sporting spectacle has commenced in Mexico. Still, nothing can replace the Summer of '86, nor can there be a return to that age of innocence

Too much capital adds to Air India’s turbulence



SATYENDRA PANDEY

MOST CORPORATE turn-arounds have similar themes. New ownership, an injection of capital, rightsizing, capex, product-revitalisation, and for the successful ones — profitability. Just four years ago, with the transition from being a Public Sector Undertaking (PSU) to new ownership under the Tata Group, Air India was supposed to be that story. However, it has been anything but.

The airline continues to incur severe losses, its reputation requires repair, and as we mark the first anniversary of the horrific Ahmedabad crash of Air India Flight 171, where 241 people on board and 19 on the ground lost their lives, there are more questions than answers.

All this while, Air India continues to struggle with culture, cash flow, and credibility. The elephant in the room is that Air India moved from a situation of constrained capital to abundant capital. But too much capital can be a curse. Because too much capital can inadvertently amplify challenges, and at scale. And capital creates a false sense of security, which then has consequent impacts.

The numbers speak for themselves: A loss in excess of \$2 billion; an estimated 22 per cent-plus cut in capacity; and a wide variation in net promoter scores highlight a consistently inconsistent product. For those looking beyond the numbers, the signals are many. But those calling them out are few and far between. The fact that the airline is not able to turn a profit in a duopoly market where it holds significant advantages is very telling.

What makes the Air India situation even more compelling is that the airline’s success is not only important for the airline and the Tata Group but also for India’s broader ambitions. For one, strategic autonomy essentially includes air connectivity as a core pillar. To this end, the country has asserted itself by not revisiting air service bilateral agreements, a position that will be untenable without a strong global airline.

Second, Air India’s success will demonstrate that PSUs can be privatised and deliver a profit to the benefit of the exchequer and all citizens. Then there is the element of jobs across the skill spectrum, where a large, successful airline can be a strong catalyst. Finally, a successful global airline provides

the fillip towards building an aviation hub to challenge those in the Middle East and Southeast Asia, thereby leveraging the Indian demographic dividend and the premiumisation wave.

Air India’s goals by March 2027 as part of its transformation plan highlight targets for fleet growth, market share, brand identity, innovation, and being a preferred employer. But what needs to be put front and centre is the customer in every way possible. Yes, the Indian consumer is demanding, yes, aviation is an exacting business, and yes, the returns on capital for airlines are very hard to deliver. But these are facts to be worked with. Not challenges to be glossed over. And doing this requires hard decisions that align the airline with the market reality.

Going forward, the flight path for Air India is anything but smooth. Elements of its strategy, such as the ultra-long-haul flights, engineering challenges, and overall talent strategy, require a rethink. The airline has to deliver consistency, not excuses, and the consumer has to be front and centre. There are no easy answers. Buying and financing aircraft with the backing of the Tata Group was the easy part; delivering a competitive cost structure, consistent product and service, and operational excellence is an order of magnitude more difficult.

There is an aviation adage that goes: “The three things that are of no use are the runway behind you, the altitude above you, and the fuel still in the truck.” For Air India, the focus has to be here and now. The past, the vision, and the impending product upgrades are not items that will move the needle. Similarly, market share, compliance, and seniority cannot outrank safety, consistency and reliability. A consumer cannot be taken for granted, especially in the international segment, where there are many options. As such, the first goal for the airline is to enter consumers’ consideration sets.

The good news is that Air India finds itself in the right market at the right time and with a strong parent company with patient capital. But it has to be backed up with strategic intent and executive capital. One year after the crash, no Air India executive has held an official, in-person press conference to brief the public or answer questions about it.

The writer is managing partner at AT-TV, an aviation finance firm

football in our neighbourhood picked the teams they would be backing for the World Cup, and the rest of their life, was a story that would have inspired R K Narayan. These were simple folk, with no skin in the game, feeling obliged to connect with the mesmerising men, from different countries and cultures, playing the Beautiful Game.

Late one night, the grandfather of a close friend announced to the family, sitting together watching their first World Cup, that Germany was to be the team they would support. Starting as a cobbler mending shoes on the footpath of a busy road, the highly respected patriarch had gone on to own a few imposing footwear shops in the city’s tony area. His proclamation had come minutes after the commentator had read the German playing XI, starting with their goalkeeper Toni Schumacher. “See, like us, the German goalkeeper too is a shoemaker. So, henceforth, Germany is our team,” he said.

Not far from where we stayed lived the Joshis. In the dead of night, they pledged their alliance to Brazil. That was after the World Cup’s most entertaining team had beaten Poland, where their right-back Josimar had scored a stunning pile-driver from outside the D. Next morning, as word spread about Joshi’s allegiance, our locality’s certified funny man overwrote Mr Joshi’s nameplate outside his home. It was now reading Joshimar, with the “mar” addition done sloppily with a black sketch pen.

Our milkman would become a

● WORDLY WISE
You cannot escape the responsibility of tomorrow by evading it today.
— Abraham Lincoln

huge Michael Laudrup fan as he was from Denmark, a country he knew was big on livestock and dairy products. England, too, had a few fans. The presence of many Gujara-rica, was a factor. The English fans loathed Maradona when he first cheated and later humiliated them in that Hand of God game. But they were a minority; Argentina and Maradona ruled most hearts.

For our small group, the hero was the Brazilian, Sócrates. He was tall, lanky, outspoken and an underdog. He was a reflection of a certain Angry Young Man, a popular silver-screen character of that image. Sócrates was a doctor who smoked like a chimney and drank like a fish. He had a casual air about himself even in high-pressure situations. Sócrates conducted himself in a crucial World Cup game like a father playing ball with his child in a park. The good doctor answered the biggest question of our teenage lives: What was cool?

Four decades after our baptism by the roaring Mexico fire, the World Cup has come full circle. The big sporting spectacle has commenced in Mexico. Still, nothing can replace the Summer of ’86, nor can there be a return to that age of innocence. This is the age of excessive information and data mining. Nothing is left to the imagination. The joy of connecting with strangers on a gut feeling is over. “Oh, when I look back now ... Those were the best days of my life.” That Summer of ’86.

The writer is national sports editor, The Indian Express.

Where there were phuchkas, there are now bulldozers



MADHURITA GOSWAMI

2008. DUMDUM Junction. I made a friend with whom I shared my daily train commute to college. Our friendship grew over plates of phuchka outside the adjoining Metro’s ticket counters, persuading hawkers to add more of the fiery green chilli extract to the potato filling. From 2008 to 2011, I travelled daily from Agarpara to St Xavier’s College on Park Street, changing from the local train to the Metro at Dumdum. At the end of last month, vendors were evicted from the railway land at Dumdum. Stores were dismantled overnight as part of an anti-encroachment drive earlier undertaken at the Howrah and Sealdah stations. Bulldozers brought down roughly 500 stalls at Dumdum, leaving hawkers who had been operating from the railway premises for decades in despair. So far, the government has not announced any policy for their resettlement.

For students like us, who travelled from the outskirts to the city, these hawkers were a lifeline. After long classes, we looked forward to their phuchkas, jhalmuri — recently hailed by the Prime Minister himself — egg rolls, chips, cold drinks and other inexpensive fare. Not just students, the hawkers at Dumdum also sustained daily-wage labourers and other workers with modest incomes. My friend and I often stopped at the phuchka stalls on our way home. Regulars were given preference, and if one of them drifted over to another stall, a mock-combative exchange would break out among the hawkers. We had settled on Raja Kaku’s phuchka. He would boast that nobody ever got sick after eating at his cart. “I do not use red chillies. The green chillies do not upset stomachs,” he told us.

When the hawkers were evicted from Dumdum station, people protested. But against the police and the infamous bulldozers, they were no match. Reading about it miles away from the city, I felt disturbed at my inability to do anything. The displaced vendors have been hitting the streets, demanding an alternative venue for their stalls. I also wondered what the new generation of students taking the train will look forward to.

As of now, the question of the hawkers’ resettlement looms large. The nostalgia of people like me who grew up benefitting from what they dished out in minutes is a secondary concern. But as prices rise, I wonder what will happen to this hawker-driven economy that didn’t let many of us go hungry. The hawkers did not just sell food. At stations — among the most democratic public places — they were the fabric that briefly held people together in their shared love of food, irrespective of background. They were central to an ecosystem of sellers and buyers, Biharis and Bengalis, Muslims and Hindus, men, women, and those of other gender identities, standing shoulder to shoulder, waiting for their turn to dig into small but filling dollops of pure joy.

Undoubtedly, Kolkata’s famous street food culture hinges on the daily labour of hawkers. At their carts, people gather not only to eat but also to discuss politics, or daily experiences, in what’s a melting pot of ideas that contributes to an evolving social consciousness. I still visit phuchka stalls when I go back home and ask for more heat, more salt, and a phau — a free dry shell to end with. From the vendors’ end, a phau, though a small gesture, symbolises a kind of unique generosity from those with little to spare.

The writer is senior assistant editor, The Indian Express. madhurita.goswami@expressindia.com

40 YEARS AGO

June 13, 1986



Punjab-Haryana land dispute

THE TRANSFER of Chandigarh to Punjab and Hindi-speaking areas in lieu of the city to Haryana on June 21, as announced by the government, depends upon a settlement between the chief ministers of the two states. The Venkataramiah Commission has awarded 70,000 acres of land to Haryana in lieu of Chandigarh. But the commission has not identified the areas and has instead suggested either the appointment of another commission to determine these or a settlement between the two states.

France offers high technology

FRANCE OFFERED to transfer high technol-

ogy to India without any pre-condition. The offer was made during 30 minutes of talks, covering a wide range of subjects between the French PM, Jacques Chirac, and the Vice-President, R Venkataraman. The areas covered during the talks included transfer of technology, trade relations between India and France, the situation in Sri Lanka and holding of the French festival in India.

Hegde’s word satisfies Chavan

THE MAHARASHTRA Chief Minister, S B Chavan, said that his Karnataka counterpart, Ramakrishna Hegde, had made it clear to him that there would be no compulsory introduction of Kannada in primary schools in the bilingual boundary region of the state. He said

during his talks with Hegde, the latter offered to show him the government circular on the issue and had promised that his government would not do anything unconstitutional.

SALT is dead: US

THE WHITE House declared the SALT-2 strategic arms treaty dead and said any future decisions on arms reduction made by the United States would be based on “Soviet behaviour” in key areas. The presidential spokesman, Larry Speakes, told reporters, “SALT is dead. The SALT treaty no longer exists.” His statement appeared aimed at clarifying remarks in which he softened the US position on the unratified 1979 Strategic Arms Limitation Treaty.



Much more than unity, Opposition needs a paradigm shift in its politics



DESHKAAL
BY YOGENDRA YADAV

THE MEETING of the INDIA bloc on June 8 reminded us of the exigency of our times: The Opposition needs a reset. Not the kind debated over the last few days. We don't need personalised blame games. Or a tired parade of loyalty. We don't need to search for nirvana in every small opening. Or to drum up a conspiracy behind every opportunity. We need an Opposition that is at once positive and energetic, imaginative and proactive.

Yes, we need a unity of the Opposition. But more than that, we need a renewal of the Opposition.

We need it now, more than ever before. Our republic could be facing the capture of democracy by seemingly democratic means. Constitutionally mandated democratic options are fast receding. Yet, a crack has opened at this moment of consolidation of total power. Loktantra offers a narrow but real opening: The simmering pot of lok has begun to bubble, just as the lid of tantra has been sealed tight. The future is unpredictable and uncharted. It is too early to judge how prepared the INDIA coalition is to face this challenge. This contradictory moment casts a historic responsibility on the Opposition. It calls for the highest form of integrity, statesmanship and political judgement.

The politics of opposition needs a paradigm shift that goes beyond electoral competition, from a politics of regaining state power to a politics of reclaiming the republic. This requires a radical shift in approach — redefining the Opposition, rethinking Opposition unity, and reimagining what it means to do oppositional politics. This demands recognising an operational shift in the site of politics to ground mobilisation at the grassroots.

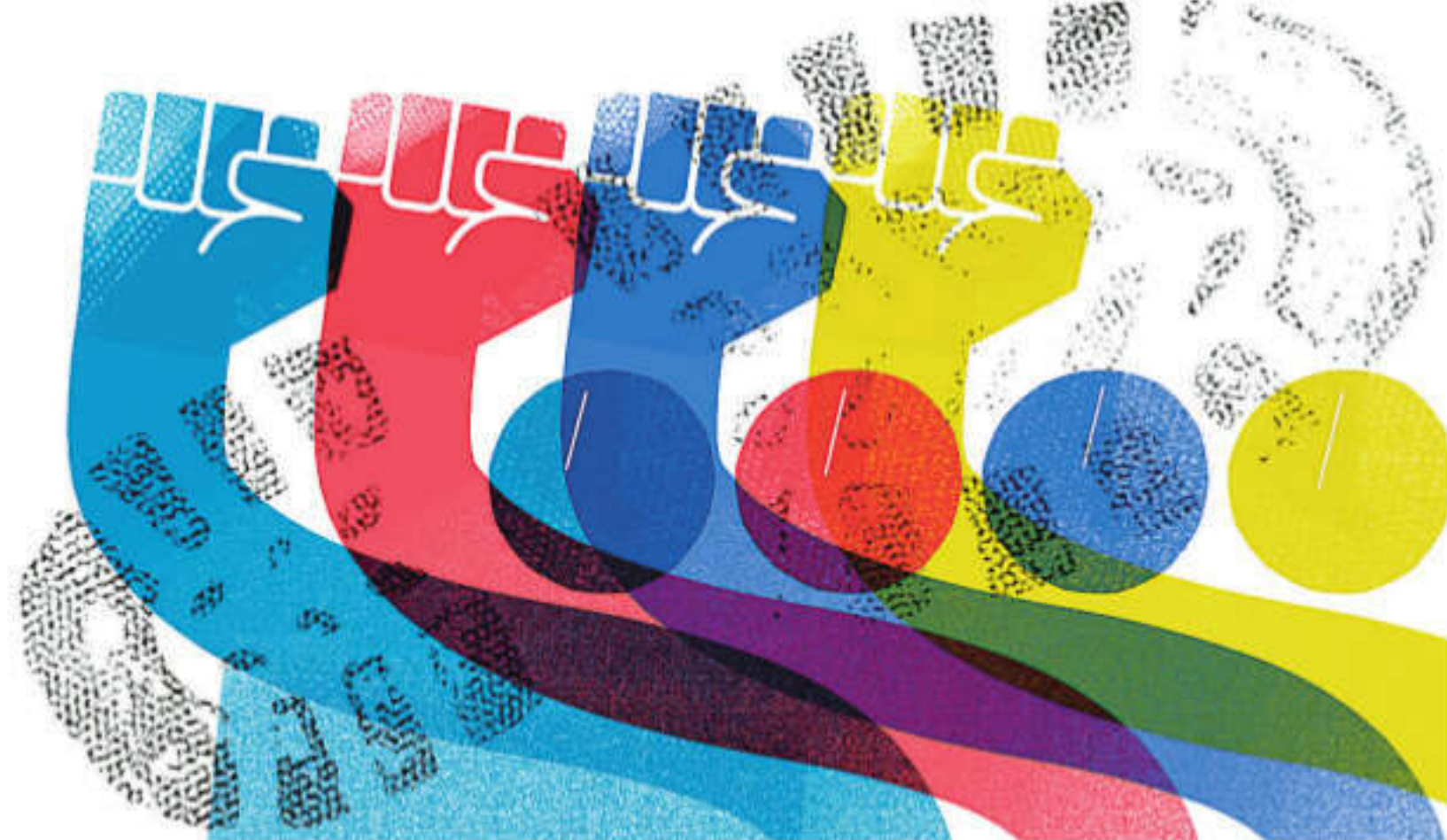


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

The first step in that direction is of course the reinvigoration of the INDIA bloc comprising the major Opposition parties. A challenge to this regime has to begin with the existing Opposition and its existing leadership. It is pointless to debate the merits or otherwise of this leader or that, unless there is a viable alternative on the horizon. The formation of the INDIA coalition was a big step forward towards checking the BJP in the run-up to the 2024 elections. It has been a downhill journey since then.

The BJP's staggering victories in the state assembly elections, followed by wrecking of the opposition parties with the help of state machinery, have contributed to falling morale in the opposition camp, accentuated by some self-inflicted wounds. A meeting of INDIA leaders was thus long overdue. This has resulted in the easing of some avoidable internal tensions. The promise of regular meetings and daily parliamentary coordination is a step in the right direction. But the action plan announced after the meeting is clearly not sufficient. The opposition must build on its suc-

When the people are on the street expressing their anger against the government, the Opposition must treat this as an opportunity. It needs to build networks of critical proximity and not firewalls of suspicion with all such protests

cess in blocking the Delimitation Bill and evolve a strategy to check the dismantling of constitutional institutions.

This needs a meaningful connect with the opposition outside the INDIA bloc. The country is witnessing innumerable popular protests and peoples' struggles. Some of these are led by peoples' organisations of long standing that are ideologically opposed to the BJP-RSS. These include trade unions, farmers' organisations and rights-based campaigns. Some of the more energetic ones are community-based movements — of Adivasis, Dalits, OBCs, nomadic communities and minorities — that may not be ideologically oriented. And then there are issue-based protests and struggles — against land acquisition, paper leaks, or corruption, for example — that may not be opposed to BJP rule as such. The challenge of building oppositional politics is not to filter these expressions of opposition for ideological purity or political correctness but to string them together effectively.

This could help define the Opposition's approach to the "Cock-

roach Janta Party". It is a very powerful and innovative expression of the youth unrest brewing in the country. No more and no less. It is naive to build messianic hopes of political redemption on this fledgling outfit. And it is self-defeating to turn one's back to youth protest due to some imagined conspiracies. When the people are on the street expressing their disquiet and anger against the government, the Opposition must treat this as an opportunity, not as a threat. The Opposition needs to build networks of critical proximity and not firewalls of suspicion with all such protests.

The renewal of the Opposition cannot stop at bringing together all existing energies. It must involve reimagining the politics of opposition. First of all, opposition cannot be limited to a critique of the government, however pressing and valid. The country deserves to know the agenda of the INDIA coalition. A full manifesto can wait. But some flagship ideas and proposals need to be placed in the public domain. Second, its communication must not remain limited to press conferences, parliamentary speeches and statements. Peaceful and non-violent street protests, used by opposition parties of late, are more effective modes of popular communication.

Third, the languages of communication need to shift from abstract constitutionalism to ones with cultural and emotional connect. For this, the Opposition needs to draw upon the rich legacy of Indian nationalism, our religious traditions and the multiple strands of cultural heritage embedded in our civilisation.

Finally, the grammar of oppositional politics needs a radical shift. Factual refutation, logical critique and rational arguments are the bedrock of opposition to the empire of lies spawned by the ruling establishment. Yet memes, pranks, cartoons and satire are among the most effective tools of communication in abnormal times. History tells us that the bubble of authoritarian regimes bursts just when they think their domination is total. Provided there is someone ready to puncture it.

The writer is member, Swaraj India, and national convenor, Bharat Jodo Abhiyaan. Views are personal

Indian industry is at a crossroads. It needs to look at longer horizons



V ANANTHA NAGESWARAN

THE FIRST part of this article traced four structural roots of India's chronic underinvestment in research and development. Apart from them, two further explanations remain — one chronological, one generational — before the case for a different calculus.

The fifth explanation is chronological. The last 15 years have been among the most volatile in living memory. The financial crisis of 2008, the Eurozone debt crises through 2015, India's own balance-sheet reckoning as the infrastructure boom unwound, the Covid lockdowns, the Russia-Ukraine war's supply and energy shocks, and now the Trump administration's tariff turbulence — each arrived before the last had fully receded. To ask businesses to commit to decade-long R&D programmes in such an environment is to ask them to plant orchards in a forest fire. The rational response to compounding uncertainty is to preserve optionality and defer irreversible commitments. This does not excuse the deficit in Indian R&D, it contextualises it.

A more intimate explanation sits alongside the macroeconomic ones. Indian business, like business elsewhere, is predominantly a family affair. Family firms tend to follow a recognisable trajectory: The founder builds with hunger, the second generation consolidates, and by the third, the urgency has often dissipated.

Morck, Wolfenzon and Yeung, in the *Journal of Economic Literature* in 2005, documented the tendency of multigenerational control toward economic entrenchment — preserving inherited wealth rather than risking it — while Pérez-González, studying CEO successions in 2006, found performance and investment efficiency declining when a family heir took over rather than a professional. In India, this has acquired a post-pandemic inflection: The exceptional returns of financial markets have given third-generation families an effortless alternative to the capital-intensive work of manufacturing and R&D. The aggregate consequence is a quiet withdrawal of entrepreneurial energy from the domain India where most needs it.

Yet context, however illuminating, cannot be mistaken for exculpation. Indian industry stands at a juncture where the choice between short- and long-horizon thinking is no longer merely a matter of competitive positioning — it has become a question of strategic survival. India's ambitions for influence in a multipolar world depend on the technological and productive capabilities of its private sector. Strategic leverage in the 21st century is not purchased with diplomatic skill alone. It is underwritten by industrial capacity, by the ability to offer the world goods and services that others cannot readily replicate, and a position in global value chains that confers genuine bargaining power.

A private sector that captures domestic demand but remains technologically dependent — a consumer of intellectual property rather than a generator of it — is one whose future profitability is under slow but accumulating existential threat. As competitors from East Asia continue to climb the value chain, the space for Indian businesses that decline to invest in frontier capabilities will narrow. The business community has historically looked to the state to create conditions for prosperity. The state's obligations in this regard are not trivial. But the capacity for strategic influence is not the state's to create unilaterally. It depends on decisions taken in corporate boardrooms: About R&D budgets, talent, the willingness to absorb short-term costs in pursuit of long-run competitive advantage. National and shareholder interests converge in the long run. The private sector that fails to recognise this convergence will eventually discover it the hard way.

History, however, is not without encouragement, and the pattern of transformation is not unprecedented. Germany's *Mittelstand* — the dense ecosystem of mid-sized manufacturers with deep engineering capabilities — was forged through deliberate investment in technical education, patient capital from Hausbank relationships that insulated firms from quarterly market pressures, and a cultural commitment to *Qualität*. Japan's post-war industrial miracle rested on long-horizon corporate strategies, state-guided but privately executed investment in technological capability, and a willingness to absorb short-run losses in pursuit of competitive positions in the industries that would matter in the future. South Korea's chaebol, for all their well-documented governance imperfections, developed world-class semiconductor and shipbuilding capabilities through a willingness to invest at scale and over a duration that would have been impossible under the tyranny of the quarterly earnings cycle.

Each of these transformations was preceded by a recognition, often born of crisis, that the existing trajectory was insufficient and that the path to national prosperity ran through industrial capability, not around it. India is arguably at such a moment. The fracturing of the old globalisation, the imperative and the difficulty of supply-chain diversification away from China, the unprecedented window opened by a demographic dividend that is available but will not remain so indefinitely — these are not guarantees of transformation, but conditions that make it possible. The short horizon has served Indian business reasonably well in the long era of low-hanging domestic demand. The next era will belong to those who learn, perhaps not too late, to look further.

The writer, president, India Foundation, is with the BJP

The writer is chief economic advisor, Government of India

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

R&D in India

V ANANTHA Nageswaran's analysis of India's chronic R&D underinvestment goes well beyond the usual funding-shortage explanation ('R&D underspending in India has no one cause. It's systemic as well as cultural', *IE*, June 12). The argument that India's corporate sector underwent financialisation before its industrial base matured is particularly compelling. When short-term shareholder returns are rewarded more than long-horizon investments, R&D inevitably suffers. Correcting this requires more than tax incentives — it requires rethinking executive compensation structures, capital-market expectations, and the cultural premium placed on quick returns over patient capability-building.

M Barathi, Bengaluru

Go well, maestro

BEFORE CINEMA found villages, villages rarely found cinema ('He took red soil to silver screen', *IE*, June 12.). Bharathiraja changed that lens forever when he framed dried riverbeds, palm trees, and red fields as worthy subjects, not backdrops. With *16 Vayathinile*, he shifted Tamil film grammar from studio sets to real soil, letting caste, poverty, and love speak in their own voice. He saw promise in faces others missed. His partnership with Ilaiyaraaja gave rural Tamil Nadu its soundtrack, with folk-rooted songs like 'Sendhoora Poove' still stirring hearts.

Chidanand Kumar, Bengaluru

Art and power

SUMANA ROY'S reflection on John Berger's enduring influence, and on what his framework left out, is thought-provoking ('The trees that escaped Berger's Ways of Seeing', *IE*, June 12). As climate concerns reshape how we think about our relationship with the natural world, perhaps it is time for our ways of seeing to expand to include trees, soil, and ecosystems, not merely as backdrops or resources, but as subjects with their own claims on our attention and consideration.

Swathi Senthilkumar



RAM RAJYA
BY RAM MADHAV

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi will be attending the G7 summit next week in France. India's association with the grouping began in 2003 — it was the G8 then — when Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee attended its annual meeting. His successor, Manmohan Singh, was invited to the summit five times. Modi has been attending the summit every year it has been held since 2019. India has been invited more than a dozen times to this group of the world's most industrialised nations, reflecting its growing importance in global affairs.

The US, the UK, West Germany, France, Italy, and Japan got together in 1975 to form the G6, which became the G7 a year later, in 1976, with Canada joining it. Russia joined in 1998, transforming it into the G8, until its expulsion in 2014 following the annexation of Crimea. The G8 was an influential economic power controlling over two-thirds of global GDP. But in the past two decades, the global economic landscape has transformed significantly. Countries like China, ASEAN nations, and India have emerged as new major economies. Meanwhile, the G7's share of global GDP has declined to roughly 40 per cent. However, its influence remains, given its leadership in advanced technologies, defence capabilities, green innovation, and cyber and space domains.

With stable democracies and

A defining feature of India's new vision towards Europe is the concept of the Indo-Mediterranean — an emerging geostrategic framework connecting the Indian Ocean with Europe

rapidly growing economies, the G7 has an important place in New Delhi's scheme of things. India's advancements in technology and its large pool of skilled manpower also make it more attractive. Also, under Modi's leadership, India has emerged as the leading voice of the Global South. India has strategic agreements with the seven G7 members. The EU's presence at the summit in addition to the four individual European powers makes it effectively a Europe-dominated forum.

India-Europe relations have gained significant momentum in the past decade, driven by a recalibration of the country's foreign policy under Modi. India concluded an important FTA with the EU this year. A defining feature of India's new vision towards Europe is the concept of the Indo-Mediterranean — an emerging geostrategic framework connecting the Indian Ocean with Europe. This vision gained traction in 2023, when India, as G20 chair, launched the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC).

In May this year, during his visit to Rome, Modi, together with his Italian counterpart, Giorgia Meloni, jointly penned an op-ed, writing that "we are witnessing the emergence of what might be termed the Indo-Mediterranean, an important corridor for trade, technology, energy, data and ideas tying the Indian Ocean to Europe". Historically, India maintained deep commercial and cul-

India at G7: From guest to strategic partner

tural ties with the Mediterranean and Arab worlds, trading in spices, textiles, and precious stones for centuries. The Indo-Mediterranean concept is the 21st-century version of this link.

Modi is investing heavily in achieving *atmanirbharta* — self-reliance in deep-tech and other frontier areas. India also needs massive industrialisation to address the growing employment needs of its youth. In realising those targets, Europe, with its capital and technology, will play a significant role. Modi understands this imperative, hence his efforts at engaging with various segments of the European community.

Modi also needs Europe on his side to tackle the restive Middle East. IMEC passes through the UAE and Saudi Arabia. The emerging bonhomie among Pakistan, Saudi Arabia, Turkey and Egypt could pose a challenge to that vision.

Unlike the Belt and Road Initiative, singularly spearheaded by China, the Indo-Mediterranean vision has a role for every participating nation. The Indo-Mediterranean vision could eventually give rise to an "Indo-Atlantic" strategic space as a western counterpart to the Indo-Pacific, redefining global strategic dynamics.

India's consistent presence at the G7 is not merely symbolic. It reflects its transformation from being a peripheral participant to a pivotal player in the emerging geopolitics of the world.

The writer, president, India Foundation, is with the BJP

The social contract we must renew



AVANI BANSAL

THE ANXIETIES surrounding examination irregularities, employment, farm incomes, and household finances are often discussed as distinct problems. Students protest paper leaks and recruitment delays. Young graduates worry about quality jobs. Farmers seek predictability in an increasingly uncertain environment. Families struggle with the rising costs of education, healthcare, and everyday living. But what if they are manifestations of the same underlying challenge?

For the past three decades, India's development story has been built upon a simple but powerful promise: If you work hard, ac-

quire skills, and play by the rules, you and your children will enjoy greater opportunities than the generation before you. That promise transformed India. Millions left villages for towns and cities. Families invested heavily in education. Access to schools, universities, and digital learning expanded.

This aspiration remains one of India's greatest strengths. But aspiration creates expectations. And expectations create a social contract. The anxieties we are witnessing today emerge when citizens begin to question whether the pathways to upward mobility remain as accessible and fair as they once appeared to be. Consider the recurring controversies about competitive examinations. For millions of young Indians, examinations are gateways to social mobility. Every paper leak, every recruitment delay,

and every perception of unfairness has consequences far beyond the immediate event.

Citizens do not experience the economy through growth rates alone. They experience it through their ability to find meaningful work, support their families, and build secure futures. Economic growth is essential, but growth that does not translate into broad-based opportunity creates anxiety. Similarly, farmers are not simply demanding support. Small business owners are not merely asking for incentives. They are seeking confidence about the future. Households

Do citizens still believe that hard work will be rewarded? Do they trust institutions to operate fairly?

are not only concerned about prices. They are concerned about whether tomorrow will feel more secure than today.

For years, political analysis has focussed on elections, ideology, identity, and leadership. Beneath these debates lies another set of questions: Do citizens still believe that hard work will be rewarded? Do they trust institutions to operate fairly? Do they believe their children will enjoy greater opportunities than they did? These questions may prove decisive in shaping India's next decade. The challenge is to ensure that institutions and policies keep pace with aspirations.

The priority must be to restore trust in merit. Examination systems, recruitment processes, and public institutions must be protected with the same seriousness with which we build roads, airports, and digital

infrastructure. Every major policy intervention should be evaluated through a simple lens: Will it expand access to quality jobs and economic mobility? India must focus on rebuilding economic security. People can adapt to hardships. What is far more difficult is navigating uncertainty without a sense of what lies ahead.

India's greatest long-term investment remains its people. But that demographic advantage is not automatic. It depends on education, skills, health, and the ability to convert potential into productive opportunity. For three decades, India has asked its citizens to believe that hard work expands opportunity. The next decade will determine whether that promise can be renewed.

The writer is a Supreme Court advocate



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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• HISTORY

The June 12 HC ruling that paved way for Emergency

Nikita Mohta
New Delhi, June 12

LATE On the night of June 25, 1975, President Fakhruddin Ali Ahmed, acting on the recommendation of Prime Minister Indira Gandhi, proclaimed a state of Emergency, citing threats to the nation's internal security. But the trigger, according to historians, was a June 12 judgment of the Allahabad High Court, upholding a petition that charged her with corrupt practices in her 1971 parliamentary election.

The election case

Raj Narain, the socialist leader Indira Gandhi defeated in Rae Bareilly in 1971, had challenged her victory in the Allahabad HC. Known as the 'election case', the petition alleged that Gandhi had secured her win through corrupt practices, particularly by exceeding the legal limit on campaign spending and by using government officials and state machinery for support.

On March 19, 1975, Gandhi became the first Indian PM to testify in court. She spent five hours in the witness box, answering questions about her election campaign.

Justice Jagmohan Lal Sinha dismissed 12 of the 14 charges against Gandhi. In his 238-page ruling, he upheld two findings: first, that Yashpal Kapoor, Gandhi's former private secretary, had begun functioning as her election agent before formally resigning from government. Second, officials of the Uttar Pradesh government had assisted her campaign. Justice Sinha declared Gandhi's 1971 election void and barred her from contesting elections for six years. But he also granted her 20 days to appeal before the Supreme Court.

CONDITIONAL STAY
● The SC's conditional stay said the PM could attend Parliament, but neither vote nor draw a salary until her appeal was decided.
● Justice Sinha had noted that his ruling might ultimately prove weak, since the violations were not 'graver electoral vices'.

government had assisted her campaign. Justice Sinha declared Gandhi's 1971 election void and barred her from contesting elections for six years. But he also granted her 20 days to appeal before the Supreme Court.

Reactions to the judgment

The day after the Allahabad HC verdict, Opposition leaders protested outside Rashtrapati Bhavan, demanding that the President dismiss the "corrupt" PM. Gandhi's supporters, however, moved swiftly to counter this campaign. Every day, more supporters gathered outside her house, and she came out to speak to them. She also addressed a massive rally at Delhi's Boat Club lawns.

On June 23, the SC began hearing Gandhi's appeal. The next day, Justice V R Krishna Iyer issued a conditional stay: the PM could continue to attend Parliament, but she could neither vote nor draw a salary until her appeal was decided by the full SC bench.

Some advised Gandhi to resign temporarily and allow a senior colleague, such as Jagjivan Ram, to serve as interim PM until the case was resolved. Those urging her to remain in office included her son Sanjay Gandhi and several Congress leaders.

Proclamation of Emergency

The same day, Ray helped draft an ordinance declaring a state of internal Emergency, which was promptly signed by the President. That night, the electricity supply to newspaper offices across Delhi was cut, preventing morning editions from appearing on June 26. By the next day, state-controlled radio informed the country that an Emergency had been declared and that civil liberties had been suspended.



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१ Indore	22 जून सुबह 8:00 बजे	24 June 5:30 PM
१ Lucknow	17 जून सुबह 8:00 बजे	24 June 11:30 AM
१ Prayagraj	29 जून शाम 5:30 बजे	23 June 8:00 AM
१ Ranchi	एडमिशन आरंभ	Admissions Open
१ Patna	17 जून सुबह 8:00 बजे	Admissions Open
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• ECONOMY

Amid youth protests, a snapshot of India's employment rate over this decade



GRAPHS, DATA, PERSPECTIVES
BY UDIT MISRA

WEEKLY ECONOMIC AND POLICY INSIGHTS USING DATA

IN RECENT times, stories pointing to growing youth unrest have made headlines — be it the launch of an online youth-led pressure group or 18-year-olds poring over tenders to investigate the school examination set-up. These developments shift the focus from mere economic growth to job creation. These lines by writer Mokomoka Mokhonoana could well describe a prevalent sentiment: "If heaven really exists: then heaven is the job, hell is unemployment, while life is merely an interview."

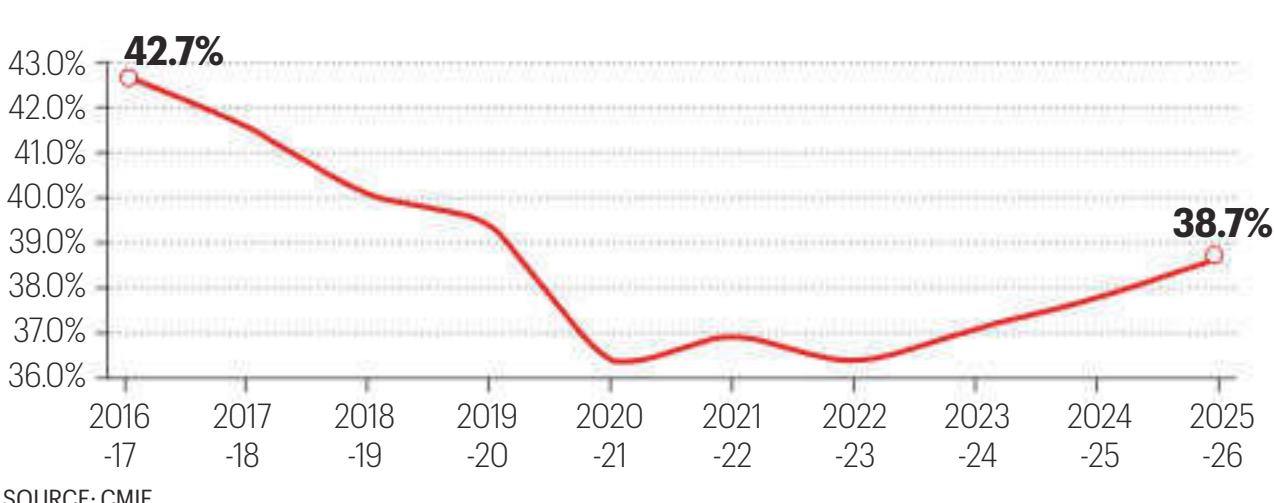
Employment data

Before getting into the subject of employment, a note on data. This explainer will use employment data from the Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy (CMIE), a leading private company.

The reason is that CMIE provides a continuous data series since 2016. The official data, released by surveys from India's Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI), have undergone many changes during this period. Until 2011-12, MoSPI released Employment-Unemployment Surveys (EUS) once every five years. In 2017-18, MoSPI replaced it with the annual Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS). The very first PLFS in 2017-18 found that unemployment had hit a 45-year high, but the government ran it down for flawed methodology. The employment rate is arguably the more important metric than the unemployment rate for India. Here is why. Imagine the total population of a country to be 100. Suppose that only 60 are above the age of 15. They constitute the workforce. Say only 50 of these 60 are looking for a job; the other 10 could include people like a 22-year-old student, or a 30-year-old who is disillusioned and has stopped looking for a job. These 50 constitute the labour force. Now, when the data shows that the unemployment rate (UER) is, say, 10%, that does not mean that only 10 people are unemployed. That's because the UER is calculated as a share of the total labour force. A 10% UER means 10% of 50, or five people who are looking for jobs but are unable to get them. If these five people also opt out of the job market, the workforce will remain 60, but the labour force will shrink from 50 to 45. The UER rate will fall to 0%, without accurately capturing the distress in the job market.

• India's employment curve

The share of working-age people (15 years and above) with a job was 42.7% in 2016-17 and it is 38.7% at the end of March 2026.



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One way out is to look at the Employment Rate (ER). This is the number of people with a job as a percentage of the total working-age population. A rising ER shows that a higher percentage of people in a particular cohort have a job, bypassing labour force size fluctuations.

• DIPLOMACY

How trust underpins India's ties with France



SHUBHAJIT ROY

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi is headed to France over the weekend for a bilateral visit as well as the G7 leaders' summit. He will be in Nice on June 13 and 14, in Evian on June 16 and 17 for the summit, and in Paris on June 17 and 18.

This is the Prime Minister's seventh official visit to France since 2014 and follows French President Emmanuel Macron's visit to India on February 17-19, when bilateral relations were elevated to a "Special Global Strategic Partnership". France is one of India's most preferred partners in Europe, and the relationship, built on strategic autonomy and respect, has been a success story over the last several decades.

The forthcoming visit is a testament to New Delhi's durable ties with Paris.

What to expect from the bilateral visit...

The key thrust of the bilateral visit will be tech and innovation.

In Nice, Modi, alongside Macron, will inaugurate the Bharat Innovates event that brings together top innovation startups from India, France and the world. More than 120 Indian companies and startups, and prominent business leaders from France and other countries, are expected to participate in the event, being held during India-France Year of Innovation.

The Prime Minister will hold a bilateral summit with President Macron in Nice, the first since the elevation of ties to a "Special Global Strategic Partnership".

On June 18 in Paris, alongside Macron, Modi will attend the VivaTech Summit, Europe's largest technology and startup event. The Vivattech Summit will host an Indian pavilion, the largest one at the summit this year.

...and the G7 summit

The West Asia conflict has set off an energy crisis shock for India and the world and put the lives of Indians living in the region at risk. The recent US attacks on ships sailing through the Strait of Hormuz have killed Indian sailors.

With US President Donald Trump at-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with French President Emmanuel Macron in Mumbai in February. X/@NARENDRAMODI

tending the G7 Summit, India has an opportunity to convey its concerns on a matter that has hit its security and economic interests.

In that context, France and Europe will be an important partner, as it is a common understanding that the continuation of the war is not in anyone's interest.

Ties defined by history...

To understand the durability of India-French ties, let's take the example of the famous French politician Jacques Chirac. In 1976, as India faced global criticism over Prime Minister Indira Gandhi's Emergency, the French Prime Minister agreed to be the chief guest at the Republic Day celebrations.

He returned as the Republic Day chief guest 22 years later, this time as President, and launched the Strategic Partnership with India. The Strategic Partnership was India's first with any Western nation, and France's first with a non-Western nation.

Just months later, in May, India conducted the Pokhran-II nuclear tests. Western powers criticised India and imposed sanctions — but France did not.

The visits are testament to French pragmatism and foresight in how it diplomati-

PM's itinerary

In Nice, Modi and Macron will inaugurate a startup event and hold a bilateral meet.

-

The PM will then head to Evian for the G7 Summit.

-

The next stop is Paris, where Modi and Macron will attend another startup and tech event.

cally managed the sensitive nature of the ties. The strongest link between the two countries, which has led to the innovation and tech partnership, is "strategic trust".

... and based on trust

Political understanding is extremely important, and that is visible at the highest levels. One of the prime examples of the leadership-level trust was displayed when India reached out to Macron at the last minute in December 2023 — after US President Joe Biden had declined the invitation for the Republic Day celebrations in January 2024. Then the Indian envoy to France reached out to Élysée Palace directly, and the French President didn't hesitate to bail out India, despite knowing fully well that he was Delhi's second choice.

The Indian Prime Minister returned the favour in 2025, when he headlined the AI summit in France.

The larger trust is on display again as India has again been invited for the G7 Summit in Evian on June 16-17. France believes that India's presence at the G7 reflects its standing as a leading voice of the Global South and a key partner in addressing shared global challenges.

Project delays

● The Rs 6,800 crore project, whose foundation stone was laid in May 2018, was expected to be completed by September 2026.
● But the Covid-19 pandemic, the 2024 terror attack on the workers at the Sonamarg tunnel, and extreme weather conditions delayed it.

The other key tunnel that keeps the Srinagar-Leh highway operational throughout the year — the Z-Morh tunnel or Sonamarg tunnel — was completed and thrown open for traffic in January last year.

What next

The Zojila tunnel project has several key

In fact, if one goes back in history, the French Presidency had invited India to participate in the G8 summit (Russia was expelled after the Crimea annexation in 2014, and the grouping became G7) for the first time ever in 2003. PM Atal Bihari Vajpayee attended the summit at the invitation of President Chirac.

France again invited India in 2019, and that was PM Modi's first G7 summit in Biarritz, France. Since then, India has been participating in the summits — this will be India's 13th participation at the G7 Summit and Prime Minister Modi's seventh consecutive participation at the meet.

A wide range of partnerships

At a time when the world has become unpredictable and volatility is the norm, trust has become a rare commodity. In the case of India and France, the strategic trust, built over years of the strategic partnership, has matured in fields as critical as defence, nuclear energy and space.

DEFENCE: The India-France defence collaborations run deep and wide, spanning the entire spectrum from air and naval assets to helicopter engines and missiles. Some flagship examples of cooperation include the Rafale aircraft, Scorpene submarines and Shakti helicopter engines.

SPACE: In this sector, there is the rich legacy of six-decade-old cooperation between ISRO and the French national space agency CNES. The highlights include joint launches, development of satellites such as Megha-Tropiques and SARAL, and collaboration in India's human spaceflight mission Gaganyaan. The two are also looking at another satellite mission, TRISHNA.

NUCLEAR: With the passing of the Sustainable Harnessing and Advancement of Nuclear Energy for Transforming India (SHANTI) Act, there is a great opportunity for collaboration among Indian and French industry. On Small Modular Reactors/Advanced Modular Reactors, India and France signed a Declaration of Intent on cooperation in this sector in February 2025.

TECH: Tech partnerships are built on a high-level of trust. As an Indian diplomat told *The Indian Express*: "One will never hand one's phone to a stranger or a person who one doesn't trust fully. The same holds true for high-level tech partnership, where high-level trust and confidence is needed between governments, systems and leaders. That's how the India and France tech partnership has matured."

components. Besides the main Zojila tunnel are two smaller ones — one 457 metres long and the other 1,953 metres long — at Nilgaur.

The larger Zojila project also comprises four bridges, an approach road from Sonamarg tunnel to Zojila tunnel, three vertical shafts — structures that provide ventilation and emergency access to the tunnel as it has no separate escape tunnel — and seven "cut-and-cover" (tunnel-like) structures. Most of these projects have already been completed.

"What is remaining is the balance works in the vertical shafts, we have already made the hole and have to widen 6.6 metres. It is the most challenging job we are up to and we expect it to complete in one-and-a-half years," said Colonel A K Shivkumar, Zojila's Project Manager.

"We also have to do the balance work for the main tunnel. We have completed the inner concrete lining for 3 km and the rest of the stretch is expected to be completed in a year. In addition to this, we have to build a drainage system and set up a ventilation system, electrical system and a fire-fighting system," he added.

shows that the total market price of all the goods and services produced in a country is growing. But it may not be a sufficient condition for all-around improvement. Academics such as Ashoka Mody (who wrote the book *India is Broken*) have argued that India should be paying greater attention to job creation. India's growth model seems to be failing Indians where it matters most: Creating jobs and boosting incomes commensurate with overall GDP growth. This predates the current government, although the situation has worsened over the decade in many ways.

During this period, many countries have also turned more insular on trade and immigration — think US President Donald Trump's ill-advised tariff mania. A world less open to trade hurts countries such as India, which have an ambitious goal ahead of them.

When the famous science fiction writer Arthur C Clarke wrote that "the goal of the future is full unemployment", his hope was "so we can play." In India, "unemployment" evokes a far more distressing future.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM/EXPLAINED

FOOD INFLATION ROSE TO 4.78% IN MAY, FROM 4.2% IN APRIL

Food prices rise in May, propel household inflation to 3.93%

Inflation for the ‘restaurant and accommodation services’ category increased further to 5.75% in May

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, June 12

CONSUMER PRICES in India rose 3.93% in May compared to a year ago as producers continued to pass on more of their input cost increases to households, according to data released on Friday by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI).

Higher food prices also drove up the overall inflation rate, with the Consumer Food Price Index rising 0.92% month-on-month in May as against a 0.75% increase in the overall CPI.

At 3.93%, the May headline inflation rate, as measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI), is higher than the 3.48% recorded in April.

Inflation, which is the year-on-year change in prices, has now risen every month in 2026.

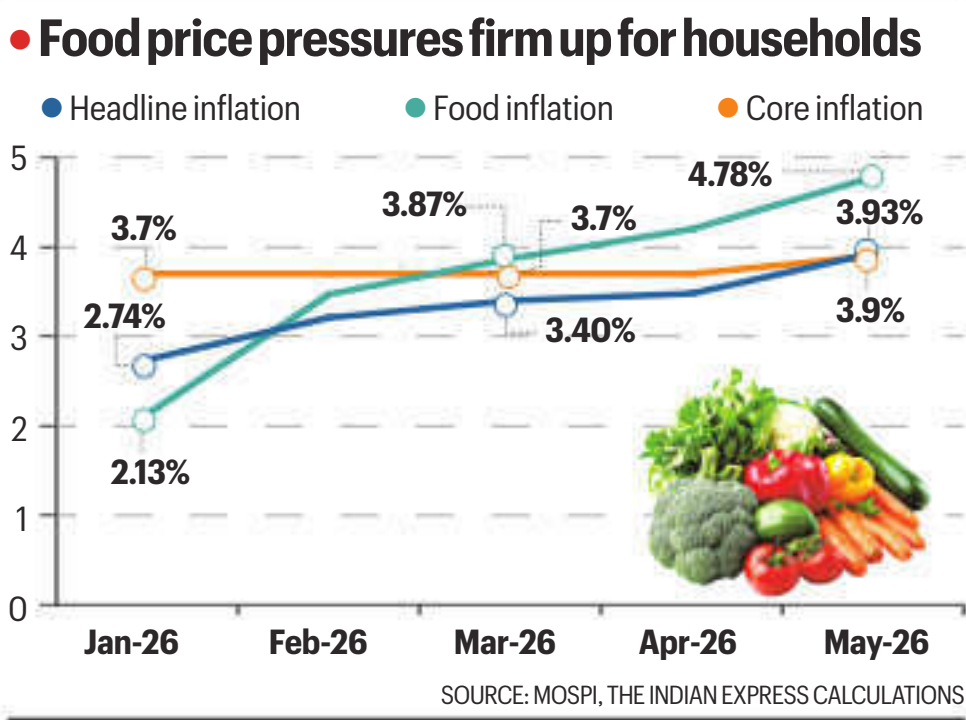
And economists expect it to rise again in June to around 4.5%. “Geopolitical tensions and El Nino conditions continue to remain upside risks to inflation,” said Megha Arora, Director at India Ratings & Research. While crude oil prices have declined on reports of the US and Iran reaching an agree-

ment over the opening of the Strait of Hormuz, “it will take time for crude prices to move towards \$70/bbl”, a level seen before the West Asia war.

After having risen to 4.2% in April from 2.9% in March, inflation for the ‘restaurant and accommodation services’ category increased further to 5.75% in May, reflecting the impact of eateries raising menu prices due to hikes in commercial LPG prices amid West Asia war. The increase in prices of ‘restaurant and accommodation services’ in May compared to April was 1.8%.

Meanwhile, overall food inflation rose to 4.78% from 4.2% in April, with Radhika Rao, Senior Economist at DBS Bank, reasoning that “heat-wave conditions in some parts of the country” pushed up food prices. According to Rajeev Sharan, Head of Research at Brickwork Ratings, while the May inflation print is broadly in line with expectations, the rise in food inflation “underscores persistent price pressures in perishables, particularly tomatoes, ginger and other vegetables”.

Tomato prices were 48% higher year-on-year in May,



while ginger was up 32%. The corresponding figures for April were 35% and 14%, respectively. The rise in food prices in May will be of concern to policymakers, with the monsoon this year forecast to be 10% weaker than the Long Period Average.

“Rising input costs for producers — reflected in the Wholesale Price Index inflation of 8.3% in April — are now increasingly feeding into consumer prices. The impact of the West Asia conflict, which has now entered its fourth month in June, is therefore starting to percolate household budgets,” said Dipti Deshpande, Principal Economist at Crisil.

The increase in CPI inflation comes a week after the Reserve Bank of India’s (RBI) rate setting panel, Monetary Policy Committee (MPC), left the policy repo rate unchanged at 5.25%, with the central bank lowering its growth forecast and raising its inflation view for 2026-27.

On June 5, the RBI cut its GDP growth forecast for 2026-27 to 6.6% from 6.9% and raised the inflation projection to 5.1% from 4.6%, with Governor Sanjay Malhotra warning there are indications that average crude oil prices this financial year would be “substantially higher” than \$85 per barrel.

As per the RBI’s latest forecasts, inflation is seen averaging 4.2% in April-June, 5.1% in July-September, 5.9% in October-December, and 5.4% in January-March 2027.

Over April-May, CPI inflation has averaged 3.7%. The

RBI is mandated to target a CPI inflation of 4% in the medium-term in a range of 2-6%. As such, the forecasts show inflation reaching the upper bound of the RBI’s target range in the last three months of 2026.

“Our assessment is that headline retail inflation could breach 6% at some point over the next six months,” said Sujan Hajra, Chief Economist at Anand Rath Group. “Even so, the RBI may refrain from adopting a decisively hawkish stance, provided core inflation remains anchored around 4% and inflationary pressures do not become broad-based.”

The RBI expects core inflation to average 4.7% in 2026-27. In May, core inflation rose to 3.9% after having stayed steady at 3.7% in the first four months of 2026. Core inflation measures the change in prices of non-food, non-fuel items, whose prices can be volatile. The movement in prices of non-food, non-fuel items, therefore, are seen as an indicator of underlying price pressures in the economy.

Economists warn that the second-round effects of fuel price hikes are expected to intensify across non-food items.

“Moreover, domestic LPG cylinder prices were raised by Rs 29/cylinder in early-June which is also likely to exert some pressure on the headline CPI print in the month,” said Rahul Agrawal, Principal Economist at ICRA.

MARKET REFORM PUSH BY REGULATOR

Corporate governance, delisting & KYC norms under review: SEBI chief

George Mathew
Mumbai, June 12

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is undertaking a comprehensive review of several key market regulations, including the Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements (LODR) framework, delisting norms, derivatives markets, framework for independent directors (IDs), short selling and KYC norms for foreign investors and NRIs, as part of a broader effort to strengthen corporate governance, deepen capital markets and enhance investor confidence, Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said.

The LODR framework is currently under review to make it more responsive to emerging governance and disclosure requirements, Pandey said.

“We will also review the delisting framework further. A well-developed capital market must provide fair entry and fair exit,” he said.

“Independent Directors play a crucial role in corporate governance. Their role is not limited to asking difficult questions on governance. They must contribute in board discussions on how best to address emerging challenges, such as, AI, cybersecurity, ESG, R&D, and rapid technological change,” Pandey said at the ET Now market summit.

At the same time, they must protect minority shareholder interests and support long-term value creation. SEBI will, therefore, work with all stakeholders to build a robust, scalable network for capacity building of Independent Directors, he said. For foreign investors, SEBI will continue to ease access through simplifying KYC and a risk-based review of disclosure requirements.

● SEBI’s proposals

- Reviewing the delisting framework
- Mulling scalable network for capacity building of Independent Directors
- Reviewing the Innovators Growth Platform so that strategic sectors like AI, semiconductors, clean energy, bio-tech, advanced materials, defence-tech can access markets better for long-term capital
- Guidelines on the responsible use of AI in capital markets
- Municipal debt and portfolio management services are also being reviewed
- Derivatives on bond indices in consultation with RBI
- Securities Lending and Borrowing and short selling frameworks to be reviewed
- Simplifying KYC and a risk-based review of disclosure norms for foreign investors
- Phased shift from cash settlement to physical settlement in select agri-commodity contracts



“We will work with other regulators to ease the KYC process for NRIs. Our efforts will be to provide clarity that global capital seeks, especially in uncertain times,” he said.

Pandey said deepening the cash market is a priority. The Securities Lending and Borrowing and short selling frameworks are being comprehensively reviewed, to facilitate inter-linkage between the cash and derivatives markets and enhance liquidity, he said.

In commodity derivatives, SEBI’s proposals on extending early pay-in benefits to options contracts, phased shift from cash settlement to physical settlement in select agri-commodity contracts, and review of

position limits are aimed at deepening participation and strengthening risk management, he said.

Electricity derivative contracts are being traded on our exchanges now. Longer-term and newer forms of contracts in this space will be required going forward.

“We will also be looking to bring in, along with RBI, derivatives on bond indices,” Pandey said. “We are reviewing the Innovators Growth Platform so that strategic sectors like AI, semiconductors, clean energy, bio-tech, advanced materials, defence-tech can access our markets better for long-term capital,” he said. [FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://www.indianexpress.com)

Case for capital gains tax changes in equities weaker than bonds: CEA



Government exempted foreign institutional investors from capital gains tax on government securities last week. REUTERS

Reuters
Bengaluru, June 12

THE CASE for changes to capital gains taxes on equities is weaker than for bonds, Chief Economic Adviser V Anantha Nageswaran said on Friday, suggesting the government sees less urgency for further tweaks to the tax regime for stocks.

India exempted foreign institutional investors from capital gains tax on government securities last week, part of moves designed to attract more capital at a time when surging foreign equity outflows, elevated oil prices, and an embattled currency weigh.

The South Asian nation, the world’s third-largest oil importer and consumer, ships in about 90% of its oil and is one of the countries most exposed to prolonged war-related dis-

ruptions to global energy supplies. Economists say sustained higher oil prices may hinder economic growth, inflation and government finances when the country is already bracing for an El Nino weather phenomenon that often portends drought.

The Reserve Bank of India’s economic growth projection of 6.6% for the ongoing financial year 2027 (FY27) with a downside risk of 20-30 basis points is realistic, Nageswaran told broadcaster NDTV.

In February, CEA projected economic growth of 7.0%-7.4% for FY27, estimates issued before the West Asia conflict. The nation’s fuel retailers may not have to pass on a lot more of higher oil prices to consumers, provided global prices conform with how financial markets expect them to settle lower for the full year, Nageswaran said.

US-Iran peace hopes spark market rally, indices surge 2%

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, June 12

INDIAN STOCK markets staged a strong rally on Friday, with benchmark indices surging more than 2% amid expectations of a possible diplomatic breakthrough between the US and Iran that could lead to the end of West Asia conflict.

Indices jumped as aggressive short covering, easing geopolitical concerns in the West Asia, a sharp decline in global crude oil prices and a strong recovery in the Indian rupee boosted the sentiment.

The benchmark BSE Sensex jumped by 1,695.40 points, or 2.30%, to close at 75,527.95, while the NSE Nifty50 advanced 461.30 points, or 1.99%, to settle at 23,622.90.

The Nifty reclaimed the crucial 23,600 level and ended comfortably above it, reflecting renewed confidence among investors after recent bouts of volatility. Positive global market cues and sustained domestic institutional buying further strengthened investor sentiment throughout the trading session.

While domestic institutions led by insurance companies and mutual funds pumped Rs 5,341 crore into the market, foreign investors pulled out Rs 1,082 crore on Friday.

Market participants attributed the sharp rise largely to



Domestic institutions, led by insurance companies and mutual funds, pumped Rs 5,341 crore into the market on Friday. REUTERS

expectations of a possible diplomatic breakthrough between the US and Iran. Hopes of de-escalation in the conflict-ridden region triggered a decline in crude oil prices, a development that is particularly beneficial for India, one of the world’s largest oil-importing nations. Lower oil prices are expected to reduce inflationary pressures and improve the country’s fiscal outlook, prompting fresh buying across sectors. Supporting the bullish sentiment, the Indian rupee recorded a significant recovery, appreciating by 64 paise to close at 95.11 against the US dollar. The rupee benefited from the sharp fall in global crude prices and weakness in the American currency.

The strengthening rupee

also boosted investor confidence by easing concerns over imported inflation and foreign capital outflows, traders said.

Brent crude, which had traded near \$93 per barrel in overnight dealings, fell sharply after Trump reportedly cancelled plans for additional military strikes against Iran.

The rally on Dalal Street was broad-based, with all major sectoral indices ending in positive territory. Realty, financial services, PSU banks, private banks and consumer durable stocks led the gains, rising between 2 and 4%. Information technology stocks, while ending higher, underperformed the broader market and remained the session’s relative laggards.

[FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](http://www.indianexpress.com)

Govt limits diesel sales to 200 litres per vehicle a day

New Delhi: The government has capped diesel sales to a vehicle in a day at 200 litres and restricted industrial, commercial, and institutional users from buying petrol and diesel from petrol pumps in a bid to prevent local shortages amid global supply disruption, according to an official order.

Retail outlets can sell diesel only into a vehicle tank or PESO-approved container, and not more than 200 litres per customer or vehicle per day.

Also, industrial, commercial and institutional consumers will no longer be allowed to buy petrol or diesel from retail outlets. They must source their fuel from their own consumer pumps.

The restrictions, which will be in place for up to 90 days, follows abnormal demand growth, particularly that of diesel, in some pockets after bulk users started buying fuel from petrol pumps due to the pricing difference. PTI

● BRIEFLY

India’s forex reserves drop \$711 mn: RBI

Mumbai: India’s forex reserves dropped \$711 million to \$681.610 billion during the week ended June 5 due to a sharp decline in foreign currency reserves, the RBI said on Friday. In the previous reporting week, the overall reserves had jumped \$938 million to \$682.321 billion. For the week ended June 5, foreign currency assets — a major component of the reserves — was down \$2,704 billion to \$543.444 billion. PTI

Nestle India rejects charges of infestation in its noodles

New Delhi: Nestle India on Friday rejected allegations that insects were found in its MAGGI noodles product, after news agency ANI reported India’s food regulator had taken cognisance of social media complaints and issued notice to the company. Nestle India said that the concern was raised from an unverified social media account. Testing of a reference sample from the same batch at an independent laboratory notified by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) found no infestation, the firm said. PTI

‘India willing to let fiscal deficit widen to 4.8% of GDP for FY27’

New Delhi: India is preparing for a wider-than-expected budget deficit this year, Bloomberg News reported on Friday, citing an official familiar with the matter, as the war in Iran raises fuel subsidy costs and pressures government finances. Reuters could not immediately verify the report and has sought comment from India’s finance ministry. REUTERS

India clears way for self-driving, safety car tech to reduce mishaps

Bengaluru: India has scrapped licensing requirements for radio spectrum used by crash-avoidance and self-driving systems in cars, removing a commercial barrier for automakers as it seeks to make some of the world’s deadliest roads safer. India reported more than 177,000 deaths in 2024, latest government data show. In notices on Thursday, the government waived licence requirements for radar sensors in the 77GHz to 81 GHz frequency band, allowing companies to use the spectrum without separate allocation by authorities. REUTERS

● INSTITUTIONAL & RETAIL INVESTORS BOUGHT 555.6 MILLION SHARES OF SPACEX AT THE OFFERING PRICE OF \$135 APIECE

SpaceX soars 23% in Wall Street debut, makes Musk 1st trillionaire

AP
New York, June 12

Shares of SpaceX soared 23% in their Wall Street debut on Friday, making the rocket maker’s CEO Elon Musk the first-ever trillionaire.

The shares opened at \$150 and kept rising, reaching \$166.90 around 12:20 pm ET. That price gave the company a market value of \$2.18 trillion. Forbes is now estimating Musk’s net worth at USD 1.1 trillion. Institutional and retail investors jumped at the opportunity to buy 555.6 million shares of SpaceX at the offering price of \$135 apiece.

The \$75 billion in proceeds easily topped the previous record IPO from oil giant Saudi Aramco in 2019. Musk says SpaceX is going public now be-

cause it needs money to fund its ambitions of putting satellites and data centres in space and eventually establishing a colony of people on Mars.

Musk earlier marked the opening of trading on Nasdaq, where the company’s are trading under the symbol “SPCX,” by joining a ceremonial bell ringing from Starbase, the South Texas home of SpaceX.

He reiterated his lofty goals “to make life multi-planetary.” “Not just a few astronauts. I mean literally you,” Musk said.

“Whoever you are watching this, SpaceX wants to be able to take you to the moon, take you to Mars and ultimately beyond.” Known for his technology breakthroughs, as well as wild claims and missed deadlines, Musk was widely expected to break the trillion dol-



Shares open at \$150 a piece, up from \$135 IPO price. REUTERS

lar mark despite SpaceX generating losses as big as its ambitions. In addition to establishing a one-million person Martian colony, the company has promised to save humanity

by establishing other outposts in space, launch data centers the size of football fields into orbit and outdo rivals Anthropic and OpenAI in the race to make money from artificial

intelligence.

To reach its goals, SpaceX needs billions more than it currently takes in from its rocket and satellite business.

Between the start of 2025 and March 31, 2026, the company lost \$8.7 billion.

Wall Street bankers that helped take SpaceX public are enthusiastic about the company — and the big fees they will earn — but not everyone thinks the stock price is justified. Analysts at research firm Morningstar, which doesn’t earn any investment banking fees, wrote that the IPO is “significantly overvalued” because of SpaceX’s unproven technology and massive capital needs.

They estimate the company is only worth \$780 billion — less than half its IPO value.

Still, Musk has pulled off the

seemingly impossible before.

The trillionaire — on paper at least — made his fortune by creating two companies, Zip2 and PayPal, that netted him about \$200 million at sale.

He used that money to start SpaceX and invest in Tesla, and defied the odds by creating a space company that figured out how to reuse rockets and a car company that made electric vehicles cool.

Musk has realised vast sums of wealth for himself, much of it in stock he has yet to cash in or grants for shares he’ll only receive if Tesla or SpaceX hit ambitious performance targets.

At Tesla, he’s worried shareholders by fighting with regulators or dividing his attention between multiple companies and last year by taking a role in the Trump administration.

● MARKETS

Sensex 75,527.95 1,695.40 2.30%	NIFTY 23,622.90 461.30 1.99%	Gold ▲ ₹1,47,800	US Dollar ▼ ₹95.11
		Silver ▲ ₹2,42,582	Oil ▲ \$93.19

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JUNE 11, 2026

US deports Iran's pro-democracy activist to Central African Republic

Reuters
Darkar, June 12

THE UNITED States has deported an Iranian pro-democracy activist to Central African Republic, her lawyer said on Friday, describing it as a "super dangerous" transfer to a country with which the activist has no connection.

The Iranian American Legal Defence Fund (IALDF) said on Thursday three Iranian women who fled persecution were at risk of deportation, including one who had converted to Christianity.

In the end, only the activist was on the flight which took off from Louisiana on Thursday night, said her lawyer, Emily Trostle, while not ruling out that the others could potentially be deported later.

The plane was expected to travel to Bangui, the capital of Central African Republic, via Ghana's capital, Accra.

"They have absolutely no connection to this place. In all of my filings I submitted tons of information about how this was super dangerous," Trostle told Reuters.

"These individuals are being removed from the United States and abandoned in a country where they have no status, no connection and no support network. We fear they will ultimately be forced to return to the countries they originally fled."



Ukrainian service members hold Ukrainian and Colombian national flags near a coffin of a soldier from Colombia on Friday. REUTERS

Ukraine and Russia trade overnight drone strikes, say officials

Reuters
Kyiv, June 12

UKRAINE AND Russia exchanged overnight drone strikes into early Friday, with Ukraine targeting a major oil processing and petrochemical region while Russia attacked railway stations and electrical substations.

Ukraine's strikes hit an apartment block in Russia's central Tatarstan injuring three, and Russia's attack in Ukraine's Sumy region killed a railway worker, officials said.

The strikes follow large air attacks by Russia on Ukraine in recent weeks, while Kyiv has intensified long-range drone strikes on Russian oil facilities, leading to shortages of fuel in Crimea and elsewhere.

Industrial facilities in Tatarstan were targeted, regional head Rustam Minnikhanov said on the Telegram messaging app. Regional city Nizhne-

'EITHER FIGHT, OR DON'T FIGHT... WE ARE FED UP'

Whipsawed between fear and relief, Iranians wait for war's end

Farnaz Fassihi
June 12

FOR DAYS, Iranians have gone to bed hearing the sounds of explosions or reports that their country and the United States were trading fire. And then they have awakened to news that the attacks had concluded and negotiations for a peace deal were still ongoing.

On Thursday, the pendulum again swung wildly — within a few hours. First, President Donald Trump threatened to hit Iran "VERY HARD" and take over Kharg Island, Iran's oil export hub. Then he abruptly canceled attacks because, he said, progress had been made in peace negotiations. Between the president's two statements, Iran's armed forces had threatened retaliation against energy infrastructure in the region if attacked. For ordinary Iranians, the constant vacillation between fear and relief, anxiety and hope, has been emotionally taxing. In phone interviews and text messages, some said that they just wanted the war to end, one way or another.

"They go to war at night. They stop the war by morning. It's all ridiculous," said Vahid, a 37-year-old resident of Tehran, Iran, who, like most ordinary Iranians interviewed, asked that his last name not be used for fear of retribution.



People attend Friday prayers in Tehran. REUTERS

"Either fight or don't fight," he added. "We are fed up."

Streams of people flowed out of Tehran, the capital, on Thursday in reaction to Trump's threats. The three main roads leading north out of the city toward the coasts of the Caspian Sea were jammed with traffic, the deputy police chief told local news media. Reza, a 48-year-old manager of a company, and his wife decided to take a weekend trip to the north and wait out the latest wave of tensions, he said in a phone interview. He said they worried the United States could

strike civilian infrastructure, a concern fuelled by a recent strike in the south, which destroyed a facility that a *New York Times* analysis found appeared to be for drinking water.

"Work is very slow, businesses are paralyzed because of fluctuating prices, it feels like our life is on hold right now," Reza said. In addition to concerns about their safety in the event of another all-out war, Iranians who were interviewed said they worried the economy would further collapse if the conflict remained in limbo. They say that

if tit-for-tat strikes become the norm and the naval blockade against Iran's ports continues, daily life will become even harder. In his post calling off planned strikes, Trump said the blockade would "remain in full force and effect" until a deal was reached. Mahasti, a 65-year-old resident of Tehran working in the health sector, said that was as bad as bombs being dropped, because the disruptions to trade and the curtailment of Iran's oil revenues were slowly deteriorating many Iranians' quality of life. NYT

Hezbollah leaders confident any US-Iran deal will include Lebanon

Reuters
Beirut, June 12

HEZBOLLAH IS confident that Iran will insist on Lebanon being included in a deal with the United States, a leading Hezbollah politician said on Friday, as hopes grew for an agreement between Tehran and Washington.

Hezbollah, founded by Iran's Revolutionary Guards in 1982, entered the regional conflict in support of Tehran on March 2, opening fire at Israel and prompting an Israeli offensive that has killed thousands of people in Lebanon. Iranian officials have repeatedly insisted on an end to fighting in Lebanon as part of any wider agreement.

"If the agreement happens, we have complete confidence in the Islamic Republic... we have confidence that it will insist on any agreement including the file of Lebanon," Hassan Fadlallah, a Hezbollah politician, said in a speech. Israeli forces have occupied swathes of southern Lebanon, where National News Agency reported new Israeli airstrikes in several towns and villages on Friday.

EU envoys agree on first phase of membership talks for Ukraine and Moldova

Reuters
Brussels, June 12

AMBASSADORS FROM the European Union's 27 countries agreed on Friday to advance membership talks with Ukraine and Moldova, with the first phase of negotiations set to begin on Monday.

Even as Ukraine continues to fight Russia's invasion, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy has made EU membership a key strategic goal to anchor his country in Europe's political mainstream.

EU leaders agreed to open accession talks with Ukraine and Moldova in December 2023 but negotiations could not start in earnest due to opposition from the previous Hungarian government to Kyiv's membership bid.

But a new government in Budapest reached an agreement with Kyiv this month on the rights of the Hungarian minority in Ukraine, paving the way for Hungary to lift its block on the first phase of membership talks.

At a meeting in Brussels on Friday, the ambassadors agreed both Ukraine and Moldova can begin talks on the first "cluster" of policy areas where they have to reform their laws to meet EU standards. In the accession process, candidate countries negotiate policy "chapters" which are grouped into six thematic clusters, covering areas including fundamental rights, internal market and external relations.

Ebola outbreak spreads to crowded relief camp in east Congo: UNHCR

Reuters
Nairobi, June 12

THE UN refugee agency confirmed the first Ebola-related deaths in a displacement camp in eastern Congo, as aid workers warned of a high risk the disease could spread rapidly in overcrowded sites.

The two victims were internally displaced people living in the Kpangba camp, which hosts 30,000 internally displaced people, the UNHCR said in a report published on Thursday.

The virus has now spread across three provinces since the World Health Organization declared the outbreak a public health emergency of international concern on May 17.

The affected provinces - Ituri, South Kivu and North Kivu - have been devastated by decades of conflict and are home to more than 5 million displaced people. A Congolese health ministry report seen by Reuters showed that a 60-year-old woman in the camp tested positive for Ebola on May 30. By then, she had broken out of quarantine and could not be traced by teams, the report said.

She died on May 31 and her daughter died on June 1, an aid worker with knowledge of the



A woman stands near a relief camp in Bunia on Friday. REUTERS

istry report seen by Reuters showed that a 60-year-old woman in the camp tested positive for Ebola on May 30. By then, she had broken out of quarantine and could not be traced by teams, the report said.

She died on May 31 and her daughter died on June 1, an aid worker with knowledge of the

cases told Reuters, adding that their bodies had both tested positive for Ebola after their deaths. Humanitarian workers later discovered the bodies, but community members began pelting WHO vehicles, the source said. Mistrust of aid groups has been widespread in the outbreak in Congo.

Indonesian students protest, say country heading for bankruptcy

Reuters
Jakarta, June 12

HUNDREDS OF Indonesian students rallied in Jakarta on Friday to protest the spending priorities of President Prabowo Subianto's government, and to protest against this week's decision to raise gasoline prices.

Calling the protest "Heading to Bankrupt Indonesia", university students marched towards central Jakarta's iconic Bunda-

ran HI landmark. Organisers said some of the protesters were blocked from reaching the designated site by police and military personnel.

The government has used subsidies to keep gasoline prices unchanged in Southeast Asia's largest economy, despite a spike in global oil prices caused by the Iran war. But fiscal pressures on the budget from Prabowo's ambitious spending plans have been rising, prompting a substantial price rise earlier this week. Clad in yellow and blue alma mater jackets, the students carried posters with slogans such as "Cancel the fuel price hike", and used the phrase "Wall of Shame" to describe Prabowo's cabinet. The students also called on incoming cars to honk to show support. By Friday evening, dozens of students had left the protest area, but there was still a sizeable crowd, and police were standing by.

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• BRIEFLY

THAILAND

Princess Bajrakitiyabha, known for her legal work, dies at 47



Thailand's Princess Bajrakitiyabha Mahidol.

THAILAND'S PRINCESS Bajrakitiyabha Mahidol, a lawyer and the eldest of King Maha Vajiralongkorn's children, has died at 47, the Bureau of the Royal Household said. She died Thursday evening at a Bangkok hospital where she had been cared for since falling unconscious due to illness three years ago, according to the statement issued Friday. "This loss is not merely bad news announced to the people, but an immeasurable grief in the hearts of the entire nation," PM Anutin Charnvirakul said in a televised speech. He said the princess was "a pride of Thailand," and that "her commitment to building a society of kindness, justice, and equality, will forever remain as a moral legacy for the nation..." AP

PHILIPPINES

Govt protests China sanctions on defence chief

THE PHILIPPINE government said Friday that China's imposition of sanctions, including an entry ban, against Defence Secretary Gilberto Teodoro Jr. was "an unfriendly act" that could further strain relations, while he vowed to continue defending Manila's interest against Beijing's aggression. The Chinese Ministry of Foreign Affairs announced Thursday that Teodoro and his family have been banned from entering China, including Hong Kong and Macao. AP

ALBANIA

Opp leader says US has lifted travel ban on him

FORMER ALBANIAN leader Sali Berisha, now the head of the main opposition party, said on Friday that the United States has lifted a travel ban placed on him in 2021. The US State Department had barred Berisha — a former president and PM who steered the Balkan country after the fall of communism in the early 1990s — and his immediate family from entering the country, saying he had been involved in "corrupt acts" including misappropriation of public funds and using his power to enrich relatives. REUTERS

• NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

NEPAL

Govt opens energy sector for pvt investments

THE NEPAL government has cleared the way for private players to enter the Himalayan nation's energy sector, said Federal Minister Biraj Bhakta Shrestha on Friday. Speaking at the annual general meeting of the Independent Power Producers' Association, Nepal (IPPAN) in Kathmandu, the Energy Minister said that the private sector will now be involved in transmission, distribution, and trading of power. PTI

PAKISTAN

Two policemen killed in separate attacks in KPK

TWO POLICE personnel were shot dead in separate incidents of targeted killing in Pakistan's restive Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province on Friday, police said. According to police, the first incident occurred in the Sedgi Bakakhel area, where unidentified gunmen opened fire on police constable Muhammad Roshan outside his residence. He died on the spot, while the attackers managed to flee. PTI

South Korea ex-President Yoon sentenced to 30-year jail over drone incursion

Reuters
Seoul, June 12

A SOUTH Korean court sentenced former President Yoon Suk Yeol to 30 years in prison on Friday for charges linked to his ordering an incursion of military drones over North Korea to help create a pretext for his failed December 2024 martial law declaration.

The Seoul Central District Court found Yoon guilty of aiding the enemy and abuse of power, saying he had conspired in the October 2024 drone incursion over Pyongyang from the outset, according to a court



Yoon Suk Yeol

statement. The ruling adds to a series of judgments against the ousted conservative leader, once South Korea's top prosecutor, whose martial law order plunged Asia's fourth-largest economy into its deepest political turmoil in decades. Yoon had denied any wrongdoing over the drone incursion. REUTERS

• ONE OF HIS MOST FAMOUS PAINTINGS, 'PORTRAIT OF AN ARTIST (POOL WITH TWO FIGURES)' — SHOWING A FIGURE SWIMMING UNDERWATER AND A MAN GAZING INTO THE POOL — SOLD FOR \$90.3 MILLION IN 2018

David Hockney, British artist who went in search of Californian colour, dies at 88

William Schomberg
June 12

AS A child growing up in gloomy northern England, David Hockney noticed the sharply defined shadows in the Hollywood films of comedy duo Laurel and Hardy.

"Strong shadows made a lot of sun," the painter recalled to BBC television in 2009. "So I thought, well, wherever that is, it's always sunny."

Two decades later, Hockney moved to Los Angeles to immerse himself in that dazzling light. The artist, whose brightly coloured renditions of California would go on to make him one of the most celebrated artists of the

20th and 21st centuries, died on Thursday, his publicist Erica Bolton said in a statement. He was 88. No cause of death was given.

Initially, almost as much as his paintings, Hockney was known for his own image — thick-rimmed spectacles, peroxide hair, shiny gold jacket — which became a symbol of Britain's Swinging Sixties.

As an art student in the northern English city of Bradford — where he was born to an accountancy clerk father and a devout Methodist mother — Hockney rebelled against convention. He gave titles to his abstract paintings such as "Going to be a Queen for Tonight" and "Doll Boy" at a time when homo-

sexuality was punishable by prison. To continue his studies, in 1959 he moved to London where he had a meteoric rise in the British pop art movement and rubbed shoulders with stars from dancer Rudolf Nureyev to Mick Jagger.

But Hockney yearned for the excitement he saw in the work of American artists. Using money from the sale of his art, he visited New York for the first time in 1961 — where he became a friend of Andy Warhol — and moved to California three years later. "I thought people who produced such work must live in colour, so I went in search of it," he is quoted as saying in a biography written by art critic and



David Hockney at Westminster Abbey in London. REUTERS

friend Peter Adam.

"I had spent the first 20 years of my life in the gothic gloom of the North. Here I felt free."

His pictures of swimming pools and naked men in showers became icons of a sun-drenched lifestyle that he documented with

luminous acrylic paint before dividing his time between Los Angeles, London and Paris in the late 1960s and 1970s. He remained unpretentious despite his success. "I am actually still a student," he told Adam. "I just happen to have quite a lot of credit cards in my pocket." In 1985, when he was invited to the White House to dine with President Ronald Reagan, Prince Charles and Princess Diana, he was held up for half an hour by security officers because he was the only guest to arrive on foot, his biographer wrote.

Hockney's images of love, sex and material wealth led to claims by some art critics that his work was trivial. But he won greater renown than any other British art-

turning more frequently to visit his mother in the northern English county of Yorkshire, where he had grown up, and a terminally ill friend encouraged him to paint the local landscapes.

Feeling increasingly lonely, he moved from California to the seaside town of Bridlington on England's North Sea coast. For a decade he painted clumps of bare trees in winter, fields full of ripe crops and tracks stretching towards the gentle rolling hills of the Yorkshire Wolds region. It was the most productive period of his entire career as he rushed to capture scenes that, he said, changed more dramatically with the seasons than did those of California. REUTERS

KHAN SIR'S RISE, HIS RECKONING

Faisal Khan's affordable classes and teaching style built him a student following far beyond Patna. Now, as he finds himself at the centre of a controversy over a clash with a rival coaching centre, HIMANSHU HARSH traces his arc — from a struggling Army aspirant in UP's Deoria to being 'Khan Sir'



• CHRONOLOGY OF A CLASH

JUNE 2: Shots are fired during a clash between Khan Global Studies and Gyan Bindu GS Academy

JUNE 3: FIR against Gyan Bindu director Raushan Anand and aides under attempt to murder, rioting, criminal conspiracy and other BNS sections; they're sent to judicial custody

JUNE 4: Khan's arrested security guards say

they opened fire on employer's instructions. Another FIR charges Khan and his guards with attempted murder and under Arms Act sections

JUNE 9: Khan is granted interim relief from arrest by a Patna district court

● Anand's bail plea is rejected by chief judicial magistrate the same day

JUNE 10: Hearing Khan's petition to quash the

FIR, Patna HC extends protection while demanding state response

● Anand applies for bail again before sessions court

JUNE 20: Next hearing of Khan's bail case at district court

JULY 13: Next hearing at Patna HC on quashing of FIR against him



(Top, above) At Musallahpur Haat in Patna, posters and banners of Khan Global Studies dominate the landscape. RAHUL SHARMA

beyond 50 lakh subscribers.

Over the last few years, Khan's enterprise has flourished, expanding beyond the boundaries of Kisan Cold Storage to elsewhere in Patna and beyond. KGS now has branches on Patna's Boring Road, in Delhi's Mukherjee Nagar and Karol Bagh, Prayagraj and Noida in Uttar Pradesh, and Dehradun in Uttarakhand.

Over the years, he has launched other social welfare initiatives, including Khan Healthcare Hospital, which he soft-launched in late 2025, and Khan Blood Centre, inaugurated in April this year — both of which offer low-cost clinical and diagnostic procedures. He has also set up a student library network, the Khan Sir Foundation, and a small-scale *gaushala* for stray cattle. While his supporters see this as his

way of giving back to society, his critics and rivals dismiss it as "brand promotion".

At KGS, Khan's basic online courses remain reasonably priced, ranging from Rs 399 for single-topic foundation courses to Rs 449 for state-level police constable or subordinate service selection exams. But the fee for flagship courses such as UPSC, NEET and JEE has gone up.

"UPSC courses can cost well above Rs 20,000 because they cover prelims, mains or a much larger curriculum compared to ordinary single-subject batches," says Rakesh Kumar, a student who is preparing for a state-level exam.

If Khan's popularity among students soared, he also had his share of detractors and controversies. In 2022, an FIR was registered against coaching operators in Patna, including Khan, for allegedly inciting railway job aspirants to organise protests against flaws in the recruitment exam. He subsequently asked his students to maintain peace.

Recently, journalist Anjana Om Kashyap filed a Rs 2-crore defamation suit against Khan and other Patna coaching operators, accusing them of running a campaign against her after she criticised "YouTube star teachers" during a NEET paper debate.

Khan's low-cost classes democratised the coaching space a decade ago. But as the recent controversy showed, the stakes have never been higher

A challenger

In Musallahpur's crowded coaching landscape, Khan had his share of challengers, among them Raushan Anand. Anand is currently in judicial custody over the violence that unfolded between his academy and KGS on June 2.

Like Khan, Anand presents himself as a product of hardship and interrupted dreams — a story that resonates with Bihar's youth, his target audience, who hope that education can be converted into social mobility.

In his interviews, Anand describes growing up in Saharsa district, studying in government schools, moving to Patna in 2009 and then to Kota to prepare for engineering entrance examinations. He claims to have secured admission to BIT Mesra in 2012 but says he dropped out in 2013 and returned to Patna.

From 2014 to 2016, he prepared for BPSC and UPSC examinations while teaching on the side. By 2017, sources close to him say, Anand's financial difficulties pushed him towards full-time teaching and later, setting up his own coaching business. Like Khan, he distinguishes his affordable set-up from that of legacy coaching centres.

Irrespective of these similarities, what explains the friction between the two men is the proximity of their coaching classes, and the same pool of young men and women they target.

Online, Khan is a national figure with a larger student base on virtual platforms. Anand, meanwhile, has more offline classroom enrolment — a space, which, critics say, Khan has been attempting to dominate.

"Gyan Bindu is widely known as the 'Daroga Factory' throughout Bihar due to its exceptionally high success rate in helping students crack the Bihar Police sub-inspector exams," says Abhijeet Kumar, who is not enrolled at either institute.

As both Khan and Anand attempt to gain a bigger share of the market pie, nowhere are the stakes higher than in Musallahpur Haat, the Patna locality that's part marketplace and part informal university. Here, classrooms are stacked above shops, hostels are squeezed into lanes, libraries operate late into the night and tea stalls and eateries serve thousands of students.

For decades, Musallahpur has functioned as one of eastern India's largest coaching clusters, its proximity to Patna University making it an ideal location for coaching institutes.

The area is often compared with Delhi's Mukherjee Nagar or Prayagraj's coaching districts, while being significantly cheaper. "Anyone from other districts who aspires to dream big moves to Musallahpur... those who aspire bigger, move outside Bihar," says a student.

With the competition fierce, rival coaching centre operators advertise on the same roads, target the same exams and rely on the same student networks. This competition further extends to YouTube channels, Telegram groups, mobile apps, scholarship programmes, social media engagement and aggressive marketing of results. Topper photographs appear on billboards and their felicitations become public events. Selection numbers become advertising campaigns and exam results are transformed into promotional assets.

Personal branding is par for the course. Khan recently publicly celebrated Raksha Bandhan with thousands of students who tied *rakhis*, hosted grand feasts for more than 50,000 students after his wedding, and organised large Saraswati Puja celebrations. Anand gifted Royal Enfield bikes to students who secured ranks among the top 20 in the Bihar Police Sub-Inspector examination.

In such an environment, it doesn't take long for professional competition to turn personal.

The FIR & counter-FIR

Tensions had been simmering between KGS and Gyan Bindu since the results of the Bihar Police Constable recruitment exam, as both claimed a higher percentage of successful students, until it reached a fever pitch on the night of June 2. Police said a group linked to Gyan Bindu allegedly vandalised KGS hoardings and assaulted its security personnel and staff. An injured guard had to be hospitalised, police said.

There have, however, been competing claims, including a video footage showing a man tearing down a poster advertising a felicitation ceremony organised by Gyan Bindu Academy. The dispute, sources claim, continued over competing posters, before culminating in the stone-pelting and attack reported at Khan's institute on June 2.

Within hours of the June 2 clash, Khan said the attack was orchestrated by rival coaching interests. An FIR was registered against Anand and others, prompting their arrests.

The case then took a turn when two of Khan's security guards allegedly told police that they opened fire on their employer's instructions. A second FIR followed, this time charging Khan, along with his guards and other unidentified persons, with attempted murder and violations under the Arms Act. The guards have been arrested. But Khan is yet to make a public appearance since the controversy broke.

His legal team has denied the allegations. On June 9, a Patna district court gave Khan interim relief from arrest.

A decade ago, Khan was a newcomer whose low-cost classes challenged established players and democratised the coaching space in Bihar. But as the recent controversy showed, the stakes have never been higher.

BOMBS EXPLODED at our coaching institute, one after another...*hum coaching pe hain ya border pe* (were we in a coaching centre or at the border)?," educator Faizal Khan said in a video shot four years ago.

The incident that Khan described in his characteristic wry style is from 2019, when crude bombs were allegedly hurled into his classroom in Patna. While there are few details about the incident and what prompted it, Khan did not let the 2019 summer attack end his teaching career. If anything, it became part of his story — an outsider who challenged entrenched interests and carved out a space in Bihar's crowded coaching market as the wildly popular "Khan Sir".

In the video, Khan said that while neighbouring establishments closed their shutters and people fled after the 2019 'bomb attack', students urged him not to give up. "*Sir, koi baat nahi. Aap kholtiye, hum log padhenge. Kitna bhi bomb chale* (Sir, it's okay. You keep going, we'll study, no matter how many bombs go off)."

Now, nearly seven years later, Khan finds himself at the centre of one of Bihar's biggest coaching controversies. A clash between his Khan Global Studies (KGS) and a rival coaching institute, Gyan Bindu GS Academy, operated by Raushan Anand, escalated to shots being fired outside Khan's institute on June 2, resulting in an FIR and a counter-FIR.

To supporters, 'Khan Sir' is the educator who disrupted a market long dominated by expensive coaching institutes. To critics, however, he is now part of the establishment, occupying a position of influence similar to what he once challenged.

The making of 'Khan Sir'

Much before he became a recognised name, Khan was among the thousands of students navigating Bihar's competitive examination ecosystem. In public interviews and videos, he describes a journey of financial hardship, interrupted ambitions, and years of struggle in a society that discriminated against his religious identity.

He has spoken about growing up in a joint family in Deoria, the Uttar Pradesh district that borders Bihar, the single room he shared with his parents and siblings, and how his mother struggled to bring them up as his father travelled for work to different places. In one of his many video interviews, he says, "I went to a normal school... Even pencils were accounted for. When a pencil arrived, it would be cut in half. I would take half, he would take half..."

In the mid-2010s, Khan left home to pursue his ambitions in Patna's coaching ecosystem. He recalls preparing for the Army and clearing the National Defence Academy written exam, only to be disqualified during the physical round due to a "minor arm condition".

Those close to him say that from 2014 to 2016, Khan frequented coaching institutes in Patna to study English, Maths and Reasoning for competitive exams while teaching part-time. But when he didn't find success, he finally transitioned to teaching for state-level and lower clerical-level competitive exams.

"His first teaching job was at a coaching institute, where he held test-series discussions for a modest Rs 150 per session, each lasting around 1.5 hours," says an acquaintance from his student days. "He had a laptop obtained under a Uttar Pradesh government distribution scheme that carried the image of then chief minister Akhilesh Yadav. He frequently used the device while teaching mapping."

Khan has spoken of how, when he started teaching part-time, the manager at a coaching institute, who didn't remember his first name, would schedule his classes under "Khan Sir", and the name stuck.

Nikhil Kumar, a teacher who runs Nikhil Classes in Patna's Musallahpur Haat, says that around 2016-17, he started an institute in partnership with Khan. But the relationship soon soured.

"When we were in a business partnership, I had trusted him and put in all my efforts to establish a centre on the same premises out of which Khan's current institute operates in Musallahpur Haat. He eventually took over the property and started his own KGS institute," he alleges.

While Khan could not be contacted despite efforts by *The Indian Express*, he has on public platforms claimed that "financial disputes" with his partners had forced him to create his own brand from scratch. In 2019, KGS started operating from a building in the Kisan Cold Storage complex in Patna's coaching hub of Musallahpur Haat.

Khan distinguished himself from his competitors by charging substantially lower fees. Former associates, local coaching operators and students recall courses priced at Rs 149 per course. At a time when mainstream and franchise coaching institutes were charging much more, Khan's fee structure made his classes affordable for students from modest backgrounds.

When his test-series discussions and unique map-reading classes grew popular, he started teaching GK (general knowledge), GS (general studies), and current affairs. Gradually, he built a loyal following.

Covid-19 & Khan's brand

The Covid-19 pandemic fundamentally changed Bihar's coaching landscape and turned Khan into the national phenomenon he is today.

For decades, Bihar had only exported student-aspirants. Families who could afford it sent their children to Kota for engineering and medical entrance exams, to

Khan's easy teaching style, delivered in a style that blended humour with rustic dialects, attracted students from across Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and beyond

Delhi's Mukherjee Nagar for civil services, or to Prayagraj for state-level competitive exams. However, Covid-19 changed that equation by moving classrooms online. Teachers who connected with students through digital platforms such as YouTube discovered an unprecedented reach. Khan proved particularly effective in this environment.

His easy teaching style and explanation of complex topics through real-world examples, peppered with his opinion and delivered in a style that blended humour with rustic dialects, attracted students from across Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and beyond.

After the pandemic, besides his massive online student community, Khan started expanding aggressively in Musallahpur. Sources said he acquired many

of the spaces that were vacated by institutes after the pandemic.

From around 500 students in his Musallahpur institute before the pandemic, the numbers have shot up across his centres. At the Kisan Cold Storage complex alone, which houses the main KGS centre, there are an estimated 4,000 students at a time. He has an even bigger presence online, with more than 2.5 crore subscribers on his primary YouTube channel, while subsidiary channels have also scaled

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,Vimal D/o-Richh Pal W/o Arvind,R/o Bedha Patti,Bahora Kalan(134),Gurugram (Haryana)-122413,have changed my name to Vimal Chauhan. 0040860304-5

I,JYOTI W/o SH. RAJEEV BHADU, R/O House No.79, VILLAGE ADHCHINI, MALVIYA NAGAR,NEW DELHI-110017, inform that my,son's name ARNAV BHADU AND ARNAV BHADOO,both names are same person. 0040860302-3

I,Sunita Kumari W/o Anil Kumar Kakkar R/o-B-30/14, Second-Floor, Double-Storey, Ramesh-Nagar, New Delhi-110015, have changed my name to Sunita Kakkar. 0040860333-4

I,Shazia Rashid W/o Rashid Rehman R/o,House-No.91, Vikas-Marg,Near Karkari-Morh Flyover Gagan-Vihar, Krishna-Nagar, East-Delhi, Delhi-110051,have changed my name to Shazia Rehman. 0040860333-6

I,EURENDER KUMAR S/O SATPAL R/O 16,PANDIT-PARK KRISHNA-NAGAR,Near Geeta-Colony EAST DELHI-110051, have changed my name to SURINDER KUMAR PASRICHA, permanently. 0040860302-5

I,SUAJTA alias J A SUJATA,W/O J. K. Amar Narayan,R/O B-43, FIRST FLOOR,BACK-SIDE, JAWAHAR PARK,DEVLI ROAD, KHANPUR, Deoli, South Delhi, Delhi-110062, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known As SUAJTA. 0040860288-1

I,SNEHA BIALA W/o-Manik Kumar Bhardwaj R/O-X-26 First Floor West Patel Nagar New Delhi-8, have changed my name to SNEHA BHARDWAJ, for all purposes. 0040860333-2

I,SHREYA SINGH/KM SHREYA DWIVEDI,w/o-DEEPAK SINGH R/o-KH.NO.-44/15,12,STREET NO.-16,BLOCK-A,KAUSHIK ENCLAVE, DELHI-110084 have changed my name to SHREYA NEGI 0040860304-2

I,SHOBHIT GOEL,S/O NAVEEN GOYAL,R/O F-34, RAJA PURI UTTAM NAGAR,DELHI-110059,Have changed name to SHOBHIT GOYAL. 0040860302-9

I,SANDEEP VEEDLAN S/O NARESH VEEDLAN R/O BG 3/71-D, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi-110063, have changed my name to SANDEEP RAJPUT. 0040860333-5

I,Rudhermani S/o- Vinod Gautam,House no-263,Ward no-2 Mehrauli Delhi 110030, have changed my name to Rudhermani Gautam 0040860304-8

I,Reju W/o Shri.Mahesh R/o-K-2,H.No-105,Near Hanuman Mandir,Defence Enclave, Mahipalpur,South West Delhi, Delhi-110037,have changed my name from REJU to RENU,for all future purposes. 0040860302-1

I,RAVISHANKER RAJ S/O RAM BHAROSH D/o R/O F-39/1,F-BLOCK,MANGOLPURI,N-BLOCK, P.O.-MANGOLPURI,N-BLOCK, DELHI-110083,I HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM RAVISHANKER RAJ TO RAVISHANKAR RAJ PERMANENTLY. 0040860303-1

I,PARAS ARORA S/O GIRISH KUMAR ARORA R/O Flat No-E-601,Apex Golf Avenue,Plot No- Gh-3,Sports City-1, Gr. Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar,Pradesh-201308,have changed my name to PARAS ARORAH. 0040860302-4

I, Narender S/O Bhagwan Das R/o 550/51, Mantola Pahar Ganj, Delhi-110055, have Changed my name to Narender Kumar permanently. 0040860302-6

I,LAVANYA MITTAL D/o,RISHI MITTAL,R/o-F-5-A, Gali No-5,West Chander Nagar, Delhi-110051,have changed my name to LAVVANYA MITTAL for all purposes. 0040860304-7

I,NISHA PRAVEEN,D/o. NARAIN DASS,R/O H-36,4TH-FLOOR,LEFT SIDE,ABDUL FAZAL PART-1,JAMIA NAGAR,NFC,NEW DELHI-110025,have changed my name from NISHA RANI & NISHA to NISHA PRAVEEN,D/O NaraIn Dass and w/o Attaulah,for all future purposes. 0040860302-2

I,NAZIMA BEGUM W/O-MEHMOOD KHAN R/O-HOUSE NO-C-18, MATA-SUNDRI,ROAD NEAR GURUDWARA CENTRAL, DELHI-110002 changed my name to NAZMA BEGUM,for all future purposes. 0040860302-13

I,NAVEEN GOEL S/O RAMDHAN, R/O F-34, RAJA PURI UTTAM NAGAR,DELHI-110059,Have changed name to NAVEEN GOYAL. 0040860302-8

I,Monika Misra,R/o F-3/109, South End Apartments, Charmwood-Village, Faridabad,Haryana,have changed my son's name from Bhhavya Gupta to Bhvya Gupta,for all purposes. 0040860302-11

I,Neetu Varma D/O, Jagdish Maggo R/O Ap- 05/3 1st Floor Shalimar Bagh North West Delhi-110088 have changed my name to Sonia Verma. 0040860286-1

I,Amita Mangesh Shukla D/o Ajay Parve and W/o Mangesh Nandkishor Shukla R/o Makan No.-743, Ward No.-12, Patel Mohalla, Badhapurpur, Madhya Pradesh - 450331, have changed my name to Amita Ajay Parve 0071041700-1

I,Tajinder Singh,S/O Hardeep Singh Bhatia R/O BE-5,First floor,Street no-5,Harj Nagar, Delhi-110064, changed my name to Tajinder Singh Bhatia. 0040860302-7

I,Dilshad Ahmad S/o Ahsan Ali R/o Tyori-13, Visawa, Biswa, Ghaziabad, UP have changed my name to Dilshad Ahmed. 0071041712-1

I,ANUBHA NORIN STEPHEN W/o Alexander Massey, R/o:F-5, Near Metro Tower Hotel, Mata Chowk, Mahipalpur, New Delhi-110037, Have Changed My Name to ANUBHA STEPHEN. 0071041701-1

I,Monika Gupta,W/o Himanshu Gupta,R/O F-3/109, South End Apartments, Charmwood-Village, Faridabad, Haryana,have changed my name to Monika Misra, for all purposes. 0040860302-12

I,MANOJ SAHA,S/O SUSHIL SAHA,R/O FLAT NO-403, TOWER-3B,ORRIS ASTER COURT,SECTOR-85,VATIKA INDIA NEXT,GURGAON (HARYANA)-122004,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MANOJ KUMAR SAHA,FOR ALL FUTURE, PURPOSES. 0040860304-6

I,MAMTA GOEL,W/O MAVEEN GOYAL R/O F-34,RAJA PURI UTTAM NAGAR,DELHI-110059, Have changed name to MAMTA GOYAL 0040860302-10

I,LAVANYA MITTAL,D/o. RISHI MITTAL,R/o-F-5-A, Gali No-5, West Chander Nagar, Delhi-110051,have changed my name to LAVVANYA MITTAL,for all purposes 0040860333-1

I,GEETA VASHISHT/GITA SHARMA,W/O-ASHOK SHARMA,R/O-HNO.E-31 GURUDWARA GALI PRASHANT VIHAR RAJAPUR KALAN DELHI-110085,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO GEETA SHARMA. 0040860304-10

I,DEEPAK s/osHARISH KUMAR R/o.KH.No.-44/15/12,STREET NO.-16,BLOCK-A,KAUSHIK ENCLAVE, DELHI- 110084 have changed my name to DEEPAK SINGH. 0040860304-1

I,Ankush Malhotra S/O Vinod Kumar Malhotra,R/O-160,Block-A,Shastri Nagar Delhi-110052,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Ankussh Kaushal. 0040860304-2

I,SNEHA BIALA W/o-Manik Kumar Bhardwaj R/O-X-26 First Floor West Patel Nagar New Delhi-8, have changed my name to SNEHA BHARDWAJ, for all purposes. 0040860333-2

I,SHREYA SINGH/KM SHREYA DWIVEDI,w/o-DEEPAK SINGH R/o-KH.NO.-44/15,12,STREET NO.-16,BLOCK-A,KAUSHIK ENCLAVE, DELHI-110084 have changed my name to SHREYA NEGI 0040860304-2

I,SHOBHIT GOEL,S/O NAVEEN GOYAL,R/O F-34, RAJA PURI UTTAM NAGAR,DELHI-110059,Have changed name to SHOBHIT GOYAL. 0040860302-9

I,SANDEEP VEEDLAN S/O NARESH VEEDLAN R/O BG 3/71-D, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi-110063, have changed my name to SANDEEP RAJPUT. 0040860333-5

I,Rudhermani S/o- Vinod Gautam,House no-263,Ward no-2 Mehrauli Delhi 110030, have changed my name to Rudhermani Gautam 0040860304-8

I,Reju W/o Shri.Mahesh R/o-K-2,H.No-105,Near Hanuman Mandir,Defence Enclave, Mahipalpur,South West Delhi, Delhi-110037,have changed my name from REJU to RENU,for all future purposes. 0040860302-1

I,RAVISHANKER RAJ S/O RAM BHAROSH D/o R/O F-39/1,F-BLOCK,MANGOLPURI,N-BLOCK, P.O.-MANGOLPURI,N-BLOCK, DELHI-110083,I HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM RAVISHANKER RAJ TO RAVISHANKAR RAJ PERMANENTLY. 0040860303-1

I,PARAS ARORA S/O GIRISH KUMAR ARORA R/O Flat No-E-601,Apex Golf Avenue,Plot No- Gh-3,Sports City-1, Gr. Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar,Pradesh-201308,have changed my name to PARAS ARORAH. 0040860302-4

I, Narender S/O Bhagwan Das R/o 550/51, Mantola Pahar Ganj, Delhi-110055, have Changed my name to Narender Kumar permanently. 0040860302-6

I,LAVANYA MITTAL D/o,RISHI MITTAL,R/o-F-5-A, Gali No-5,West Chander Nagar, Delhi-110051,have changed my name to LAVVANYA MITTAL for all purposes. 0040860304-7

I,NISHA PRAVEEN,D/o. NARAIN DASS,R/O H-36,4TH-FLOOR,LEFT SIDE,ABDUL FAZAL PART-1,JAMIA NAGAR,NFC,NEW DELHI-110025,have changed my name from NISHA RANI & NISHA to NISHA PRAVEEN,D/O NaraIn Dass and w/o Attaulah,for all future purposes. 0040860302-2

I,NAZIMA BEGUM W/O-MEHMOOD KHAN R/O-HOUSE NO-C-18, MATA-SUNDRI,ROAD NEAR GURUDWARA CENTRAL, DELHI-110002 changed my name to NAZMA BEGUM,for all future purposes. 0040860302-13

I,NAVEEN GOEL S/O RAMDHAN, R/O F-34, RAJA PURI UTTAM NAGAR,DELHI-110059,Have changed name to NAVEEN GOYAL. 0040860302-8

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I,Amita Mangesh Shukla D/o Ajay Parve and W/o Mangesh Nandkishor Shukla R/o Makan No.-743, Ward No.-12, Patel Mohalla, Badhapurpur, Madhya Pradesh - 450331, have changed my name to Amita Ajay Parve 0071041700-1

I,Tajinder Singh,S/O Hardeep Singh Bhatia R/O BE-5,First floor,Street no-5,Harj Nagar, Delhi-110064, changed my name to Tajinder Singh Bhatia. 0040860302-7

I,Dilshad Ahmad S/o Ahsan Ali R/o Tyori-13, Visawa, Biswa, Ghaziabad, UP have changed my name to Dilshad Ahmed. 0071041712-1

I,ANUBHA NORIN STEPHEN W/o Alexander Massey, R/o:F-5, Near Metro Tower Hotel, Mata Chowk, Mahipalpur, New Delhi-110037, Have Changed My Name to ANUBHA STEPHEN. 0071041701-1

I,ABHIMANYU, R/O 193 Shivakhari, Vishwakarma Nagar, Delhi-110095 hereby declares Mother's name Simi and Simi Raghuvaran and father's name Rajesh and Rajesh Thankappan, refer to same respective persons. 0040860198-1

I,thitherto known as LACHHO MINA W/O BALIRAM R/O H.NO. C-3/49, PHASE-4, Aya Nagar, South Delhi, Delhi-110047, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as LACHHAMINA 0130065748-1

I,Taniya D/O Vijay R/O House No 100/507 Huts hanjan Basti Kotla Firoz Shah Darya Ganj Central Delhi 110002, have changed my name from Taniya to Ravina for all purposes 0040860199-1

ISHAHBAZ S/O Mohd Gajuddin Saifi resident of H.No 345 Lokpriya Vihar Khora Colony Ghaziabad UP 201309, have changed my name from SHAHBAZ to SHAHBAZ SAIFI. Henceforth I would be known by the name of SHAHBAZ SAIFI for all future purposes. 0050291187-1

LOST & FOUND

Lost prop chain docs, Keshav Aggarwal, property papers of 107-108, First Floor, Sagar Plaza, District Centre, Laxmi Nagar, New Delhi-110092. If found call 9711194232 0071041679-1

I,RADHEY SHYAM AGRAWAL, R/O 290, Kohat Enclave, Pitampura, Delhi-34. Lost the original share certificate (in the name of Tansukh Rai Bansal) of my Flat No.124, Aggroha Kunj Apartments, Sector-13, Rohini, Delhi-85. Finder may contact above noted person. 0040860195-2

I, Tarun Kumar S/o Brij Kishore R/O 602 Aditya Celebrity Homes Sector-76 Noida-201301, have lost my original Possession Letter, Builder Buyer Agreement of my above said Property, Finder Contact above address. 0071041755-1

I,Jaskaran Singh,Son of Divari Lal,R/O B-123/4, Chattarpur Enclave, Phase-2,Chattarpur, New Delhi, declare that my original Property Paper in r/o-B-123/4, Chattarpur Enclave, Phase-2, Chattarpur,New Delhi, has been lost,which FIR LR No.2217003/2024 dated-19/10/2024.If found to any person then contact my Mob.No.9213776561, and I have transferred the above said Property to my son's. 0040860333-7

I,Abdussalam Qumradeen Khan,R/O B-158 SECOND FLOOR,LEFT SIDE, SHAHEEN BAGH,ABUL FAZAL ENCLAVE PART-2,South East-Delhi PIN:110025,have changed my name to Abdus Salam,for all,purposes. 0040860304-11

I,AVDESH KUMAR,S/O-VED PRAKASH,R/O-HOUSE NO-144,FIRST-FLOOR,STATE BANK-NAGAR PASCHIM-VIHAR,DELHI-110063,have changed the name to AVDESH KUMAR MITTAL 0040860304-9

I,AKANKSHA alias J. A. Akansha, D/O J. K. Amar Narayan, R/O B-43,FIRST FLOOR,BACK-SIDE, JAWAHAR PARK,DEVLI ROAD, KHANPUR,Deoli, South, Delhi, Delhi-110062,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as JYOTHI AMAR AKANSHA. 0040860288-2

I,Shakil S/O Naushad R/o Malik Nagar, Muradnagar, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Shakil Malik. 0071041710-1

I,SAJNAY MANGLA S/O Rajinder Singh Mangla, R/O-Agra Chowk, New Colony Road, Palwal, Haryana-121102 have changed my name to SANJAY KUMAR MANGLA. 0071041725-1

I, RAJNEESH S/o CHANDIPRASAD, R/o E 31, Sector 36, Greater Noida, Eachachhar, Kasna, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201310, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as RAJNEESH KUMAR SHARMA. 0071041692-1

I, RAJMINDER KAUR W/o JASPAL SINGH R/o K-112, Krishna Park extn. Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-110018 has changed my name from RAJVINDER KAUR to RAJMINDER KAUR for all future purposes. 0040860200-1

I, Nadeem Ahmad S/o Dilshad Ahmed R/O Tyori-13, Visawa, Biswa, Ghaziabad, UP have changed my name to Nadeem Ahmed. 0071041716-1

I, Mohibullah, S/o Mohammad Ali, one of the residents of 5, Masjid I.R.C.S, Red Cross Road, Near Parliament House, New Delhi-110001, Delhi, have changed my name from Mohibullah Nadvli to Mohibullah. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Mohibullah for all future purposes. (where Mohibullah Nadvli is the old name and Mohibullah is the new name). 0040860235-1

I, MOHAMMAD ALAM S/o Mohd Nazim, G-118, Block-G, Jaitpur Extn., Badarpur, Delhi-44 have changed my name to MD ALAM. 0071041707-1

I, Kawlijit kour Wazir W/o Mandeep Singh R/o 701 Tower-03 Sector Swarn Nagari, Parsvnath Platinum, Greater Noida, G.B Nagar, U.P have changed my name to Kawlijit kour, Henceforth I would be known by the name of Kawlijit kour, for all future purposes 0071041756-1

I,Nirmala Devi W/o Shri Dharam Dev R/o Flat No.116, Block E, DDA SFS Flats, Sector-18, Rohini, Delhi-110085 have changed my name to Nirmala Dev for all purposes. 0040860195-1

I,Sarjeet Kumar Goel,son of, Jag mohan Gupta R/o, KP-140 2nd floor Pitampuram Delhi 110034.Have Changed my name to Sarjeet Goel. 0040860304-3

PUBLIC NOTICE

Under instructions from and on behalf of my clients, Mr. Raj Kumar S/o Late Sh. Om Prakash and Mrs. Sushma W/o Sh. Raj Kumar, both residents of RZ-237A, X-Block, New Rashan Park, Najafgarh, New Delhi-110041, I, hereby inform the general public that due to the continuous misbehavior, misconduct, rude attitude and disrespectful conduct of their daughter, Ms. Neha, they have severed all relations with her. My clients have also disowned and debarred Ms. Neha from all their movable and immovable properties. Neither my clients nor any member of their family shall be responsible for any act, dealing, liability, debt or obligatory deftakers, her hereafter. Any person dealing with Ms. Neha shall do so at his/her own risk and responsibility.

(RAHUL TYAGI) (ADVOCATE)
Distt. Court & Delhi High Court, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client Jasjit Manchanda S/o Sh. Gurdev Singh Manchanda R/o 17/2696 Beadon Pura, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005, and Kiran Manchanda R/o Sh. Jai Sarpal Manchanda R/o House No.130, Block S/F Block-I, Near Sunil Dairy, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059 have disowned and debarred our son Prashant Manchanda from my all movable immovable properties and has no relation with them in future. My client and other family members shall not be responsible for any Civil and Criminal Act and Deeds.

GAURAV SHARMA, ADVOCATE
Delhi High Court

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client, Mrs. Keshwari Khatoun, W/o Late Sitare Khan, R/o J-3/263, DDA Flats, Alaknanda, Kalkaji, New Delhi-110019, hereby disowns and debars her daughter, Mrs. Muskan @ Muskan Khan, W/o Vinod, from all her movable and immovable properties and personal affairs due to her misconduct and continuous harassment. Any person dealing with her on behalf of my client shall do so at his/her own risk.

Aashi Sharma (Advocate)
D/10630/21

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is for general information that I, HARPREET SINGH GHURA S/O KULDEEP SINGH R/O H NO J-12, Block-J, Lajpat Nagar-III, Delhi-110024 declare that the name of mine has been wrongly written as HARPREET SINGH in my Driving Licence No-DL03 20120348106. The actual name of mine is HARPREET SINGH GHURA which may be amended accordingly.

PUBLIC NOTICE

My Client Brijbala Saxena W/o Mukesh Saxena and Mukesh Saxena S/o- Krishna Prasad Saxena R/o- A-182, Asototeh The Nest Crossing Republic, Distt-Ghaziabad, has disinherited his son Shashank Saxena, daughter-in-law Aditi Saxena, and grandson Adhyansh Saxena from all our movable and immovable properties due to their misconduct. My Client shall not liable and responsible for their future actions.

MANOJ PRAJAPATI (Advocate)
Reg. No.-UP/130/2010

सार्वजनिक सूचना

आम जनता को सूचित किया जाता है कि मेरी मुनिकल सूचना कुमारी गैर सम्पत्ती खतरा कुमर, निवासी 9995, गली नं. 3, सुल्तानी ब्रह्मा, पहाड़गंज, नई दिल्ली-110055 ने अपने पिता प्रहल्लव कुमार सुनुन लोहार का उनके पुत्र अव्यवहार के कारण होने के लिए अपनी संपत्ति सच व असल संपत्तियों से बेवखला कर दिया है। उसके साथी-लेनदेन-व्यवहार के मेरे मुनिकल सचिवपर विमोक्षर नहीं होंगे।

पवन चौधरी एक्वोकेट,
En.D-2235/2004

Sd/-
Rajinder Kumar
Advocate
Enrol. No. D/57115
47, Asaf Ali Road, N. Delhi-2

पब्लिक नोटिस

मेरे मुनिकल विचार अद्यतन एवं शिखा नाव (पति-पत्नी) निवासी-जी-138, जानतुरी, कृष्ण नगर, दिल्ली-110051 ने अपने पुत्र प्रहल्लव अद्यतन सचिव के अप्रद व्यवहार, रगत संगत के कारण सच संपत्ति सम्बन्ध समाप्त कर इसे अपनी सचिव सचिव सचिव सचिव से बेवखला कर दिया है। उसके साथी-लेनदेन-व्यवहार के मेरे मुनिकल सचिवपर विमोक्षर नहीं होंगे।

पवन चौधरी एक्वोकेट,
En.D-2235/2004

COMPREHENSIVE ANNUAL MAINTENANCE CONTRACT

BID NUMBER. GEM/2026/B/7591502
Dated: 27-05-2026. Works tenders through "e" Tendering system for and on behalf of the president of India are invited for the works as detailed below:-

Name of work: Custom Bid For Services- Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract for PMS Parcel Management System equipment. Estimated Bid Value in INR: ₹12.56,671/-, Earnest Money: ₹25,200/-, Bid End Date & Time: At 20.00 hrs. & opening at 20.30 hrs. on 19-06-2026. The complete information with tender documents of above e-tender will be available in the website www.gem.gov.in

DRM (C), Alipurduar Jn.
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public that my clients, **Shri. Manish Singh S/o Sh. Laxmi Narain Singh and Smt. Anita Singh W/o Sh. Harihar Singh**, both residents of RZ F36, Main Palace Dabri Road, Mahanagar Enclave, Delhi-110045, have severed all relations with their son, Mr. Ajay Singh. My clients state that the said Mr. Ajay Singh has neither maintained them nor fulfilled any of his moral, social or legal obligations towards them. Instead, my clients have been subjected to harassment and mental agony by him. Hence, my clients do not wish to continue any relationship with him. Consequently, my clients have disowned and debarred the said Mr. Ajay Singh from all their movable and immovable properties, whether self-acquired or ancestral. He (Mr. Ajay Singh) shall have no right, title, interest, or claim of any nature whatsoever in their properties, either during their lifetime or after their death. If any person deals with Mr. Ajay Singh in respect of his clients' properties or on the basis of his relationship with my clients, they shall do so at their own risk, cost, and consequences. My clients shall not be responsible or liable for any act, debt, transaction, debt, liability, or omission of the said Mr. Ajay Singh.

HARSHI GUPTA (Advocate)
Chamber No. 475, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054 (Mob. 9971368550)

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public that my clients, **Shri. Manish Singh S/o Sh. Laxmi Narain Singh and Smt. Shivani Jindal W/o Sh. Manish Singh**, both residents of RZ F36, Main Palace Dabri Road, Mahanagar Enclave, Delhi-110045, have severed all relations with their son, Mr. Ajay Singh. My clients state that the said Mr. Ajay Singh has neither maintained them nor fulfilled any of his moral, social or legal obligations towards them. Instead, my clients have been subjected to harassment and mental agony, and disturbance to my clients. Hence, my clients do not wish to continue any relationship with him. Consequently, my clients have disowned and debarred the said Mr. Ajay Singh from all their movable and immovable properties, whether self-acquired or ancestral. He (Mr. Ajay Singh) shall have no right, title, interest, or claim of any nature whatsoever in their properties, either during their lifetime or after their death. If any person deals with Mr. Ajay Singh in respect of his clients' properties or on the basis of his relationship with my clients, they shall do so at their own risk, cost, and consequences.

HARSHI GUPTA (Advocate)
Ch. No. 717, Rohini Court, Delhi-85. Mob. 9971368550

"IMPORTANT"

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred by third parties in transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We do not recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting in any manner whatsoever.

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

HEAD
CONSTABLE
RAM YASH
MISHRA
71 BN BSF
06.07.1949
- 13.06.1996

ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CONSTABLE
ABACHA LAL
142 BN BSF
01.07.1967
- 13.06.1990

his injuries.

CONSTABLE
PRASUN KUMAR
MISHRA
94 BN BSF
07.10.1987
- 13.06.2012

ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

SH AZAD
SINGH DALAL,
AC, PPMG
141 BN BSF
08.10.1970
- 13.06.1999

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Abacha Lal on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting with militants in Anantnag city area, J&K and later succumbed to

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

Veer Balidani Sub Inspector/ Ministerial T. R. V. Prasad 69 Bn 24-09-1949 To 13-06-2005

Veer Balidani Sub Inspector/Ramesh Kumar Bhaggal 69 Bn 13-01-1950 To 13-06-2005

Veer Balidani Sub Inspector/ Ministerial A. B. Amber Rao 69 Bn 20-03-1966 To 13-06-2005

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Inspector/ Ministerial T. R. V. Prasad, Sub Inspector/Ministerial A. B. Amber Rao, and Sub Inspector Ramesh Kumar Bhaggal of 69 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice in a car IED blast in Pulwama Bazaar, Jammu & Kashmir on 13 June 2005. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable Sunil Kalita 209 CoBRA Bn 01-02-1987 To 13-06-2019

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Sunil Kalita of 209 CoBRA Bn, who was seriously injured in an IED blast by Maoists during an antiMaoist operation at Raisindri Pahar, Saraikela, Jharkhand on 28 May 2019 and succumbed to his injuries on 13 June 2019. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Twenty seven years ago, on this very day, the glorious history of Indian Army witnessed one of the greatest victories against the enemy in Drass (Kargil) during 'Op Vijay'. We bow our heads in reverence of those soldiers, who in the true rich traditions of the '2nd Battalion the Rajputana Rifles' made the supreme sacrifice for the motherland while fighting the enemy. It is but for you, that today every member of the '2nd Battalion the Rajputana Rifles' holds his head high.

'MAY THE ALMIGHTY CONFER EVERLASTING PEACE TO YOUR NOBLE SOUL'

REMEMBERED AND REVERED BY
COMMANDING OFFICER AND ALL RANKS
2nd BATTALION THE RAJPUTANA RIFLES (TOLOLING)

Maj Vivek Gupta, MVC
Sub Sumer Singh, SM
Sub Bhanwar Lal, Vrc
CHM Yashvir Singh, Vrc
Hav Sultan Singh, Vrc
Nk Chaman Singh
Nk Surendra Singh
L/Nk Jasvir Singh
L/Nk Bachan Singh
Rfn Ashish Kumar

NORTHERN RAILWAY

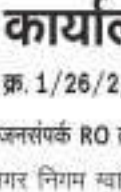
Tender Notice NO. 19/2026-2027 Dated: 12.06.2026



OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE OFFICER
Nagar Prishad, Simri Bakhtiyarpur (Saharsa)
REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)
Development of material Recovery Facility (Solid Waste Management Project)
SHORT Notice for Inviting Re-Tender (NIT) 03/2025-26
(on website- www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
The details of the schedule for the bid are given below:
01. Name Of Publisher and Officer/Address :-Executive Officer, Nagar Parishad, Simri Bakhtiyarpur
02. Tender Invitation Issue Date :- 11.06.2026
03. Bid Submission Start Date :- 20.06.2026 (at 11:00 AM)
(on website-www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
04. Pre Bid Meeting Date/Time/Address :- 22.06.2026 (at 11:00 AM)
Office Nagar Parishad Simri Bakhtiyarpur
:- 30.06.2026 (till 03:00 PM)
Office Nagar Parishad Simri Bakhtiyarpur
(on website-www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
:- 02.07.2026 (till 03:00 PM)
(i) Executive Officer, Nagar Parishad Simri Bakhtiyarpur
(ii) Executive Engineer, Urban Development Division, Saharsa
(iii) Superintending Engineer, Urban Development Circle, Koshi, Saharsa
07. Bid Open Date/Time of online Opening Of Document (Mandatory Document) Technical :- 02.07.2026 (At 03:30 PM)
08. Financial Bid Open Date/Time :- After Disposal of Technical Bid.
Online bids are hereby invited on behalf of NAGAR PARISHAD SIMRI BAKHTIYARPUR from eligible entities for the below mentioned work:

Name Of Work	Estimate d Project Cost (In lac)	Plant Capacity (In TPD)	Bid Security/EMD	Perform ance Security	RFP Document Fee	Tender Fee	Bid Completion Validity of Constructio n Work
Design, Build, Construct, installand commissioning of material recovery facility (MRF) of 10 TPD for dry waste along With operation and maintenance of the plant for 5 years.	275.03	Applicable for 10 TPD	550100.00	Rs. 13,75,2 00.00 (5 % of project cost)	Rs.: 10,000.00	As per Eproc2	06 Months

Executive Officer
Nagar Parishad, Simri Bakhtiyarpur
PR- 005679 (B & C) 2026-27
For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

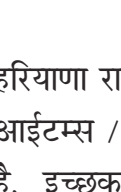


कार्यालय आयुक्त, नगर पालिक निगम, ग्वालियर
क्र. 1/26/2/10/सा.प्र./2026/17166
जमसंक्रं क्रो रमांक 417
नगर निगम ग्वालियर की सीमा अंतर्गत सीवर सफाई कार्य कराये जाने हेतु 300 अकुशल श्रमिक (मैन पॉवर) उपलब्ध कराये जाने के संबंध में।

ई-निविदा सूचना
दिनांक : 11-06-2026
नगर निगम ग्वालियर की सीमा अंतर्गत सीवर सफाई कार्य कराये जाने हेतु 300 अकुशल श्रमिक (मैन पॉवर) उपलब्ध कराये जाने के संबंध में।
अपर आयुक्त, नगर निगम, ग्वालियर

देखर क्र. जारी दिनांक	कार्य का नाम	कार्य की सम्पादधि एवं लागत	निविदा प्रश्न का मूल्य एवं ईपडी	निविदा की अंतिम तिथि
2026_UAD_509934_2	नगर निगम ग्वालियर की सीमा अंतर्गत सीवर सफाई कार्य कराये जाने हेतु 300 अकुशल श्रमिक (मैन पॉवर) उपलब्ध कराये जाने के संबंध में	365 दिन 56448900.00	Rs. 20000 Rs. 282244	25.06.2026 समय सायं 05:30 बजे तक

नोट : 1. इच्छुक बोलीदाता वेबसाइट <https://mptenders.gov.in> पर एनआईटी देख सकते हैं।
2. एनआईटी में कोई संशोधन होता है, तो केवल, वेबसाइट पर प्रकाशित किया जायेगा और समाचार पत्र में नहीं।

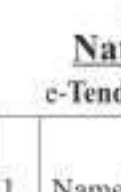


कार्यालय आयुक्त, नगर पालिक निगम, ग्वालियर
क्र. 1/26/2/10/सा.प्र./2026/17166
जमसंक्रं क्रो रमांक 417
नगर निगम ग्वालियर की सीमा अंतर्गत सीवर सफाई कार्य कराये जाने हेतु 300 अकुशल श्रमिक (मैन पॉवर) उपलब्ध कराये जाने के संबंध में।

ई-निविदा सूचना
दिनांक : 11-06-2026
नगर निगम ग्वालियर की सीमा अंतर्गत सीवर सफाई कार्य कराये जाने हेतु 300 अकुशल श्रमिक (मैन पॉवर) उपलब्ध कराये जाने के संबंध में।
अपर आयुक्त, नगर निगम, ग्वालियर

देखर क्र. जारी दिनांक	कार्य का नाम	कार्य की सम्पादधि एवं लागत	निविदा प्रश्न का मूल्य एवं ईपडी	निविदा की अंतिम तिथि
2026_UAD_509934_2	नगर निगम ग्वालियर की सीमा अंतर्गत सीवर सफाई कार्य कराये जाने हेतु 300 अकुशल श्रमिक (मैन पॉवर) उपलब्ध कराये जाने के संबंध में	365 दिन 56448900.00	Rs. 20000 Rs. 282244	25.06.2026 समय सायं 05:30 बजे तक

नोट : 1. इच्छुक बोलीदाता वेबसाइट <https://mptenders.gov.in> पर एनआईटी देख सकते हैं।
2. एनआईटी में कोई संशोधन होता है, तो केवल, वेबसाइट पर प्रकाशित किया जायेगा और समाचार पत्र में नहीं।

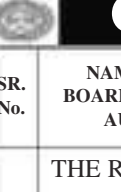


कार्यालय आयुक्त, नगर पालिक निगम, ग्वालियर
क्र. 1/26/2/10/सा.प्र./2026/17166
जमसंक्रं क्रो रमांक 417
नगर निगम ग्वालियर की सीमा अंतर्गत सीवर सफाई कार्य कराये जाने हेतु 300 अकुशल श्रमिक (मैन पॉवर) उपलब्ध कराये जाने के संबंध में।

ई-निविदा सूचना
दिनांक : 11-06-2026
नगर निगम ग्वालियर की सीमा अंतर्गत सीवर सफाई कार्य कराये जाने हेतु 300 अकुशल श्रमिक (मैन पॉवर) उपलब्ध कराये जाने के संबंध में।
अपर आयुक्त, नगर निगम, ग्वालियर

देखर क्र. जारी दिनांक	कार्य का नाम	कार्य की सम्पादधि एवं लागत	निविदा प्रश्न का मूल्य एवं ईपडी	निविदा की अंतिम तिथि
2026_UAD_509934_2	नगर निगम ग्वालियर की सीमा अंतर्गत सीवर सफाई कार्य कराये जाने हेतु 300 अकुशल श्रमिक (मैन पॉवर) उपलब्ध कराये जाने के संबंध में	365 दिन 56448900.00	Rs. 20000 Rs. 282244	25.06.2026 समय सायं 05:30 बजे तक

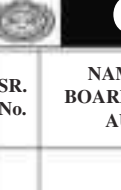
नोट : 1. इच्छुक बोलीदाता वेबसाइट <https://mptenders.gov.in> पर एनआईटी देख सकते हैं।
2. एनआईटी में कोई संशोधन होता है, तो केवल, वेबसाइट पर प्रकाशित किया जायेगा और समाचार पत्र में नहीं।



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA
TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE ROHTAK CO OP MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED	HIRING OF VEHICLE FOR TRANSPORTATION OF SFSMP TO GOVT. SCHOOLS IN BLOCKS OF ROHTAK, SONIPAT, JHAJJAR, REWARI, MAHENDARGARH DISTRICTS	13.06.2026 02.07.2026	AS PER DNIT	vitaindia@gmail.com	9896401185 vitarotak@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 46200/HRY



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA
TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATIO N SONIPAT	PROVIDING AND FIXING OF SANITARY NAPKIN VENDING MACHINE,INCINERATOR ,DASHBOARD AND SANITARY NAPKINS AT VARIOUS LOCATION IN MC SONIPAT. + 1 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 22.06.2026	69,56,270/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01302260100 xenhortmcs@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No- 46199/HRY



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA
TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, PALWAL	CONSTRUCTION OF 01 NO. SECURITY ROOM IN JUDICIAL COMPLEX AT HODAL IN PALWAL DISTT. (WITHOUT GST). + 3 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 16.06.2026	24.58 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466219169 pwd-eeepd-palwal@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, AMBALA	CONSTRUCTION OF WAR MEMORIAL AT AMBALA CANTT IN THE HONOUR OF MARTYRS OF THE FIRST WAR OF INDIA INDEPENDENCE, 1857, AMBALA CANTT IN DISTRICT AMBALA AZADI KI PHELI LADAI KA SHAHEEDI SAMARAK) - ART EXHIBITS WORK O F MEMORIAL TOWER (PHASE - III).	04.06.2026 24.06.2026	1228.85 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01712977224 pwd-eeepd1-ambala@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, KARNAL	COMPREHENSIVE MAINTENANCE CONTRACT OF VARIOUS DG SET INSTALLED ON VARIOUS SITES UNDER ELECTRICAL SUB DIVISION PWD BANDR BR., PANIPAT FOR THE YEAR 2026-27 + 7 WORKS	12.06.2026 18.06.2026	233.46 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01842265696 pwd-eeed-karnal@hry.nic.in
4	PWD B&R, YAMUNA NAGAR	STRENGTHENING OF SAHARANPUR-KURUKSHETRA (SH-06) ROAD (ID 559) KM.37.18 TO 50.195 AND 52.255 TO 55.00) PROVIDING 115MM DBM PLUS 40MM BC ALONG WITH GEOGRID IN YAMUNA NAGAR DISTRICT	11.06.2026 02.07.2026	3531.96 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172237834 pwd-eeepd-yamunanagar@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, HISAR	CONSTRUCTION OF NEW PWD REST HOUSE HISAR (PDG. 11 KV SUBSTATION, DG SET AND STREET LIGHT), + 2 WORKS	11.06.2026 16.06.2026	806.56 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	1662225651 pwd-eeed-hissar@hry.nic.in
6	PWD B&R, HISAR	SPECIAL REPAIR TO E.I. IN CIVIL HOSPITAL AT HISAR (PDG. POWER MANAGEMENT UNIT AND ISOLATION TRANSFORMER IN NICU WARD IN CIVIL HOSPITAL HISAR	11.06.2026 16.06.2026	14.35 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	1662225651 pwd-eeed-hissar@hry.nic.in
7	PWD B&R, HISAR	CONSTRUCTION OF NEW PWD REST HOUSE AT HISAR IN DISTT. HISAR (PDG. 1 NO. LIFT ONLY).	11.06.2026 16.06.2026	20 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	1662225651 pwd-eeed-hissar@hry.nic.in
8	PANCHAYATI RAJ ,KARNAL	SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND DISMANTLING WITH 5 YEAR MAINTENANCE OF STREET LIGHTS IN BLOCK NILOKHERI DISTRICT KARNAL PHASE 2 AND SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND DISMANTLING WITH 5 YEAR MAINTENANCE OF STREET LIGHTS IN BLOCK NISSING DISTRICT KARNAL PHASE 2 + 2 WORKS	10.06.2026 18.06.2026	76.80 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896634422 prexeeng.krl@hry.nic.in
9	PANCHAYATI RAJ , PANCHKULA	PROVIDING 261 NO 'S OF STREET LIGHTS IN 10 VILLAGES OF DISTRICT PANCHKULA AT VILLAGE BHAGWANPUR, BUNGA, TAPRIAN, SHYAMTOO, KHAIRWALI PARWALA , HANGOLA, KAKRALI, KHERI , NATWAL , REHNA	10.06.2026 16.06.2026	11.71 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416915374 prexeeng.pkl@hry.nic.in
10	PANCHAYATI RAJ , ROHTAK	SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND DISMANTLING OF STREET LIGHTS IN VARIOUS VILLAGE DISTRICT ROHTAK	11.06.2026 18.06.2026	59.43 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01262254150 prexeeng.roh@hry.nic.in
11	PANCHAYATI RAJ ,PANCHKULA	BADONA KHURD : CONST. OF STREET FROM H/O RAJENDER TO H/O HARVINDER IN VILLAGE BADONA KHURD, PG TIBBI MAJRA, BLOCK RAIPURRANI, DISTRICT PANCHKULA (VANGY 2025-26) + 4 WORKS	09.06.2026 15.06.2026	159.98 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416915374 prexeeng.pkl@hry.nic.in
12	PANCHAYATI RAJ , SIRSA	SIRSA- SUPPLY INSTALLATION AND DISMANTLING OF STREET LIGHTS AT VILLAGE BHAWDIN, SUCHAN, DADU, GHUKANWALI, JALALANA, LAKRANWALI, NUHANWALI, DHANI BACHAN SINGH, KEHARWALA, GORIWALA, LOHGAH, MASITAN, ALIKAN, BIRUWALAGUDHA, SUKHCHAIN, BAHITYA, BHAROLIJANWALI, ODHAN (TOTAL-18NOS VILLAGE) BLOCK SIRSA, ODHAN, ELLENABAD, DABWALI, BARAGUDHA, RANIA IN DISTRICT SIRSA. (HGVY-2ND PHASE)	09.06.2026 17.06.2026	35.37 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9017622646 prexeening.srs@hry.nic.in
13	PANCHAYATI RAJ , AMBALA	PDG. SUPPLY, DISMANTLING AND INSTALLATION WITH 5 YEARS MAINTENANCE OF STREET LIGHTS IN 5 NO. VILLAGES OF BLOCK AMBALA-I AND 5 NO. VILLAGES OF BLOCK AMBALA-II DISTT AMBALA + 2 WORKS	09.06.2026 15.06.2026	45.15 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0171-2551368 prexeeng.amb@hry.nic.in
14	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, ROHTAK	DEWEEDING AND BANK CLEARANCE OF JASRANA MINOR FROM RD 30000 TO 160650. + 16 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 18.06.2026	36.48 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812111077 xenwsdnrkt@gmail.com
15	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, ROHTAK	DEWEEDING OF ROHAD MINOR FROM RD 0 TO 9750 FOR THE YEAR 2026 + 7 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 18.06.2026	55.95 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9464040970 xensampla@gmail.com
16	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, PANIPAT	INTERNAL CLEARANCE OF 1-R MINOR FROM RD 0 TO 34175 BERFORE KHARIF SEASON 2026. + 6 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 18.06.2026	8.59 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466159501 xenpwsdlv@yahoo.com
17	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, SONIPAT	INTERNAL CLEARANCE, DEWEEDING AND SURFACE DRESSING (JUNGLE CLEARANCE) OF ROHNA MINOR FROM RD 0 TO 55822, KAKROI DISTY FROM RD 0 TO 9207 AND SEHITI MINOR FROM RD 0 TO 13743 BEFORE KHARIF 2026-27 + 3 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 17.06.2026	14.95 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9050101646 xenws@rediffmail.com
18	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADRI	REQUIREMENT OF SUPPLY AND FIXING OF 95 SQ MM 3 CORE ALUMINUM ARMOURED CABLE FOR VARIOUS PUMP HOUSES OF BADHWANA DISTY., SAMASPUR & GOTHA MINOR AND 3 MORE WORKS	CLOSING DATE 18.06.2026	3.84 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01250-220058 xenlwsmech@gmail.com
19	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	PROCUREMENT OF DIGITAL RADIOGRAPHY MACHINE (X-RAY)	13.06.2026 26.06.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
20	AYUSH DEPARTMENT, ROHTAK	PROVIDING AND FIXING OF TENTAGE FOR INTERNATIONAL YOGA DAY AT RAJIV GANDHI STADIUM, ROHTAK FOR 20TH JUNE 2026 AND 21TH JUNE 2026.	11.06.2026 16.06.2026	3.50 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416357406 daorhtk.ayush-hry@nic.in
21	CIVIL SURGEON,SIRSA	E-TENDER OF MEDICINE/ CONSUMABLE/MINOR EQUIPMENT/LAB REAGENTS/DENTAL ITEMS/SURGICAL & OTHER INSTRUMENT, DISTRICT SIRSA	15.06.2026 06.07.2026	EMD 50000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9416255807 gargpardeep12@gmail.com
22	CIVIL SURGEON, JIND	SUPPLYING OF LAB ITEMS AND OTHER ITEMS	09.06.2026 22.06.2026	EMD 1 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	7015444191 cds.jind@gmail.com
23	CIVIL AVIATION DEPARTMENT, HARYANA	SELECTION OF PROJECT MANAGEMENT UNIT (PMU) FOR PROCESS IMPROVEMENT AND ADVISORY SERVICES	09.06.2026 30.06.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01722709386 cavation@hry.nic.in
24	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE & CONSUMABLE (VITAMIN K 1MG, INJ. ANTI RABIES VACCINE, INJ. METRONIDAZOLE 1.V 100ML, INJ. TERLIPRESSIN 0.1MG/ML, 10ML ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	12.06.2026 19.06.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896154463 director.kgch-hry@gov.in
25	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	REGARDING E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE & CONSUMABLE (TAB. AMLODIPINE 5MG, TAB. TELMISARTAN 40MG, TAB. METOPROLOL 50MG, TAB. CLOPIDOGREL 75MG ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	15.06.2026 22.06.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896154463 director.kgch-hry@gov.in
26	WOMEN & CHILD DEVELOPMENT, PANCHKULA	TRANSPORTATION WORK OF SNP AND OTHER SUPPLY TO AWC'S	12.06.2026 21.06.2026	EMD CONTRACTOR 50,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812343208 dpopkl.wcd@gmail.com
27	WOMEN & CHILD DEVELOPMENT, PANCHKULA	HIRING OF SEDAN VEHICLES	12.06.2026 21.06.2026	EMD CONTRACTOR 20,000/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812343208 dpopkl.wcd@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 46188/HRY

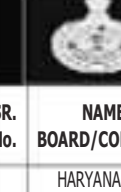


कार्यालय नगर निगम, भागलपुर
BAGALPUR
NIT NO -13 /2026 -27
1. Name and Address of advertiser :- Municipal Commissioner , Muncipal corporation Bhagalpur.

NOTICE INVITING e-tender
2. Date of issue of NIT :- 11-06-2026
3. Start of uploading and downloading of Bid documents :- 29-06-2026
4. Pre Bid Meeting :- 06-07-2026 (at 11:00 AM)
5. Last date of online Bid submission :- 31-07-2026 (at 03:00 pm)
6. Technical Bid opening date :- 31-07-2026 (at 04:00pm)
7. Financial Bid Opening date :- After completion of bid evaluation – Technical Bid
The description of the work is given below :-

Sl No	Name of work:	Estimated Projected lost (in rupees)	EMD (IN RS)	Document fee (in rupee)	Bid processing Fee
1	The Municipal Commissioner, Bhagalpur Municipal Corporation, Bihar invites for door to door Collection, segregation of Municipal solid waste (MSW) from each residential and commercial establishments, drain Cleaning & transportation to the transfer stations/ processing site including: manual road sweeping, etc. in municipal corporation, Bhagalpur for four (4) years from ward no 1 to 51.	215,19,88,406.6	2,25,19,884.00	10,000.00 + 18% GST	As per aproc 2.0

1. Bid Validity :- 180 Days
2. The bid forms and other details can be seen & downloaded from the website portal <https://www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in>.
• Document fee is mandatory to be paid through online mode i.e internet payment gateway (Credit /Debit Card), Net banking, NEFT /RTGS in favour of Municipal Commissioner, Municipal Corporation Bhagalpur.
• The RFP May be Postponed, modified or Cancelled at any time due to administrative reasons and No Claim shall be entertained on this account.
For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar
Municipal Commissioner
Municipal corporation Bhagalpur
PR- 005647 (B & C) 2026-27
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।



GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA
TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA POLICE CORPORATION PANCHKULA	CONSTRUCTION OF GOVT. NURSING COLLEGE SAFIDON, JIND. + 8 WORKS	11.06.2026 18.06.2026	60,55,77,924/-	www.hphc.org.in	9463200487 dpnanchkula@yahoo.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 46171/HRY



UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LTD.
(A Govt. of Uttarakhand Undertaking) Victoria Cross Vijeta Gabar Singh Urja Bhawan, Kanwali Road, Dehradun -248001
Corporate Identity No. UA40109UP2001SGC025867/2358 Telephone-(0135)-2763672-76, Fax:(0135)-2760289 Website: www.uktenders.gov.in

E-TENDER NOTICE (NIT)
No: 416/EE(CM)/UPCLA-2
Date: 11/06/2026
TENDER SPECIFICATION NO. CCP-II/6/2026-2027
Uttarakhand Power Corporation Ltd. Dehradun invites e-tender for following work as detailed below:

Sl. No	Name of work	Estimated Cost (in ₹ Crore)	Average Yearly Turnover of preceding three financial years (in ₹ Crore)	Earnest Money Deposit (in ₹ Lakh)	Cost of tender document including GST (in ₹)	Last Date & time of online request for Tender and submission of tender in online & off line mode	Date of opening of Part-I of tender in online & off line mode
1	Engagement of agency for design, development & Implementation of cloud based Automated monthly invoice verification of Power Purchase through software/ application for one year and verification vis a vis certification of past years invoices of power purchase	2.369	4.00	4.74	11800	27-06-2026 upto 17:00 Hrs.	29-06-2026 at 15:30 Hrs.

For further details, please visit our website www.uktenders.gov.in.
Superintending Engineer
Corporate (Contract & Procurement-II)
SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF THE NATION. Use LED Bulb, Save Electricity (Toll Free No. 1912) *Pay Electricity bill online 24x7 from www.upcl.org . (For information on Electricity theft, informer may report to Toll free No 18001804185/ Fax No 0135-2760911)



Haryana Government Gazette
EXTRAORDINARY
Published by Authority
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No. 86-2026/Ext. CHANDIGARH, FRIDAY, JUNE 5, 2026 (JYAISTHA 15, 1948 SAKA)

HARYANA GOVERNMENT
TOWN AND COUNTRY PLANNING DEPARTMENT
Notification
The 5th June, 2026
No. CCP(NCR)/JR/NH-352/ACA/2026/844.- Whereas, in the opinion of the Governor of Haryana, the area specified in the Schedule given below and shown in the plan appended hereto, has the potential for building activities, industrial, commercial, institutional or recreational estates' activities and uses subservient to the above;
Now, therefore, in exercise of the powers conferred under sub-section (1) of section 4 of the Haryana Scheduled Roads and Controlled Areas Restriction of Unregulated Development Act, 1963 (Punjab Act 41 of 1963), the Governor of Haryana hereby declares the said area, as specified in the Schedule given below and shown in the plan appended hereto, to be a controlled area for the purposes of the said Act, namely:
SCHEDULE
Schedule of boundaries of the Additional Controlled Area, Part-I (Pocket A and B) along National Highway No. 352 (Rohtak-Jhajjar-Rewari road) in district Jhajjar to be read with Drawing No. DTP(JH)681/2022 dated the 20th December, 2022/29th February, 2024/16th February 2026.
Pocket A
North: Starting from point 'A' i.e. north-west corner of rectangle number 1 of village Gijarod (Hadbast Number 260), which is located on the boundary of controlled area, Jhajjar already published vide notification No. 260-10DP-82/4784 dated the 26th March, 1982 also, towards east along the boundary of above said controlled area, Jhajjar published vide notification dated the 26th March, 1982 upto point 'B', where it meets the boundary of the controlled area along Rohtak-Jhajjar-Rewari road (NH-352), Part-I, District Jhajjar already published vide notification No. CCP(NCR)/JH/CA/2013/2588 dated the 7th November, 2013.
East: Thence moving from point 'B' towards south along the boundary of above said controlled area already published vide notification dated the 7th November, 2013 upto point 'C', where it meets the common district boundary of Jhajjar and Rewari.
South: Thence moving from point 'C' towards west along the common district boundary of Jhajjar and Rewari upto point 'D' i.e. the north-west corner of rectangle No. 63 of village Koka (Hadbast No. 247). Thence, towards east along northern boundary of rectangle No. 63 of village Koka (Hadbast No. 247) upto point 'E' i.e. the north-east corner of rectangle No. 63 of village Koka (Hadbast No. 247).
West: Thence moving from point 'E' towards north along western boundary of rectangle Nos. 59, 53, 48, 41, 33, 27, 17 and 14 of village Koka (Hadbast No. 247), rectangle Nos. 71, 54, 43 and 24 of village Ahri (Hadbast No. 246), rectangle Nos. 67, 60, 52, 41, 30, 19, 10 and 4 of village Asadpur Khera (Hadbast No. 241), rectangle Nos. 123, 117, 102, 95, 75, 66, 45, 36, 22, 14, 11, 4 and 3 of village Machhroli (Hadbast No. 240), rectangle Nos. 63, 55, 52, 45, 41, 34, 28 and 21 of village Kirlod (Hadbast No. 235) upto point 'F' i.e. the north-west corner of rectangle No. 21 of village Kirlod (Hadbast No. 235). Thence, moving from point 'F' towards east along northern boundary of rectangle Nos. 21, 20 and 19 of village Kirlod (Hadbast No. 235) upto point 'G' i.e. north-east corner of rectangle No. 19 of village Kirlod (Hadbast No. 235). Thence, moving from point 'G', towards north along western boundary of rectangle No. 15 of village Kirlod (Hadbast No. 235), rectangle Nos. 80, 77, 69, 66, 59, 47, 42, 29, 24, 11, 8 and 1 of village Gijarod (Hadbast No. 260) upto point 'A' i.e. the point of start.
Pocket B
North: Starting from point 'A' i.e. the north-west corner of rectangle No. 4 of village Silana (Hadbast No. 259), which is located on the boundary of controlled area, Jhajjar already published vide notification No. 260-10DP-82/4784 dated the 26th March, 1982 also, towards east along the boundary of above said controlled area, Jhajjar published vide notification dated



UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

e-Tender Notice
Letter No: 494 Date: 12/06/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil), MB-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites online e-bid from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below.

Tender No: 10/EE(Civil)/MB-II/Chinyalisaur/2026-27

Name of work: Providing & Laying of Flooring in Machine Floor at Dharasu Power House, MB-II at Dharasu, Uttarkashi.

Estimated Cost :- Rs. 1,42,30,876.00/- (excluding GST)

Date of availability of bid document on website: 16.06.2026 from 5:00 PM

Last date for submission of bid on website: 08.07.2026 upto 05:00 PM

For fuller & further details, kindly visit "e-procurement portal "http://uktenders.gov.in"

Executive Engineer (Civil), MB-II, Chinyalisaur.

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

BENGALURU METROPOLITAN TRANSPORT CORPORATION Central Office: Stores & Purchases Dept., K.H. Road, Shantinagar, Bengaluru-560 027. No: BMT/CO/COSP/TENDER/07/2026-27 Date: 12.06.2026			
NOTICE INVITING TENDER			
BMTCT Invites Tender for Procurement of the following Goods & Services through KPP Portal:			
Sl. No.	Tender No.	Description	Last date for bid submission in KPP Portal
Short-Term Tender			
1	BMTC/2026-27/IND0305	Procurement of Dashboard Instruments.	24-06-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
2	BMTC/2026-27/IND0306	Procurement of Masking Tape and sanding disc.	24-06-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
3	BMTC/2026-27/IND0307	Procurement of Cotton waste & Banian waste.	24-06-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
4	BMTC/2026-27/IND0304	Procurement of Fuel Injection pipes & Leak off pipes.	24-06-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
5	BMTC/2026-27/IND0308	Procurement of Fan Belts.	24-06-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
6	BMTC/2026-27/IND0309	Procurement of Thin Walled Bearing	24-06-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
7	BMTC/2026-27/IND0315	Procurement of Water Pump Assembly.	24-06-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
8	BMTC/2026-27/IND0314	Procurement of Rubber Parts.	24-06-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
Regular Tender			
9	BMTC/2026-27/IND0302	Procurement of King pin kit and components	29-06-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
10	BMTC/2026-27/IND0303	Procurement of Spring Leaves	29-06-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
11	BMTC/2026-27/IND0313	Procurement of Brake & Brake Parts	15-07-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
12	BMTC/2026-27/IND0310	Procurement of M S Flat and M S Angles	30-06-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
13	BMTC/2026-27/IND0311	Procurement of Vinyl flooring mat	30-06-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
14	BMTC/2026-27/IND0312	Procurement of Desktop computers	30-06-2026 at 17.00 Hrs
Corrigendum: Due to Administrative reasons the below mentioned tender has been Cancelled			
15	BMTC/2025-26/IND0217	Procurement of Brake & Brake Parts	Tender Cancelled
The above mentioned tender details can be obtained from https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in . Further any addendum/corrigendum in respect of change in calendar of events, specification, other tender terms and conditions etc. will be uploaded/published through kpp portal only.			
Note: Interested Bidders need to register in the e-procurement portal. For further information visit BMTCT Central Office or log on to https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in			
Sd/- CONTROLLER OF STORES AND PURCHASES (Tender Inviting Authority)			



BENGALURU SOUTH CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer,
BTM Layout Division, BBMP Complex, 2nd Floor,
Laskar Hosur Road, Adugodi, Bengaluru - 560030.

No: EE/BTM/KPPP/05/2026-27
INVITATION FOR TENDER (IFT) - (SHORT TERM)
(Two Cover System) (Through GOK KPP Portal only)

The Executive Engineer, BTM Layout Division, BSCC, Bengaluru invites Tenders from eligible Contractors registered in GBA or equivalent registration with CPWD / KPWD or any State Government Organizations for the Construction of Works detailed below.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1st CALL	
1	Comprehensive Development of Roads, Drains and Other Developmental Works in J.D. Mara Slum, Block No. 114_1, 114_2 in BTM Layout in Ward No. 180 and Jogi Colony in Block No. 13 in Ward No. 178, Suddagunte Palya, Approximated Amount of Work (Rs. in Lakhs): 200.00, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 3,00,000/-
2	Comprehensive Development of Roads, Drains, Footpath and Other Developmental Works and Surrounding Area in Koramangala Sub Division in Ward No. 173 (Ejipura), Ward No. 174 (Koramangala) and Ward No. 175 (Jakkasandra), Approximated Amount of Work (Rs. in Lakhs): 250.00, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 3,75,000/-
3	Comprehensive Development of Roads, Drains and Other Developmental Works in Adugodi Village, Balappa Layout, Munikrishna Layout in Block No. 164, 60, 12 and 21 in Ward No. 176, Adugodi and Chandrappa Nagar in Block No. 127, 126, 128, 125 and 129 in Ward No. 177, Lakkasandra, Approximated Amount of Work (Rs. in Lakhs): 250.00, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 3,75,000/-
4	Comprehensive Development of Roads, Drains and Other Developmental Works in Indiragandhi Slum, A.K. Colony, Shastri Nagara in Block No. 175_2, 175_1, 5, 134, 9 and 8 in Ward No. 173, Ejipura, Approximated Amount of Work (Rs. in Lakhs): 200.00, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 3,00,000/-
5	Comprehensive Development of Roads, Drains and Other Developmental Works in Rajendranagara Slum, A.K. Colony, Mestripalya Village, Koramangala Village in Block No. 5, 73, 32, 74, 28 and 27 in Ward No. 174, Koramangala, Approximated Amount of Work (Rs. in Lakhs): 100.00, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 2,00,000/-
6	Comprehensive Development of Roads, Drains, Footpath and Other Developmental Works and Surrounding Area in Adugodi Sub Division in Ward No. 176 (Adugodi), Ward No. 177 (Lakkasandra) and Ward No. 178 (Suddaguntepalya), Approximated Amount of Work (Rs. in Lakhs): 250.00, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 3,75,000/-
7	Comprehensive Development of Roads, Drains, Footpath and Other Developmental Works and Surrounding Area in BTM Layout Sub Division in Ward No. 179 (Madiwala), Ward No. 180 (Someshwara Temple Ward) and Ward No. 181 (BTM Layout), Approximated Amount of Work (Rs. in Lakhs): 250.00, EMD Amount (in Rs.): 3,75,000/-
Calendar of Events: 1) Tender document can be downloaded from the GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Website: https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in 2) Pre Bid Meeting will be held on 22-06-2026 at 15.00 hours in the Office of the Chief Engineer, Bommanahalli South Zone-2, BSCC, Begur Main Road, Bengaluru - 560068. 3) Tenders must be Submitted online through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal on or before 16.00 Hours on 25-06-2026. 4) Technical Bids will be Opened on the Website: https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in at the Office of the Executive Engineer, BTM Layout Division on or after 29-06-2026 at 11.30 Hours. Further details can be had from the above office.	
Sd/- Executive Engineer, BTM Layout Division, BSCC.	



NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
Open Tender Notice No.
SrDEE-TRD-BSB-2026-27-T06
Date- 10.06.2026

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD, North Eastern Railway, Varanasi for and on behalf of President of India, invites sealed "OPEN E - Tender for the following work.

S. N 1 :- Name of work: Outsourcing of PSI Maintenance Activities of BSB Division CHPG - GKC Section including HTW/SP of N.E. Railway for 2 Years. Tender reference no: Sr.DEE-TRD-BSB-2026-27-T06, Approx. Cost (in Rs.): ₹18096372.94, Earnest money (in Rs.): ₹3619000/- Cost of tender documents (in Rs.): Nil, E-Tender closing date and Time: 02.07.2026 upto 14:45 Hrs. Completion period: 24 Months, E-Tender Online will be submitted up to 14:45 Hrs on date 02.07.2026. For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the Official website of Indian railway i.e. www.irops.gov.in Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD CP/RO/Elect-67 Varanasi

Never travel on roof and foot boards.



NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice

Online open E-tender are invited by Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer (TRS)/N. E. Railway/ Loco Shed Gonda acting for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work. Tender Notice No. & Description : 1. Tender No. :- LS-GD-2026- Loco_Painting1, "PU painting of electric locomotives at Loco shed Gonda for 1 year." Estimated Cost (in Rs.) :- 47,04,545.03; Period of Completion :- 12 months, Earnest Money (in Rs.) :- 94,100.00; ● Offer can be uploaded by tenderer, up to 12:00 Hrs. on 01.07.2026. ● Detailed information, minimum eligibility criteria. Terms and condition regarding this e-tender are available at website www.irops.gov.in ● Tenderer should check any correction/corrigendum related to this e-tender notice on website before uploading their offer. Note:- I. Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders and any such manual offer received, shall be ignored. 2. For full details and submission of bid, kindly visit the official website of Indian Railways i.e. www.irops.gov.in ADEE/TRS, N. E. Railway, Loco Shed Gonda CP/RO/EL - 68

"Never travel on roof and foot boards"



UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Short Term Tender Notice
Letter No: 491 Date: 12/06/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (M&G) Kulhal Power Station, Kulhal, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No. 05/UJVNL/EE(M&G)/KPS/2026-27: "Trash Rack, Intake Area Cleaning and other associated work at Kulhal Power House for one year"

Estimated cost: Rs. 10,40,000/- GST Extra

Date of availability of bid document on website: 13/06/2026 11:00 Hrs

Last date for submission of tender: 23/06/2026 15:00 Hrs

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com"

Executive Engineer (M&G) Kulhal

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"



UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता प्रमंडल, मेदिनीनगर
ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
(1st Call)
निविदा सूचना संख्या – DWSD/RPWS/Med-04/2026-27
दिनांक 11.06.2026

क्र. सं.	कार्य का नाम	Remaining work of PANDU Rural Water Supply Scheme under Drinking Water & Sanitation Division, Medinipur on turnkey basis. 'Year 2026-2027.
1	प्राकृतिक राशि लगभग (लाख में)	600.14 (छ. करोड़ चौदह हजार रुपये मात्र)
2	अग्रचन की राशि (लाख में)	6.0015 (छ. लाख एक हजार बीस बी रुपये मात्र)
3	परिमाण विवरण का मूल्य	10,000/- (दस हजार रुपये मात्र)
4	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	18 (अठारह) महीना + 3 (तीन) महीना Trial & Run
5	वेबसाइट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि एवं समय	24/06/2026 / 12.30 बजे अपराह्न तक
6	क्रो बोल की तिथि एवं समय	24/06/2026 / 12.30 बजे अपराह्न तक (अभियंता प्रमुख का कार्यालय, पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता विभाग, झारखंड, राँची, मेडिनगर हाउस)
7	बीड प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	04/07/2026 / 05.00 बजे अपराह्न तक
8	संस्कार के साक्ष्य, सूचना प्रक्रिया की एवं ई-गवर्नेन्स, झारखंड मंत्रालय, के झापाक 120 दिनांक 03.10.2023 के आलेख में विहित का मूल्य एवं अग्रचन की राशि Online जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	04/07/2026 / 05.00 बजे अपराह्न तक
9	निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय	06/07/2026 / 05.00 बजे अपराह्न तक
10	निविदा खोलने वाले के कार्यालय का पता	कार्यपालक अभियंता, पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता प्रमंडल, मेदिनीनगर।
11	निविदा खोलने वाले परदाधिकारी के कार्यालय का पता	कार्यपालक अभियंता, पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता प्रमंडल, मेदिनीनगर।
12	ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट परदाधिकारी का सम्पर्क	9973742366
13	ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट सेल का हेल्पलाइन नं०	0651-2490920

नोट:- निविदा की प्राकृतिक राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है। तत्पश्चात अग्रचन की राशि देय माय्य होगा।

विस्तृत जानकारी हेतु वेबसाइट <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> पर कार्यालय अभियंता, पेयजल एवं स्वच्छता प्रमंडल, मेदिनीनगर।

PR 382286 (Drinking Water and Sanitation) 26-27 (D)



REFORM ARC LIMITED
(Formerly known as Reliance Asset Reconstruction Company Limited)
2nd floor ICC Chambers, Saki Vihar Road,
Near MTNL Telephone Exchange, Powai Mumbai 400072

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION SALE OF SECURED ASSETS

REFORM ARC LIMITED (Formerly known as Reliance Asset Reconstruction Company Limited) called as "RARC", acting in its capacity as Trustee of "RARC 068 Trust" is an assignee and a secured creditor of below mentioned borrowers by virtue of Assignment Agreement dated 30.03.2022 executed with Indian Overseas Bank.

The undersigned in exercise of powers conferred under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 hereby give notice to public in general that the below mentioned property shall be sold by way of "online e-auction" for recovery of dues. The properties shall be sold strictly on "AS IS WHERE IS", "AS IS WHAT IS" and "NO RECOURSE" basis apart from other terms mentioned below.

NAME OF BORROWER/GUARANTORS/MORTGAGORS

1. M/s Shree JI Enterprises (Borrower), At - R/o L- 1194, Shastri Nagar, Meerut, U.P- 205002

2. Mr. Ravi Goe! S/o Mr. Rajendra Kumar Goe! (Proprietor/Mortgagor) , At - R/o 364/5, Nehru Nagar, Garh Road, Meerut, U.P- 250002

Total Outstanding dues as on date 03.06.2026 are Rs. 2,48,11,612.11/- (Rupees Two Crores Forty Eight Lakhs Eleven Thousand Six Hundred Twelve and Paise Eleven Only) with future interest thereon till the date of realization.

Date of Symbolic Possession: 09.07.2024

DESCRIPTION OF IMMOVABLE THE PROPERTY

EM on all that Part and Parcel of the Residential Plot situated at Kharsa No. 706, Village - Palwara, Tehsil - Garh Mukteshwar, Dist. Hapur. Measuring 854.68 Sq. Mtr. or 1022.23 Sq. Yards. By Mr. Ravi Goe! S/o Mr. Rajendra Kumar Goe!.

RESERVE PRICE :- Rs. 44,00,000/- (Rupees Forty Four Lakhs Only)

EMD AMOUNT:- Rs.4,40,000/- (Rupees Four Lakh Forty Thousand Only)

Details Of Auction Events:-

Date of Inspection of Property : 25.06.2026 from 11A.M. to 1 P.M.

Last date for bid submission : 29.06.2026

Date of e-auction : 30.06.2026 between 11 A.M to 12 P.M. (with extension of 5 minutes each)

TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF E-AUCTION SALE

1. The property shall not be sold below the reserve price and sale shall be subject to confirmation by REFORM ARC LIMITED (Formerly known as Reliance Asset Reconstruction Company Limited) as secured creditor. The properties shall be sold strictly on "AS IS WHERE IS", "AS IS WHAT IS" and "NO RECOURSE".

2. The E-Auction shall be conducted through REFORM ARC LIMITED (Formerly known as Reliance Asset Reconstruction Company Limited) approved service provider M/s ARCA EMART PRIVATE LIMITED through the website: <https://www.auctionbazaar.com>. Detailed terms and conditions of the E-Auction, Bid Form, and Tender Documents are available on: www.rarc.co.in and <https://www.auctionbazaar.com>.

3. Intending bidders must possess a valid e-mail ID. The Participation ID and Password will be communicated only through e-mail by the E-Auction service provider.

4. Interested bidders shall submit the duly filled Bid Form along with proof of EMD deposit and self-attested KYC documents (PAN Card, Aadhaar Card, etc.) to the Authorized Officer at: REFORM ARC LIMITED (Formerly known as Reliance Asset Reconstruction Company Limited) 2nd floor ICC Chambers, Saki Vihar Road, Near MTNL Telephone Exchange, Powai Mumbai 400072 and by email to himanshu.yadav@rarc.co.in and Narendra.shukla@rarc.co.in. Last date of submission of Bid Form is 29.06.2026. Bid Forms received late or without EMD shall be summarily rejected.

5. Neither REFORM ARC LIMITED nor the service provider shall be responsible for any failure on the part of the bidder due to internet/network issues, power failure, or technical lapses. Bidders are advised to make adequate alternative arrangements.

6. All bidders shall comply with the provisions of Section 29A of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016.

7. Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) shall be deposited through RTGS/NEFT fund transfer to Current Account No.: 040211010000004, Name of the Bank: Union Bank of India, Branch: Mumbai, Name of the Beneficiary: "Reliance Asset Reconstruction Company Limited", IFSC Code: UBIN0590070. Please note that the Cheque/Demand Draft shall not be accepted towards EMD.

8. The balance sale consideration amount will be remitted in Current Account No. '02470200003168, Name of the Bank: Indian Overseas Bank, Branch: Santacruz(V), Name of the Beneficiary: RARC 068 Trust, IFSC Code: IOBA0000247 through RTGS/NEFT.

9. Bids below the Reserve Price and/or without EMD shall not be accepted. Bid increment amount shall be in multiples of Rs. 1,00,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Only) for property. In case of a sole bidder, at least one incremental bid shall be mandatory.

10. The successful bidder shall deposit 25% of the sale consideration (inclusive of EMD) immediately upon being declared successful bidder and the balance 75% within 15 days from the date of confirmation of sale.

11. In default of payment within the prescribed period, the amount already deposited including EMD shall stand forfeited without further notice. However, extension of time may be granted at the sole discretion of the Authorized Officer.

12. EMD of unsuccessful bidders shall be refunded without interest after completion of the auction process.

13. The particulars specified herein are stated to be the best of the knowledge and belief of the Authorized Officer. However, the Authorized Officer shall not be responsible for any error, misstatement, or omission.

14. The undersigned Authorized Officer reserves the absolute right to accept or reject any bid or to adjourn/postpone/cancel the auction without assigning any reason whatsoever.

15. Prospective bidders are advised to conduct independent due diligence regarding encumbrances, title, measurement, liabilities, and condition of the property before submitting bids. No claim shall be entertained thereafter.

16. All statutory dues, taxes, charges, stamp duty, registration charges, transfer charges, and any other incidental expenses relating to the sale shall be borne solely by the successful purchaser.

17. For further details, contact Mr. Himanshu Yadav, Legal, Mobile No. 9892049543 & Mr. Narendra Shukla, A/P-Resolution, Mobile No- 9321339065.

18. The Sale Certificate shall be issued solely in the name of the successful bidder. No request for addition, deletion, substitution, or change of name(s) shall be entertained under any circumstances. The Sale Certificate shall be issued only upon receipt of the full sale consideration and confirmation of the sale by the Secured Creditor.

THIS NOTICE WILL ALSO SERVE AS STATUTORY 15 DAYS NOTICE TO THE BORROWER/GUARANTORS/MORTGAGOR UNDER SARFAEE ACT AND RULES MADE THEREUNDER.

Date: 13.06.2026
Place: Hapur

Sd/- Authorized Officer
REFORM ARC LIMITED (Formerly known as Reliance Asset Reconstruction Company Limited)



उत्तर प्रदेश आवास एवं विकास परिषद
कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियंता, सा.नि.वि., नौलागरी रोड, कलकत्ता-12
E-mail: cdkto12@upavp.com

Letter No-515/AC-9/97
Date: 12-06-2026

U.P. Awas Evam Vikash Parishad is inviting E.O.I till date 21-07-2026 via e-tender for Empanelment of Architects / Consultants in different categories for consultancy of deposit works of U.P.A.V.P. Detailed description can be seen on Parishad website <https://upavp.in> and e-tendering portal.

Executive Engineer

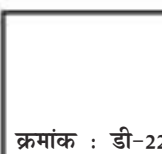


Metro Railway, Kolkata

Tender Notice for e-tendering is invited by Principal Chief Engineer, Metro Railway for the following work: Name of work: Zonal Contract for Up-Keep of track and track bed of Both UP and DN Line from km 16/18 to km 25/11 between Mahanayak Uttam Kumar (Ex.) to Kavi Subhash (Inc.) including Kavi Subhash Yard and Car Shed of Metro Railway, Kolkata upto 2028. Approx Cost of Work ₹ 3,58,41,601.50, Earnest Money: ₹ 7,16,800.00, Completion Period: Twenty Four (24) Months, Date and Time of Closing : 07.07.2026 at 12:00 Hrs. The Tender Document and other details can be obtained from the website www.irops.gov.in Amendments/Corrigendum, if any, would be hosted only on the website.

Abridged e-Tender Notice No.: Civil-2592-2026 (Open)

Follow us at: <https://metrorailwaykol> <https://metrorailkolkata>



कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियंता, सा.नि.वि., संभाग द्वितीय उदयपुर मु. बाँसवाड़ा

क्रमांक : दी-229

निविदा सूचना संख्या- 04/2026-27

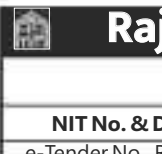
NIB Code: PWD2627A1012

सड़क निर्माण कार्य हेतु बुद्धक संवेदको से अनलाइन माध्यम से दिनांक 12.06.2026 से दिनांक 02.07.2026, सार्व 06:00 बजे तक निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा का अन्य विवरण वेबसाइट (<http://www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> और <http://www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>) पर देखा जा सकता है। उपान की कुल अनुमानित लागत राशि रु. 1312.35 लाख है।

हस्ता- (बी.एन. शर्मा)

अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियंता सा.नि.वि. संभाग द्वितीय उदयपुर मुख्यालय बाँसवाड़ा

DIPIR/C/10240/2026



Rajasthan State Mines & Minerals Limited

e-NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Date :- 12/06/2026

NIT No. & Date	Description of Work
e-Tender No: RSM/M/ CO/Proj/2026-27/02 dated 11.06.2026 NIB No. MML26275LOB00062	Site survey, design of Tailing Dam/Tailing Storage Facility, preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR), preparation of Bid document for award of Construction work of Tailing Dam/Tailing Storage Facility, tender for selection of construction contractor, review of bids submitted for finalization of contract and supervision of construction work of Tailing Dam/Tailing Storage Facility so as to accommodate optimum tailing to be discharged from our existing industrial Beneficiation Plant. EMD/Bid Security-in lieu of Bid Security of Rs. 11,00,000 thousand, Cost of Tender document processing fee Rs. 4720/- by cash/DD in favour of RSMML payable at Udaipur, Processing fee Rs. 1500/- payable by DD only in favour of MD, RISL, payable at Jaipur, Period of downloading of tender-From 11.06.2026 to 13.07.2026 till 1.00 PM. Last date of submission 13.07.2026 till 3.00 PM.

Other terms & conditions have been given in detailed tender for which please visit us at our website www.rsmm.com or www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in or www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in or contact GGM (Project) on above website.

Raj Samwad/C/26/4770

Dy. General Manager (P&A)



OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER PHED CITY CIRCLE AJMER
LOHA KHAN TEMPO STAND, AJMER
Telephone NO 145-2970165, E-mail address: seajmer@gmail.com

S.No.- SE/Ajmer/City Circle/ Ar.- City 1/2026-27/2357-59

Date:-8/6/2026

NOTIFICATION INVITING TENDER
(NIT No 05/2026-27)

Online tenders are hereby invited on behalf of the Governor of Rajasthan for the following works from bidders meeting eligibility as per criteria mentioned in detailed tender document which can be seen and downloaded from website <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> and <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>. The tenders are to be submitted online in electronic format on website <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> as per schedule given below:

S. No	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (Rs in Lacs)	Bid Security @2% (Rs)	Last date of submission of tender	Due date for opening
05/2026-27	Providing, laying, Joining & Testing of 250mm DI K7 Pipeline 2500M, 150MM DI K7 RM Pipeline 500M, & 100MM DI K7 Distribution Pipeline 2500M With Construction of OHSR 200 KL, CWR 600KL & Pump House 20 SQM With Pumping Machinery and Other Associated Works for New Medical College Near Kayad Pushkar By Pass Under Deposit Works Ajmer,	332.03	6,64,065	29-06-2026	30-06-2026

The tender shall be received online and opened in the office of Superintending Engineer, PHED, City Circle Ajmer. The cost of each tender document is Rs 5000 /- (Rs Five Thousand only) by depositing through e-Challan at e-gross System, RISL processing charges of Rs 2000 /- (Rs Two Thousand only) for each NIT and Bid security as mentioned above shall be deposited through e-Challan at e-gross System as described in detailed NIT in tender Document and uploaded online on detailed website as above. This tender notification and other details can also be seen in NIT exhibited on web site <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> and <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> from date 08-06-2026

Nit No. SPP ID No. URBN No. Sd/-

05/2026-27 PHE2627A0898 PHE2627WSOBO1804 (Ramchandra Rar) Superintending Engineer, PHED, City Circle Ajmer

DIPIR/C/10154/2026



AU SMALL FINANCE BANK LIMITED
(A SCHEDULED COMMERCIAL BANK)
Regd. Office: 13-A, Dhuleshwar Garden, Ajmer Road, Jaipur - 362001 (CIN:L36911RJ1996PLC011381)

Demand Notice Under Section 13(2) of Securitisation Act of 2002

As the loan account became NPA therefore the Authorized officer under section 13(2) of "The Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002" had issued 60 days demand notice to the borrowers/co-borrowers/ Mortgages/Guarantors collectively as "Borrowers" as given in the table. According to the notice if the borrowers do not deposit the entire amount within 60 days, the amount will be recovered from auction of the mortgage properties/secured assets as given below. Therefore you the borrowers are informed to deposit the entire loan amount along with future interest and expenses within 60 days from the date of demand notice, otherwise under the provisions of 13(4) and 14 of the said Act, the Authorized officer is free to take possession for sale of the mortgage property/Secured assets as given below.

Borrowers to note that after receipt of this notice, in terms of Section 13(13) of the Act, 2002, you are prohibited and restrained from transferring any of the secured assets by way of sale, lease or otherwise, without prior written consent of the secured creditor. Borrowers attention are attracted towards Section 13(8) /w Rule 3(5) of The Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 Act that the borrowers shall be entitled to redeem their secured asset upon the payment of the complete outstanding dues as mentioned below before the publication of auction notice, which thereafter shall cease to exist.

Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower /Mortgagor/Guarantor/ Loan A/c No.	Date and Amount of Demand Notice Under Sec. 13(2)	Description of Mortgaged Property
(A/C No.) L9001060139356373 Rohit (Borrower), Smt. Rani Devi (Co-Borrower)	14-May-26 Rs. 1534618/- Rs. Fifteen Lakh Thirty-Four Thousand Six Hundred Eighteen Only As on 13-May-26	Property Situated At- Kharsa No- 90, 91K, & 92, Plot No- 82, Jagannathpuram Phase-II, Rajsarai Vill -Nanglatashi, Tahsil- Kasampur,

Shubhra Gupta

TWO LOVE stories spanning two eras is a running theme in Imtiaz Ali's filmography. His latest, *Main Vaapas Aaunga*, a pre-Partition for ever-and-ever romance, juxtaposed against a commitment-phobic present-day couple, in which the girl and guy are doing the back-and-forth chancy-dancy thing, is also in the same zone. It also re-unites him with the lead actor of their previous collaboration, *Chamkila*.

Co-written by Ali and Nayanika Mahtani, and produced by Applause Entertainment, the film opens with the Chandigarh-based 95-year old Ishar Singh Grewal (Naseeruddin Shah) desperate to get to Sargodha: his faculties are slipping and he has no realisation that the town lies across the border, created in 1947 to carve out India and Pakistan, from the subcontinent, leading to wholesale carnage and bloodshed.

His incoherent mumblings can only be deciphered by grandson Nirvair (Diljit Do-

Main Vaapas Aaunga is a valuable addition to the films which do the difficult work of acting as memorial and redemption

sanjh), who has flown in from the UK, leaving behind a job, a girlfriend (Banita Sandhu) and tangled emotions of his own. *Dadaji* has unfinished business, and as he clings desperately on, despite the debilitating stroke, he becomes the device through which the film harks back to those terrible times which have been buried in the memories of those who lived through them.

That Ali is able to make this film in 2026, with spiralling communal polarisation having created so many fissures within our own country, is astounding, and a straight up cause for celebration. *Main Vaapas Aaunga* is very clear about where its politics lies, pointing towards the unresolved trauma and unhealed wounds transmitted through generations, as the root cause of our present troubles, as well as the clear-eyed declaration that those troubles cannot be laid at the door of one community or one religion: everyone — the Muslim marauders who raped and pillaged, the Sikhs who retaliated, the blood-lust leading to beheadings — was responsible, everyone was complicit, everyone's hands were equally bloody.

To dig up those skeletons, and to tell those stories, so that we can look back with lessening anger, can be healing. In that

Look Back in Love



sense, *Main Vaapas Aaunga* is a valuable addition to the films which do the difficult work of acting as memorial and redemption: Partition is still an open wound, hidden under scabs.

But while its intentions are noble, and its heart is very much in the right place, the film meanders, especially in the first half. It does make up for it in the post-interval section, when it gets into full gear, but that makes us wish, all the more, that all of it was tighter, especially with its rousing climactic coda about forgetting as way to forgiveness, and that being a pacifist is the only way forward.

MAIN VAAPAS AAUNGA

★★★★

DIRECTOR: Imtiaz Ali
CAST: Naseeruddin Shah, Diljit Dosanjh, Vedang Raina, Sharvati, Banita Sandhu, Manish Chaudhari, Danish Pandor, Anjana Sukhani, Babita, Sanjay Suri

The film works best when it nudges us into accepting that those feelings are important, and those moments come flooding in well into the second half, in which *Main Vaapas Aaunga* finds its footing, as it goes back and forth, coasting on nostalgia for a softer, gentler era in which a lost *chand-baadi* could become an excuse for a clandestine meeting between lovers from different religions.

Where it fails to leave a mark is the creation of that very same long-lost love: there's not enough fizz between the fresh-faced Vedang Raina and rosy-cheeked Sharvati, the former playing the college-

going Ishwar and the latter his beloved Jiya, whom he has to leave behind when violence erupts.

These portions, with its studied flirtation between the young'uns, the hardening of lines destroying the harmony between the Muslims and the Sikhs, the horrific violence wrecked on the women left behind, are all familiar: we have seen similar depictions.

Where the film stands out is in the clear acknowledgement of guilt of those that left, the lingering curses of those left behind, the burden of which Ishwar has carried all these years, which has perhaps corroded his future relationships. There's an interesting thread hinting at the conflicted feelings of Ishwar's older son (Rajat Kapoor, excellent), which he brings up to air when he sees the former stricken by stroke: the film leaves it unexplored. You realise that a character was played by Sanjay Suri, almost unrecognisable, only once you have blinked and he's gone.

The plot is stuffed with everything the film wants to touch upon, which includes a pointed scene in which farmers and their constraints (a reference to Dosanjh's support for the farmers?): that scene comes and goes, without having anything to do with the film. Dosanjh being named Nirvair is a lovely meta-touch, speaking to one that doesn't hate, only loves: a degree of equal elegance is missing in the way his character is turned into a bald explainer on what his grandfather is going through, as well as the Partition itself. A walk-on part, played by Vinod Nagpal as Ishwar's younger brother who saw more than any human can bear, has more weight than all the words we hear Nirvair translate for the benefit of his immediate family.

Yes, generational trauma can be addressed through comedy, so Nirvair starts doing sets, trying to make sense of it all, and only some of it is effective. It takes his solo, which sings of refugees the world over, who yearn for a lost home, to make you tear up.

But *Main Vaapas Aaunga*, equal parts uneven and moving, isn't the very likeable Dosanjh's film. It is Naseeruddin Shah's superbly-judged performance, pitched high enough to sustain the drama which hovers this close to grating melodrama, never quite tipping over, which keeps this film going, literally and metaphorically. His end-of-life Ishwar captures the arc of an old man whose suppressed agony can only be released through tormented yells which reverberate through his tony household, as well as those of us who still have the patience to listen.

For me, the film's weaker portions are papered over by the ones that hold us, reuniting us with a filmmaker unafraid of drama, telling us a story about memory and loss, and the power of homecoming.

Reading the Room(s)

Shalini Langer

LITTLE COMES closer to the approximation of a full empty life than perhaps a furniture store. Dining tables to be had family meals on, sofas to sink into, almirahs to hold possessions, beds to be slept in — all waiting for someone to take them home.

Little comes closer to the approximation of an empty full life than perhaps an impersonal glass-and-concrete office space. Rows upon rows of people sitting behind screens doing identical work day after day — all waiting for someone to make it home.

In *Backrooms*, the twin meet in the liminal space that the Internet calls it own, where real and fake symbiotically live off each other. It is fitting then that the film should be the creation of 20-year-old YouTube find Kane Parsons, and be steered into massive commercial success by A24, a studio with a nose for zeitgeist and the pocket for zillions.

So, *Backrooms* started out as a 4Chan idea, a theme board inviting users to post images of things or places that just seemed "off". Parsons — and others — went on to make short horror films centred specifically in vast empty spaces, which could be anything and everything.

In Parsons's feature film-length expansion on that, backrooms are explained as "every place that has ever been".

Clark (Chiwetel Ejiofor), a disgruntled furniture store owner, finds himself caught in one of them, sometime in 1990. Clark has a lot of rage in him, about the architect he wanted to be and couldn't, about the ex-wife who he felt sucked him dry pursuing her own dreams of being a lawyer, about even the ridiculous promotional videos he is making dressed as a one-legged pirate with a fake parrot on his shoulder to attract customers to his 'Capt Clark's Ottoman Empire' store. Nowhere is this seething frustration more evident than when he topples over trying to hobble on the wooden appendage he has tied to his own good leg, while being filmed for the video by two cynical teenagers.

Ejiofor is scary and pitiful at the same time, lending the terror and tragedy that fill out *Backrooms*.

Mary (Renate Reinsve), in comparison, is the meticulously groomed, supernaturally contained therapist of Clark. If she has any other clients, we don't see them. What we do see is her as alone as Clark when home, watching TV in a dark room. Often, she too is watching her own ads, promoting herself-help book where the subconscious is rendered in the language of walls, windows and loops that we are all caught in.

Well, that is not subtle at all given the



theme of the film. Nor is Mary's backstory of a disturbed childhood with a mentally disturbed mother, who boarded up their home afraid of "something out there".

Clark is the first to go through a wall, literally, and find himself in a parallel space of endless rooms, corridors, doors, cables, whisperings and standees of one particular man with a device attached that delivers in different languages "a message from the people of the Earth".

With zero customers, Clark fills his time making Antilla (Ambani)-like architectural drawings. Is he manifesting the backrooms then? Though he does manage to bring back a stool from there, and leave inside two employees. Or Mary, for that matter? Are the backrooms a representation of what she remembers of her childhood, the neglect of a littered home where nothing is how it should be, the paranoia of a mother in the furniture stacked against the door?

Or are the backrooms a combination of Clark and Mary's interactions, one's memories filling out the other's inner world, in a way that can never be an exact copy but carry small bits of distortions? Like those people with multiple eyes or melting faces the two encounter when caught in the backrooms?

This certainly innovative horror of Parson's imagination works best when it leaves us to try and put two and two together, scrap it, and try all over again. What gives *Backrooms* its punch is the sense of the inexplicable and yet the familiar — we have all been here, walking into a long, dark corridor with lights humming overhead or flickering, a shadow in a corner, the vast stretches of sudden emptying out an unnerving possibility after Covid.

It's when Parsons (also co-writer) tries to give *Backrooms* a worldly — even "scientific" — explanation that the film fumbles.

The other horror creation by a young YouTuber that is also having its moment in Hollywood, *Obsession*, just had its release. It took a different route, straighter in its plotting, subtle in its messaging.

Says Clark to Mary about the backrooms: "It's like describing a dog to someone who has never seen one and asking them to draw it... It will never come out the same."

It doesn't.

Spielberg ET al

Shalini Langer

DISCLOSURE DAY rolls out smoothly and fully formed from the atelier of the great Steven Spielberg, with humanity — once again — discovering itself in the face of the divine and the unknown. Spielberg himself has described it as the closest to his film *Close Encounters of the Third Kind*, and *Disclosure Day* perhaps dabbles most evidently with the question of God and aliens.

And because it's Spielberg, what you see is what you get. There is talk of a government-military-industrial nexus but it is suggestive of an older time, not now, when the President's family and the biggest weapons profiteers are in bed together without raising a scandal. There is talk of "empathy as humanity's evolutionary advantage", but nothing about why and where and how fast it is eroding. The only aliens in Spielberg's film are the ones that come from outer space, and they are the same big-headed, slender-limbed, bug-eyed creatures he favours; the director clearly hasn't spotted the ones closer home being chased off the streets.

Spielberg's insistence on a childlike innocence extends to a TV network where everyone is polite, and ultimately to what is the essence of *Disclosure Day* — that confronted with the bad their government has done, people will have a collective breakdown and demand answers. "That the truth will set us free", as the Bible says. Well, we are onto post-truth, and have seen governments do their absolute worst the past few years, without any Second Coming.

So that's that.

Set aside these disappointments though, and *Disclosure Day* can be fully enjoyed for



DISCLOSURE DAY

★★★★

DIRECTOR: Steven Spielberg
CAST: Emily Blunt, Josh O'Connor, Colin Firth, Colman Domingo, Eve Hewson, Wyatt Russell

a thriller, involving the works — from a world "on the brink (without really an explanation for why)", to deeply kept State secrets, to braveheart renegades, to do-gooders, to a magical device that can do all sorts of things, to vehicle chases, to a brilliant scene involving a car and two trains, to rooms with thousands of screens, and at the heart of it, to two magnetic people pulling it all along.

The two are Margaret and Daniel, played respectively by Emily Blunt and Josh O'Connor. She is funny and empathetic, he is sincere and gullible, and both are people the world can lean on easily for comfort.

The film's collection of British and allied actors for this very American film includes Colin Firth as Noah, the head of the super-secret firm called Wardex, whose operations have all of them in a tizzy. Domingo is the leader of the rebels, Hugo, with the gravitas of someone who sees all, knows all.

Wardex is short for 'Waived Reporting Development and Extraction'. Hugo, a fellow employee of the firm, rails at Noah for making even astonishment a source of ridicule, to stop people asking questions. Acronyms, we here at home can tell you, are a good place to start digging.

Healing from the Frontlines

BHARAT BHHAGYA VIDDHAATA

★★★★

DIRECTOR: Manoj Tapadia
CAST: Kangana Ranaut, Girija Oak Godbole, Smita Tambe, Esha Dey, Suhita Thatte, Asha Shelar, Aditya Mishra, Zahid Khan

Shubhra Gupta

MY FIRST reaction when I heard that *Bharat Bhhagya Viddhaata* was yet another version of the Cama Hospital shootout during the 26/11 terror attack was one of dismay. Did we really need yet another iteration, when we have had a flurry of films and shows on the same theme?

Turns out we did. Despite its mouthful of a title, which is more a paean to the performative patriotism encouraged by the current regime than anything else, and the



familiarity of the main events, which have been well documented, this latest film, written by Ritesh Shah and directed by Manoj Tapadia, stands out.

It takes into account the bravery of the Cama nurses in the face of tremendous

odds, making it an ode to an unsung section of our society. And even more importantly, it lauds their actions, while showing us the casual and constant cruelty of the two men on a killing spree in a space dedicated to saving lives, without demonising a minority.

It also, while giving us a resurgent Kangana Ranaut reclaiming her place as one of the best actresses working today, ensures that her Nurse Geeta doesn't overshadow everyone else: that she leads from the front as the hero of this enterprise is not hidden, but that the others are equally heroic is what creates balance.

It's been a while since I have seen a film so tightly paced, never letting the tension subside: even though you may recall what went down during the time when Ismail Khan (Aditya Mishra) and Ajmal Kasab (Zahid Khan) roamed the staircases looking for targets, shooting off their AK 47s and mouths in equal measure, your heart will be in your mouth.

The quick thinking of Geeta and her companions manages to hide hundreds of

•STREAMING WATCHLIST



Over Your Dead Body

PRIME VIDEO

CENTRED AROUND Dan and Lisa, a couple trying to salvage their failing marriage, *Over Your Dead Body* sees the narrative take a bizarre turn

when both secretly arrive at a secluded cabin planning to kill the other. What begins as a tense weekend soon spirals into a chain of betrayals. Directed by Jorma Taccone, the film stars Jason Segel, Samara Weaving and Timothy Olyphant, Juliette Lewis and Paul Guilfoyle.



Shelter

LIONSGATE PLAY

LIVING IN isolation on a remote Scottish island, a retired government assassin has built a life designed to keep the rest of the world at a distance. But when a young girl survives a devastating shipwreck near his home, protecting her forces him to reveal exactly the kind of man he once was. What follows is a relentless pursuit as former MI6 operatives close in, determined to erase both of them before the truth can surface. The film's cast features Jason Statham, Bodhi Rae Breathnach, Naomi Ackie and Shelter balances.



Sweet Magnolias S5

NETFLIX

THE SWEET Magnolias have made it through marriage, infidelity, divorce, career changes and un-

expected death — so it should be no surprise that the three lifelong best friends from Serenity, South Carolina, won't let a job relocation to New York City get in the way of margarita night when they return for Season 5. The new season offers a taste of how Mad-die (JoAnna Garcia Swisher), Dana Sue (Brooke Elliott) and Helen (Heather Headley) continue to juggle relationships, family and careers.



Colors of Evil: Black

NETFLIX

WHEN A young boy goes missing in a small sleepy town, a newly reasigned prosecutor begins to uncover

unexpected links to an old missing persons case. *Colors of Evil: Black* is a Polish crime thriller directed by Adrian Panek. It features Jakub Gierszał as prosecutor Leopold Bilski, who is trying to solve the disappearance of a child in a remote town.

Raakh Season 1

PRIME VIDEO

THIS NEW show follows the investigation into the disappearance and murder of two teenagers in Delhi, a crime that shocks the city. As the case deepens, a determined police officer leads a nationwide hunt for the killers, uncovering disturbing truths. Directed by Prosit Roy, the series is created, written and co-directed by Anusha Nandakumar and Sandeep Saket. The cast features Ali Fazal, Sonali Bendre and Amir Bashir.

ALAKA SAHANI

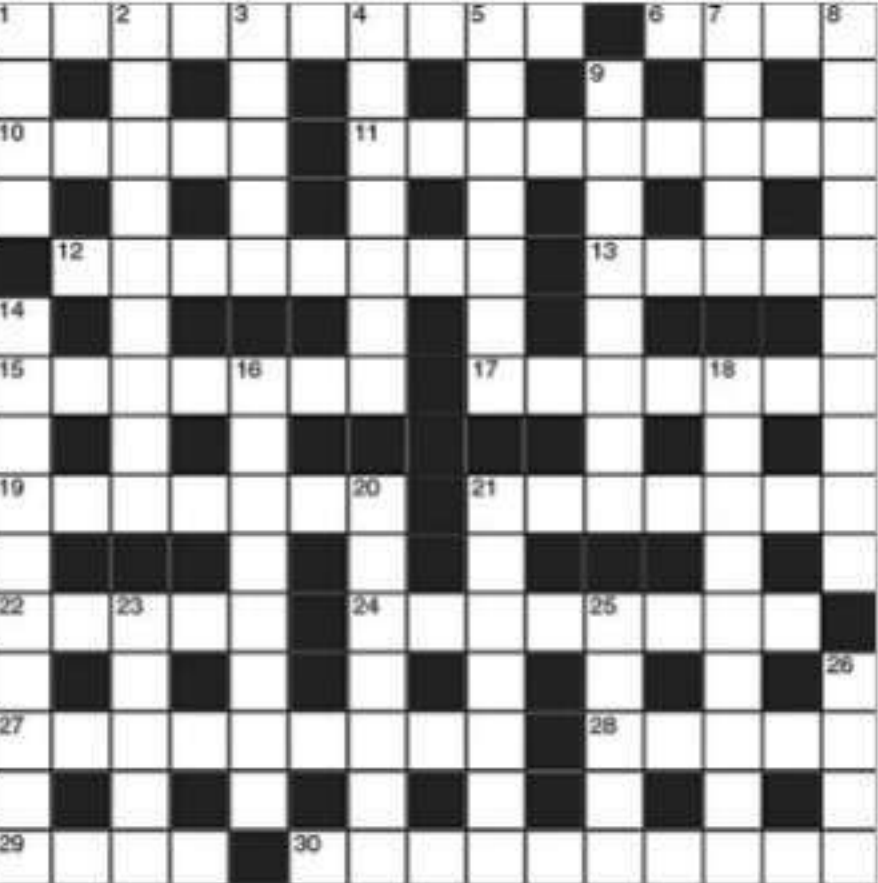


patients, including a number of expecting women on the verge of going into labour. The other nurses, played by Girija Oak Godbole, Esha Dey, Smita Tambe, are all very good: in places, Godbole effortlessly steals every scene she's in.

Meanwhile, effort has gone into making us believe that these nurses have been longstanding colleagues: when one starts spouting yet another Urdu couplet, everyone smiles indulgently. That there's politics amongst the best is also shown in the way a superintendent (Asha Shelar), along with her canny, work-shirking deputy (Suhita Thatte), acts officious instead of supportive, but then she's shown to realise the error of her ways, in keeping with the upbeat note the film finishes on.

But politics, past and present, while very much a presence, is never allowed to overshadow the personal. And that's where the film wins, in its celebration of the human spirit, kept alive by the indomitable courage of the women who wear the nurses' uniform. They are soldiers in their own right.

CROSSWORD



ACROSS
1 Amazed at getting only a walk-on role? (10)
6 Cat turning up on a seagoing vessel (4)
10 Cook demands the right sort of oven (5)
11 He may be seen at the courts practising (9)
12 Be hot turning red and irritated (8)
13 Laity out abroad (5)
15 It may carry out a service on a summer afternoon (3,4)
17 Extremely fine wood (7)
19 Outdoor love-song about a writer (4-3)
21 Stirred to a rich stew (7)
22 Health-giving drink (5)
24 Make one try with mail packaging for the armed forces (8)
27 Canned - as sardines are (4-5)
28 Animal that's a knockout to the French (5)
29 Possibly went in the pond (4)
30 We may bet on them to give us hydrogen (10)

DOWN
1 One bound on a crest of a wave we hear (4)
2 Package turned up with address in detailed form (9)
3 Net takings? (5)
4 Something presumed to be freely available (7)
5 Takes steps not to have to walk in the streets (7)
7 It's very much used as a prefix (5)
8 A miserable and penitent condition (5,5)
9 Very serious internal trouble (5,3)
14 Had good chance of success, being upright (5,2,3)
16 Response concerning the deed (8)
18 Indefinite truce in an engagement (9)
20 A walker or a climber maybe (7)
21 Workless period when many leave home (7)
23 Chap on the base gets permit (5)
25 Youth leader took out foreign capital (5)
26 Equine animals sounding canine (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6013
ACROSS: 1 Pushers, 5 Prose, 8 Doing time, 9 Fit, 10 Lead, 12 Comedown, 14 Raffia, 15 Actors, 17 No change, 18 Frau, 21 Obi, 22 Interests, 24 Nanny, 25 Segment
DOWN: 1 Pedal, 2 Ski, 3 Eggs, 4 Sutor, 5 Presence, 6 Off-colour, 7 Extends, 11 Affection, 13 Hilarity, 14 Run down, 16 Agates, 19 Upset, 20 Brag, 23 Sue

JUMBLD WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

_____cool more than cold water. - John Ray (4,5)

BT0OR

●●●●●

AELYDD

●●●●●

GIMOS

●●●●●

GITYGW

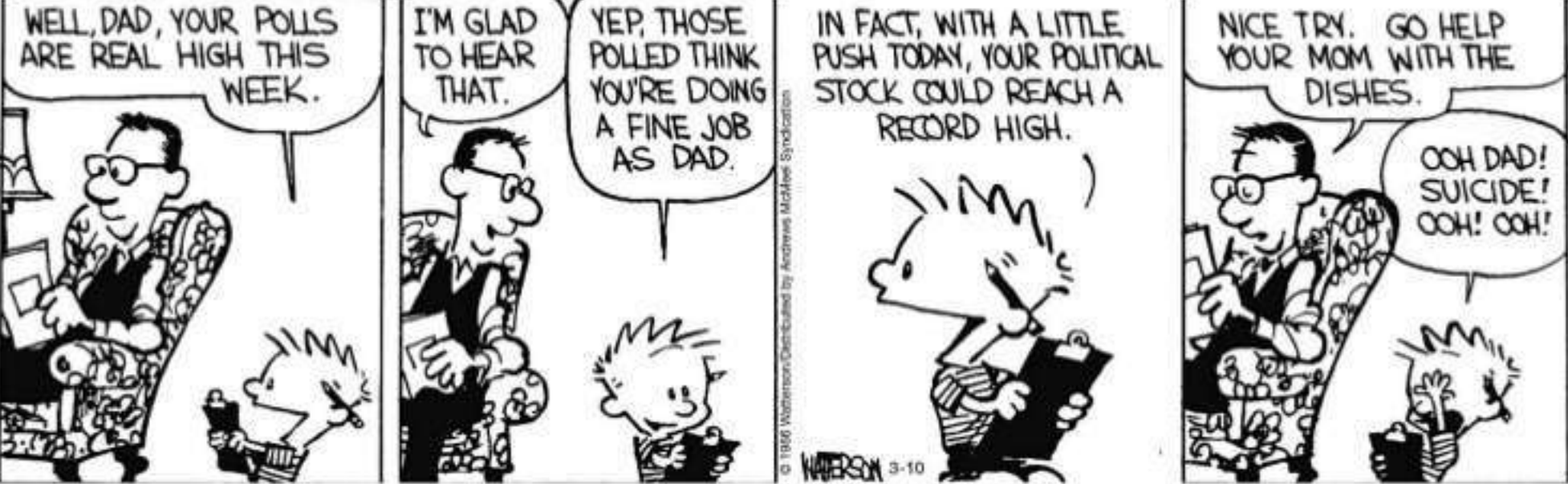
●●●●●

ANSWER: Good words cool more than cold water. - John Ray
SOLUTIONS: Robot, Beedly, Twiggly

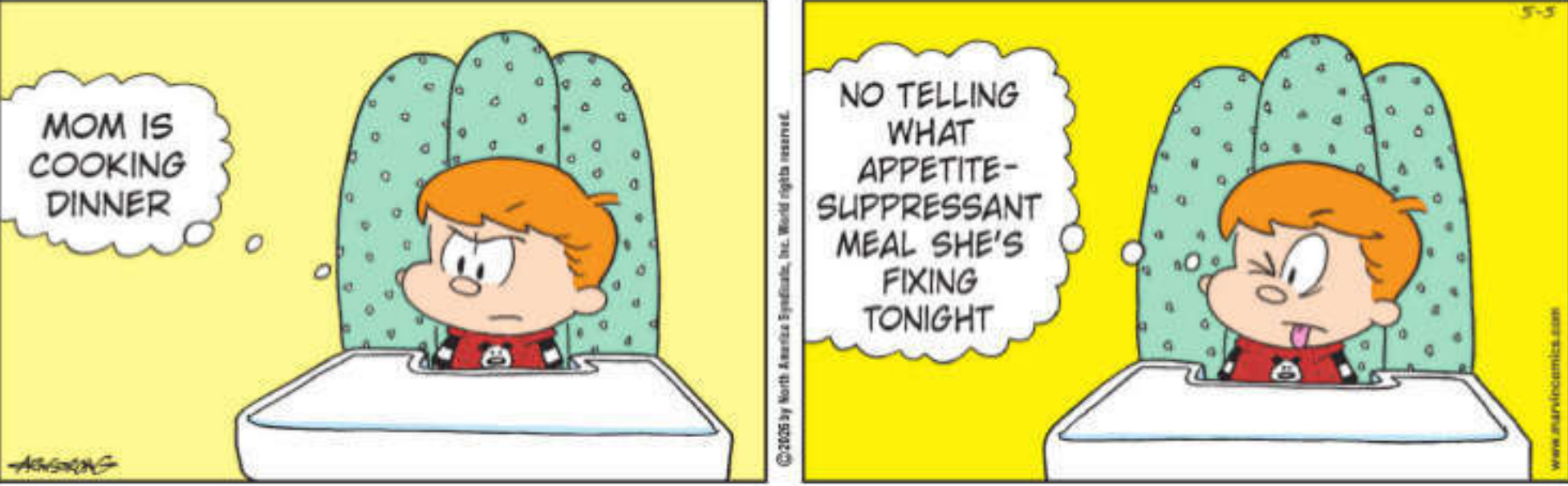
OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL
4s INSTRUCTIONS
To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6348

1			8			5
	9	2		3	7	
		1	9			
8	3			5		1
4	7			8		3
			7	8		
		1	9	5	2	
5			1			9

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6347

7	1	5	3	6	4	8	2	9
8	6	9	1	2	5	4	7	3
4	3	2	8	7	9	6	5	1
9	5	4	7	3	2	1	8	6
1	7	8	9	5	6	3	4	2
6	2	3	4	8	1	5	9	7
2	8	6	5	9	3	7	1	4
5	9	1	6	4	7	2	3	8
3	4	7	2	1	8	9	6	5

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is your kind of day as it's full of potential adventure and fun and games. Above all, be open to trying something new and different. Jot down clever new ideas. Tonight: Interesting discussions.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Be smart and keep an eye on your monetary assets to protect yourself from loss, theft or damage. Something unexpected could impact these areas. Stay on top of things to avoid regrets. Tonight: Check your money.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Today the Moon is in your sign, which gives you a slight edge over all the other signs. However, the Moon is also lined up with wild, wacky, unpredictable Uranus, which means you feel impulsive, and this day is slightly accident-prone. Keep your eyes open. Tonight: You win.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): You might feel bit restless today and not know why. Meanwhile, Mercury, Venus and Jupiter are in your sign bringing you many opportunities to enjoy this day, especially through conversation. Tonight: Enjoy privacy.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Today you might meet a real character. Or perhaps, someone you know will do something that surprises you? Whatever the case, new ideas and new possibilities might emerge. With Mars at the top of your chart — you're up for anything. Tonight: Friendships.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Be aware that the authority figures you encounter today might do something you least expect. You could be busted or they might issue an unexpected demand or instruction. Tonight: You're admired.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Travel plans might suddenly change today. You also might have an opportunity to learn something exciting, fresh and different — something that expands your world. Tonight: Explore and learn.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Double-check banking details and anything that relates to shared wealth, property and responsibilities. These areas will be impacted by sudden change today. Tonight: Check your finances.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): This is a lively day. You're up for hard work. However, spouses, partners and close friends also might do something you least expect. You might need to be skillful and diplomatic when dealing with someone. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Your work routine will be interrupted today. This can be good, or not so good news. Whatever the case, give yourself extra time to deal with the unexpected. Surprising news related to health or legal matters also might occur. Tonight: Get better organised.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Parents should be extra vigilant today because this is an accident-prone day for your kids. Meanwhile, your social scene will be full of surprises today. An unexpected invite might come your way. Perhaps plans will change. Tonight: Socialise.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Small appliances might break down today. Something unexpected will impact your domestic routine. Perhaps someone unexpected will knock on the door. Stock the fridge so you're ready for anything. Tonight: Relax at home.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSONS

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons (1) **Baljeet Singh S/o Harbhajan Singh R/o WZ-97, 2nd Floor, Mukhram Park, Tilak Nagar, Delhi**, (2) **Ashok Dalal S/o Late Bhagwan Singh R/o H.No. 234 Near Chhara Chungi, Gazi Kamal Mandir, Gali No.-03, Ward No. 2, Jhajjar, Haryana**, have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 158/2022, U/S 33/38/58 Delhi Excise Act & 482 IPC, PS Crime Branch, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused persons cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused persons have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that (1) **Baljeet Singh (2) Ashok Dalal** the said accused of **FIR No. 158/2022, U/S 33/38/58 Delhi Excise Act & 482 IPC, PS Crime Branch, Delhi**, are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before (1) **Baljeet Singh 15.07.2026 & (2) Ashok Dalal 01.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Upasana Satija
Chief Judicial Magistrate (North West),
Court No. -108, 1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7852/Crime/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2)(ii) Cr.Pc.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Charan Singh S/o Ram Kumar R/o Village - Daura Milk, PS - Kud, Fathegarh, Distt. Sambhal, UP** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 8702/2016 U/s 379/411/34 IPC** has been registered at **P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Charan Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Charan Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Charan Singh** of under **FIR No. 8702/2016 U/s 379/411/34 IPC** has been registered at **P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Shruti Sarawat,
JMFC-03, Room No. 22,
1st Floor. karkardooma court, Delhi

DP/7821/NE/2026
(court notice)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Letter No.-DRM/C/AGRA/PARKING /E-AUCTION/2026 Dated:-11.06.2026

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per categories given as under:-

Category : Parking	Auction Catalogue No.: PARKING-26-02
--------------------	--------------------------------------

Asset Details : Bhuteshwar Railway Station, Circulating Area - Two Wheelers and Four Wheelers Parking.

E-Auction Start Date and time : Date:-29.06.2026, Time : 12:00

E-Auction End Date and time : Date:-29.06.2026, Time : 12:30

Asset Details : Idgah Jn. Railway Station, IDH Station PF-1, Circulating Area- Two Wheelers and Four Wheelers Parking.

E-Auction Start Date and time : Date:-29.06.2026, Time : 12:00

E-Auction End Date and time : Date:-29.06.2026, Time : 12:40

Note : Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on **IREPS website** (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number: **1333/26 (ADM)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in **@ CPONCR**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ashif @ Ashik @ Natta, S/o Israil, R/o Jhuggi No. 30/2, A-Block, Jahangirpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 751/21, U/s 379/411 IPC, P.S. Mahendra Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Ashif @ Ashik @ Natta** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ashif @ Ashik @ Natta** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ashif @ Ashik @ Natta** accused of **FIR No. 751/21, U/s 379/411 IPC, P.S. Mahendra Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.07.2026**.

By Order - **Ms. Amardeep Kaur**
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, North
DP/6919/NW/2026 Room No. 117, Rohini Courts, Delhi

उत्तर पश्चिम रेलवे				
ई-खुली निविदा सूचना				
ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या: सी-45 / 1 / टेन्डर / जीएमयू / ए कैटेगरी / 2026 दिनांक: 27.05.2026				
1. कार्य का नाम एवं लोकेशन	जयपुर मण्डल के 'ए' कैटेगरी के रेलवे स्टेशनों पर कैटरिंग सर्विस जीएमयू (GMU) का आवंटन (कैटरिंग स्टॉल)			
2. जमा की जाने वाली बयाना राशि (प्रति यूनिट)	Name of Station	Catering unit no. & Category of Unit	P.F. No.	Amount of EMD (in Rs.)
	RE (A)	Catering unit no. A-60=UR	1	129000/-
		Catering unit no. A-61=UR-LD	2/3	62600/-
		Catering unit no. A-63=UR-LD	2/3	119200/-
		Catering unit no. A-65=UR	4/5	173700/-
		Catering unit no. A-66=UR-LD	4/5	182100/-
	AWR (A)	Catering unit no. A-70=UR	6/7	113900/-
		Catering unit no. A-77=UR	1	66100/-
		Catering unit no. A-79=UR	1	142200/-
	BKI (A)	Catering unit no. A-81=UR-LD	2/3	94700/-
Catering unit no. A-84=UR		2/3	185900/-	
GADJ (A)	Catering unit no. A-22=UR	1	70800/-	
	Catering unit no. A-40=UR	1	111800/-	
UR- Unreserved, LD-Ladies				
3. निविदा फार्म का मूल्य	ए श्रेणी स्टेशनों पर GMU के लिए रुपये 3540/- प्रति सेट			
4. कार्य की समाप्ति अवधि	पांच वर्ष			
5. ई-निविदा जमा कराने की तिथि एवं समय	दिनांक 02.07.2026 समय 15.00 बजे			
6. वेबसाइट विवरण	www.ireps.gov.in			
वरिष्ठ मण्डल वाणिज्य प्रबंधक, उपर-जयपुर				
98 11 11 NWR/Railways 98 11 11 NWR/Railways, न नो नो				852-PH/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Prahalad Kumar S/o Lalu Ram R/o H. No. 129/130, Pocket-15, Sector 24, Rohini, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 651/2018 U/s 509/506/34 IPC, P.S. Vijay Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Prahalad Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Prahalad Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Prahalad Kumar** of case **FIR No. 651/2018 U/s 509/506/34 IPC, P.S. Vijay Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class
North West, Court No. 109, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7737/RD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused persons namely **Vicky S/o Shivaji Prasad R/o near NIT School, Sec-9A, Basai, Gurugram, Haryana**, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 238/2023 U/s 25/29 Arms Act.**, has been registered at **PS: Dwarka North, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Vicky** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Vicky** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Vicky** under **FIR No. 238/2023 U/s 25/29 Arms Act.**, registered at **PS: Dwarka North, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Rahul Katara
JMFC-06 (South West), Room No. 514
Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/7901/DW/2026
(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pawan Aggarwal Director/Authorised Signatory of P.B. Retails Pvt. Ltd. RZ-11G, Puran Nagar, Palam, New Delhi-45, also at 9, Jagbandhu Boral Lane, Kolkata, West Bengal, Near Ganesh Talkies** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **Case No. 19160/18, U/S 138 NI Act, P.S. Kotwali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Pawan Aggarwal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Pawan Aggarwal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Pawan Aggarwal of Case No. 19160/18, U/S 138 NI Act, P.S. Kotwali, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **15.07.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Urvi Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI Act-01)
Central, Room No. 201, Annexe-II
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7920/N/2026(Court Matter)

UP Rajaia Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd.

Anpara Sonebhadra

E-Tender Notice

Tender Notice and scope of work

- E-Tender- GEM/2026/B/7611308**, Work of replacement of existing wooden sleepers with galvanised steel channel sleepers at various bridges of MGR railway Track, ATPS, Anpara as per Indian railway/RDSO standard. Last date of tender: 23.06.2026 (15:00 Hrs).
- Short Term E-Tender- GEM/2026/B/7607744**, Construction of temp. bund in Lagoon-1 of main ash dyke for proper ash disposal." EMD Rs. 70,000.00. Last date of tender: 11.06.2026 (16:00 Hrs).
- E-Tender- GEM/2026/B/6000011907**, Overhauling of ID, FD, PA fans and its auxiliaries etc. during overhauling of unit no #2 of 3x210MW. ATPS: Anpara." EMD Rs. 14,500.00, Last date of tender: 29.06.2026 (16:00 Hrs).
- E-Tender- GEM/2026/B/7623619**, Overhauling of various parts of bowl mills (XRP-803) during overhauling of unit no/2 of 3x210MW, ATPS, Anpara." EMD Rs. 17,500.00, Last date of tender: 29.06.2026 (16:00 Hrs).
- E-Tender- GEM/2026/B/7621605**, Replacement of old and eroded expansion joints, cleaning and welding of ID & PA fan duct during overhauling of unit no #2 of 3x210MW, ATPS, Anpara." EMD Rs. 11,400.00, Last date of tender: 29.06.2026 (16:00 Hrs).
- E-Tender- GEM/2026/B/7618932**, Quality inspection of IIP joints through radiography & PAUT during overhauling of Unit no. 4 2x500MW, BTPS, Anpara. EMD Rs. 59,000.00, Last date of tender: 04.07.2026 (13:00 Hrs).
- E-Tender- GEM/2026/B/7621697**, Overhauling of valve & soot blowing system of unit no. 4 2x500MW, BTPS, Anpara. EMD Rs. 42,000.00, Last date of tender: 04.07.2026 (14:00 Hrs).
- E-Tender- 01/CAD/ATPS/2026-27**, Overhauling maintenance of LP piping and associated valves etc. of unit #2, 3x210MW, ATPS, Anpara. EMD Rs. 9,000.00, Last date of tender: 06.07.2026 (19:00 Hrs).
- E-Tender- GEM/2026/B/7645211**, "Slope protection work of platform & construction of steel structure stair at Gorbi mines pit no. 03, Gorbi, Singrauli (MP)." EMD Rs. 25,500.00, Last date of tender: 20.06.2026 (12:00 Hrs).

For information regarding addendum corrigendum rejection of Bids kindly regularly visit website <https://etender.up.nic.in>

पत्रांक: 3257 / मुं०नि० (सार-1) / अ०वा० / कला अनु० Date: 12.06.2026

"Save Electricity for Nation"

● **RESULTS**

GROUP A

Mexico 2-0 South Africa
Azteca, Mexico City

GROUP A

South Korea 2-1 Czechia
Estadio Guadalajara

● **SUNDAY'S GAMES**

GROUP B

Qatar vs Switzerland
California, 0030 hrs (Sunday)

GROUP C

Brazil vs Morocco
New York, 0330 hrs (Sunday)

GROUP C

Haiti vs Scotland
Boston, 0630 hrs (Sunday)

GROUP D

Australia vs Turkiye
Vancouver, 0930 hrs (Saturday)

ZEE5 OTT & UNITE8 CHANNELS



Hwang In-beom scored one and assisted one goal. ASSOCIATED PRESS

South Korea come back from behind to win 2-1

SOUTH KOREA rallied from a goal down to defeat the Czechia 2-1 and make a winning start to their World Cup Group A campaign thanks to goals by Hwang In-beom and Oh Hyeon-gyun Thursday. The Koreans joined Mexico on three points at the top of the standings after the co-hosts defeated nine-man South Africa 2-0 in the tournament opener. South Korea next face Mexico on June 18 and the Czechs travel to Atlanta to meet South Africa on the same day.

Canada refuses visa to Ghana's Partey

GHANA MIDFIELDER Thomas Partey will not take part in his team's World Cup game against Panama on Wednesday after his visa application to Canada was refused. "FIFA can confirm that player Thomas Partey will be unable to travel from Ghana's Team Base Camp in Boston, USA, to Canada for their first match against Panama on Wednesday as his visa application has been refused by the Canadian government," said FIFA in a statement to Reuters.



Kylian Mbappe has been under the scanner recently. REUTERS

Criticism of Mbappe is very unfair: Dembele

FRANCE FORWARD Ousmane Dembele has defended captain Kylian Mbappe, saying criticism of the Real Madrid striker has become excessive as the national team prepare for the World Cup. Dembele, who has emerged as a key figure for France at the tournament and is a contender for this year's Ballon d'Or after helping Paris St Germain win the Champions League. "The criticism towards him is very, very unfair," Dembele said before France start their World Cup campaign against Senegal on Tuesday. REUTERS

Azteca roars World Cup to life



Raul Jimenez scored the second goal of the game as Mexican fans filled the legendary Azteca Stadium for the first game of the 2026 FIFA World Cup. AP



Sandip G
Mexico City, June 12

SOMETIME PAST noon in the bowels of Azteca, football took over the tournament, liberating the World Cup from the cynicism, disillusionment and anger that had stormed it in the build-up. By the time the game ended, Mexico shredding a tepid South Africa, the tiers dripping in sweat, tears of joy and beer, the sport had salvaged its centrality. The quality of the game was marginally modest, three red cards were brandished, a slew of fouls and discordant passes jarred, the game stuttering and stopping like a singer whose voice kept giving out, defences of both sides dotted with gaping cracks. But it would be remembered as a spectacle for the sheer atmosphere that Azteca whipped — an afternoon born just to enjoy, to take home as a lifetime's memory, and not one to be preserved for its football. The hosts dominating the game from the first touch lent a raw, wild energy to proceedings. It took only five minutes for

Mexico beat South Africa 2-0 in a raucous opener at the Azteca, as the World Cup finally belonged to the game and not the noise around it

Raul Jimenez to register his country's first shot on goal. It took simply four more minutes for Julian Quinones to ignite boundless delirium in the stands. It was that easy against a side petrified by the ambience. The goal was an inevitability after South Africa's error-strewn start. Ponderous passing was the likeliest culprit and so it unfolded. Perhaps the confusion's origin was the five men at the back, an unusual formation for the visitors and one that takes getting used to, irrespective of hours in training. The idea perhaps was to match Mexico's three forwards and the searing full backs when attacking. But it only bred disharmony, men caught in a friction of function. Mexico had vast expanses to rove in the midfield, enough to organise an impromptu mariachi concerto like those that played out outside the stadium in the morning.

Green Wave
Mexico's green wave buzzed and South Africa's pack of yellow wilted. Mistakes lurked. Goalkeeper Ronwen Williams and Sphephelo Sithole's thoughts were in as different postcodes as Cape Town and

Mexico City. Williams's pass stunned Sithole — not the last time that it would — which manifested in a clumsy first touch. Erik Lira sprung on with an enthusiastic, if risky tackle, and broke into teammate Julian Quinones's path. He rifled a shot through the goalkeeper's legs and the cavernous stadium roared like an ocean. A capello unfurled; the crowd flung the cardboard sombreros as far as they could. Some swirled and nestled in the nets behind Mexico's goal-

The hosts dominating the game from the first touch lent a raw, wild energy to proceedings.

post. Plastic cups of beer were hurled from up the tiers. Quinones sank on his knees and prayed. Of Colombian descent, he switched nationality a few years ago and has been on fire this season — 33 goals for Al-Qadsiah in the Saudi League, finishing ahead of both Ivan Toney and Cristiano Ron-

aldo in the Golden Boot race. He has a dancer's feet and sniper's eyes, and could have at least doubled his tally. He designed a gorgeous pass, his back to the goal and holding the defender off with his body, to Erik Gutierrez. He side-footed the ball to the bottom of the near post. The half-time whistle wouldn't have come faster for South Africa. But five minutes upon resumption, they went a man down — the most usual suspect Sithole, whose heel caught the shin of Gutierrez just outside the box. South Africa's comeback hopes lay in tatters, like the drone of their vuvuzelas submerged in the screech of a lakh vocal chords. Shortly, they shipped in a second goal from the head of Raul Jimenez. Jimenez headed the second. He has been to places that make scoring at a home World Cup mean something different. He cried. Worse, they lost a second man — Themba Zwane for violent conduct, a perceived slap on Roberto Alvarado's face, or was it accidental? Whatever it was, South Africa just wanted the game to end. Perhaps the Azteca devoured them — it was so raucous that Mexico's manager Javier Aguirre admitted that his own players felt "a bit of stage fright." South Africans might have read and heard about the Azteca and its blistering antagonism. No matter how prepared they had come, they withered aimlessly under the midday sun. Passes went askance; tackles went haywire. They had no time to breathe or soak the game. The heat and altitude are oppressive but it's the fans that make the arena truly hostile. The cheering is relentless, the barracking ruthless. The South Africans might not understand a single word of Spanish — but not the screaming resentment. The citadel swayed as though it were alive. But for César Montes's sending off in the dying minutes, Mexico enjoyed a near-perfect day. Aguirre would say: "Things got a little complicated but we relaxed and we did start with a win. Can we make it better? Of course."

The day was long enough for the Mexicans; the night of celebration longer. But as significantly, it was an afternoon football took over the tournament. And it owes a debt to the wondrous Azteca crowd. him. And finally he realised the dream he first dreamt in his childhood, living in a quarter not far from the Azteca. He is from Tepeji del Rio, a small village of 5,000. But his father was transferred to Mexico City, where Jimenez spent his early years. As big a contribution as the goal was his role. He was the deputised central striker, but he frequently dropped deep so that he pulled defenders into him, carving room for Alvarado and Quinones. Jimenez would then skin past the defenders, using his build and dexterous feet to devastating effect. He is 34, has lost yards of zip that made Wolverhampton Wolves a force in

the EPL once, but not the sniff of a goal, the instinct to anticipate a move and be at the receiving end and delivering the end product. Or the work rate, pressing hard and putting pressure on his markers. He is not only Mexico's talisman, but also the most loved teammate. His assist-provider Alvarado would say: "At half-time, he had told me to send in a cross for him. I didn't think twice, and I knew that in that area it could be dangerous. Thank God I got the assist and Raul was able to score." And as the banner read, when Jimenez play, he is the hero.

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Three red cards at the opener — the referee England called a cheat

Sriram Veera
Mumbai, June 12

SOMEONE, IN England, in the winter of 2022, sat down and rewrote Wilton Sampaio's Wikipedia page. The entry was changed to describe him as "a Brazilian cheat" who had "lost his guide dog." A note was added: Please return dog if found, the dog has a match to ref. It was taken down within hours. The joke lasted a news cycle. The name stuck. Last night at the Azteca — 80,000 people, the whole world watching, Shakira having just left the stage — Wilton Pereira Sampaio walked out of the tunnel for his third World Cup as a referee. By the time he walked back in, he had handed out three red cards, a World Cup opening match record, and had done something no referee had ever done at a World Cup: raised a microphone, for the first time, to explain a decision live. Players and commentators scratched their heads. Nobody was quite sure what he had said. The moment went viral before the match was over. He is 44 years old, from Teresina de Goias, a small municipality in the northwest of Goias state that most Brazilians would struggle to place on a map. He began refereeing at 15.

Best referee
In 2012, he was voted the best referee in the Campeonato Brasileiro Série A — the highest recognition in Brazilian domestic football. It is the kind of distinction that tends to disappear from the conversation once a crowd has decided what it thinks of you. His brother Sávio is also a FIFA referee. Two brothers from a town nobody had heard of, both at the highest level. In 2018 in Russia, Sampaio was in the VAR bunker when the technology was introduced at a World Cup for the first time. He watched from screens as football rewrote its own laws, every decision now reversible, the game suddenly suspicious of itself. Four years later he was on the pitch in Qatar, refereeing four matches including a quarter-final. That quarter-final was England against France. England lost 2-1. What



Wilton Sampaio brandished three red cards in the opener. AP

● THE TEAM THAT CAME FROM EVERYWHERE

Haiti's return to WC: A war escape, a ghost coach and 52 years of waiting

Sriram Veera
Mumbai, June 12

DUCKENS NAZON was already strapped into his seat on the tarmac at Tehran airport when his phone lit up. A friend playing in Israel. The war alarm was ringing. "I said, wow, I'm so lucky because I'm on the plane right now, ready to take off," Nazon, Haiti's all-time leading scorer, recalled to Reuters. Ten seconds later, his luck ran out. "The cabin chief said, 'Everybody has to get off the plane. The war has started.' The sky is closed," Nazon recalled. "And now you start survival mode." He watched a strike land 100 metres away before eventually finding a route out of Iran and into France, where he needed a visa for the World Cup. He made it. Haiti's record

scorer — born in a Paris suburb, playing for a Tehran club, escaping a war — made it to a World Cup his country hadn't attended in 52 years. It is, in miniature, the story of the whole squad. On the night Haiti qualified, their players were not in Haiti. They were in Curacao — a Dutch island off the coast of Venezuela, 500 miles from home — because armed gangs control most of Port-au-Prince and the national stadium sits unusable. They had beaten Nicaragua 2-0. Now they needed Costa Rica to not beat Honduras. Someone found a phone. The squad gathered around it. When the result came through, coach Sébastien Migne described the scene: "Everything exploded, with people running in all directions." In Haiti, fans erupted and took over the streets. In Little Haiti, Miami,

watch parties spilled into the night. Migne himself was not in Curacao. He has never set foot in Haiti. "It's impossible because it's too dangerous," the Frenchman told France Football. "I usually live in the countries where I work, but I can't here. There are no more international flights landing there." He managed the whole operation remotely — phone calls, video calls, federation officials feeding him intelligence on local players — and "took up his pilgrim's staff to convince dual nationals to join the adventure." He coached a country he had never seen. "The Haitian people are waiting for a sign. And we're going to show them that we're here," Migne said. The last time Haiti were here, they had a moment the country still carries. June 15, 1974, West



Haiti qualified after defeating Nicaragua 2-0. REUTERS

Germany. Italy had not conceded in 1,142 minutes of international football. Goalkeeper Dino Zoff was considered impregnable. Then Emmanuel Sanon — 20 years old, born in Port-au-Prince — took a pass from Philippe Vorbe, dribbled past a defender and powered the ball into the net.

Haiti lost that game 1-3, lost all three in the group, and went home. Sanon went on to play in Belgium and Florida, managed the national team, died in Orlando in 2008 and was given a state funeral in Haiti. A mural in Port-au-Prince's Bel Air neighbourhood depicts him alongside Che Guevara, Fidel Castro and

Dessalines. The goal was 52 years ago. It is still the first thing any Haitian mentions when you say the word football. This squad is almost entirely built of people who left. Of the 26 in Migne's squad, only Woodensky Pierre plays his football at home, for Violette AC in Port-au-Prince. The rest are scattered across Europe, Iran, US. Nazon's journey is the most extreme version of it. Born to Haitian parents, he grew up speaking Creole at home, eating Joumou soup on New Year's Day, hearing family stories about a country he first visited as a child. What struck him then, he has said, was not the poverty but the kindness of the people. He chose Haiti. Jean-Ricner Bellegarde, the Wolves midfielder, said the same thing differently: "I feel like I'm representing my family."

Frantzdy Pierrot was born in Cap Haïtien, grew up in Melrose, Massachusetts, and will have a homecoming playing back on American soil. On May 26 this year, the governor of Massachusetts declared Frantzdy Pierrot Day in the state. A country that has pushed its people outward for decades is watching them come back, wearing its colours, on the world's biggest stage. They face Brazil, Morocco and Scotland in Group C. Scotland, on June 14 in Foxborough, is the match that matters — the one game where a win is genuinely imaginable. Nazon will lead the line, chasing his 50th goal for the country. Before the Costa Rica qualifier, he was asked what this means. "We can change many things in our country," he said. "People need it."

{ SIDELINES }



Fans cheer after Scotland forward Lawrence Shankland scored a goal during their friendly against Bolivia. AP

Scottish fans arrive in Boston, run out of beer on flight

SCOTLAND ARE returning to the FIFA World Cup after a gap of 28 years, and their fans are already making heads turn in Boston. The Kilt-clad Scottish fans landed at the Boston International Airport ahead of their match against Haiti on Saturday proudly revealing they “ran out of beer” on the seven-hour flight journey across the Atlantic. “Been drinking since one o’clock in the morning when I got up,” said Scottish fan David Wood as he arrived on US soil. “We ran out of beer.” And once the beer was emptied, the Scottish fans revealed they first turned to wine and then to whisky on the flight. “We had a round of applause when we landed,” Wood added. “I don’t know if you do that here. That’s a

very Scottish thing. I’m going to find Cheers. That’s what I want do. I want to find Cheers, he told CBS, holding up a bottle of whiskey.” Having landed in the early hours of Thursday, even the locals in Boston got a hang of Scottish when they landed at their *Air BnB* stays in a celebratory mood. In videos that are going viral, some of the fans got into the party mood early in the morning, waking up the hosts and the locals by playing the bagpipes while dressed in kilts. Called as Tartan Army, some of the Scots weren’t prepared for the heat upon landing in Boston. “It was quite humid when I stepped off the plane. I don’t do well in the heat,” said Adam Cook. ENS



Peru police dress up as mascots to nab drug dealer

POLICE IN Peru dressed up as World Cup mascots — Maple, Zayu and Clutch — to fool a alleged drug dealer and arrest him on Thursday. According to a short video shared by AFP, one of the officers is seen telling, “Thanks to the intelligence work carried out by the team, we were able to establish that the person we are about to arrest was a die-hard football fan, living and breathing World Cup fever. So we proceeded to disguise my green squad personnel as World Cup mascots to approach him without arousing any suspicion at the market area.” In the visuals, the mascots are seen chasing the alleged drug dealer before they nab him on top of a building. ENS

Golf & parenting tips: Haaland’s preparation

NORWEGIAN STRIKER Erling Haaland has been keeping himself busy ahead of his side’s opening World Cup game against Iraq by playing golf and video games, and even helping to prepare teammate Leo Ostigard for fatherhood as the defender’s first child is due any day now. Asked on the Norwegian team’s World Cup YouTube channel *Spillerhotellet* (The Players’ Hotel) if he had any tips he could offer his team-mate, Haaland laughed. “Well, first of all, I would have said to be present during the birth, that’s the first tip I would give him!” the striker said. “It will be a new daily routine for him, a tough time but it’s a lovely time as well.” The Norwegians have been preparing for their Group I clashes with Iraq, Senegal and France at their base in Greensboro, North Carolina, and Haaland has been helping Ostigard get into golf during their downtime. “There’s been a lot of golf, I’m a beginner there and Erling is pretty good, so it’s been nice to play a bit of golf,” Ostigard said. REUTERS

WORLD CUP’S FIRST HEAVYWEIGHT CLASH

Ancelotti’s Brazil chase glory beneath weight of history and expectations



Brazil coach Carlo Ancelotti looks typically at ease during a training session with his players ahead of their opener. REUTERS

24-year Cup drought has turned Brazil’s fans fatalists, reading into dots of destiny and accidents of fate

Sandip G
Mexico City, June 12

A BAND of Brazil fans in their canary yellow shirts, their names printed on the back, were wading through a stream of Mexicans, before the World Cup’s opening game at the Azteca on Thursday. Their transit in Mexico City from Sao Paulo, en route to Brazil’s first game in New Jersey, against Morocco, has a superstitious purpose. “Back home, we visit the church, attend the mass before we set out for something important. Azteca is a shrine for us Brazilians, it’s where we won our greatest World Cup (1970),” says Rafael, in his late 20s, and attending his first World Cup.

The World Cup drought, running 24 years, has turned Brazil’s fans fatalists, increasingly reading into the dots of destiny and accident of fate. Their previous 24-year wait also ended on American soil. In 1970, they played with a front four; Heading into the 2026 edition, Carlo Ancelotti has resorted to the same tactic to bring glory back to football’s spiritual home. He has resurrected belief and inspired faith, brought calm into a dressing room prone to volatility, but Brazil don’t arrive in New Jersey as tournament favourites. Rafael disagrees: “Whenever there is a World Cup, we are the first favourite.

We are the greatest footballing nation.”

History supports him, reality doesn’t. Since the last time they held the World Cup aloft, they have reached the semi-final once, and it’s a match the whole of Brazil believe never existed (the 7-1 thrashing at the hands of Germany in 2014). They have lagged behind European teams in organisation and structure; they have frozen in clutch moments under the burden of expectation; they have faced acute shortages in departments that were once superfluous with riches. “Where have all the full-backs gone?” fumed Roberto Carlos, he of thunderous free-kicks and a stellar left-back, in Rai Television. It is customary to blame the lure of European

The passionate fans and the unmatched pedigree have hung around the players’ necks.

Ancelotti had to find full-backs from Moscow, Riyadh and other domestic leagues. The most accomplished one, AS Roma’s Wesley, pulled a muscle during the 2-1 scrape over Egypt in a friendly and was ruled out. He replaced him with midfielder Ederson. He could be forced to repurpose a centre-back into the full-back—Ancelotti is a master at

convincing his men to play out of position and coaxing success—but the move could dishevel the team’s balance. But Carlos’s criticism didn’t stop here: “Has there been a good No 9 since Ronaldo? We are losing our tradition, our essence and beauty.”

But the 1994 band of Carlos Alberto Parreira did not enthrall the purists and was on the pragmatic side; the 2002 batch was not a radically attacking one either. Parreira had a sturdy backline and an exemplary front-two in Bebeto and Romario; in 2002, the trio of Ronaldo, Ronaldinho and Rivaldo sizzled, but they didn’t blow adversaries away, but relied on bursts of individual magic and madness and robust defensive midfielders.

Feared Four

Ancelotti’s brigade has individuals who could define games. The front-four of Vinicius Junior, Raphinha, Matheus Cunha and Gabriel Martinelli, when in sync, is a throw-back firm that can skin defences in different ways. They can interchange, create, score and press relentlessly. Neymar, when fully fit,

can sprinkle the magic dust from the bench. Brazil’s attacking riches are so deep that they could afford injuries to Rodrygo, Endrick and Estêvão and still exude menace. It prompted Ancelotti to adopt the front-four system. “Considering the players we have at

our disposal we believe the best model of play for us is to go with four up front,” Ancelotti said.

The formation has legends like Ronaldo excited; and the army of supporters descending in the United States has brightened up goalkeeper Allison Becker.

“We have the best fans in the world,” he said, after thousands flocked to the team’s training base in New Jersey’s Morris Township. New York has an estimated 70,000 Brazilians, many clustered around Midtown Manhattan; it has a Pele store and a house that he sold just before his death. Boston and Miami each have about 65,000 people of Brazilian descent; Miami has around 65,000. Their group-stage games are suitably located—the opener in New Jersey, the second in Philadelphia, 90 minutes from New York, and Miami. “We will turn every city yellow,” Rafael says.

But the passionate fans, the unmatched pedigree and the narrative of Brazil as the ultimate proponents of beautiful football, an elusive concept in itself, has hung on their neck like unbearable millstones, bred an incurable fear of failure. Ancelotti’s arrival, from a different culture, was timely, in that he lends an outsider’s perspective. But even he would have realised the burden of being a Brazilian footballer going into the World Cup. Another disaster—which equates to not winning the World Cup—would condemn a grand footballing culture into a full-blown crisis. Their fans have already turned fatalists.

How border with Spain shapes Moroccan team

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, June 12

SPAIN AND Morocco are literal neighbours. Their football is enmeshed — six Spain-born players will turn out for Morocco at the World Cup.

Spain is the only European country whose autonomous regions sit on the African continent — the Spanish enclaves of Melilla and Ceuta being Morocco’s land neighbours. The narrow Strait of Gibraltar in the Mediterranean is anyway less than a 15-km boat-ride away, but if one stood atop Mount Tighin, the tallest peak of northern Morocco’s Rif range, in Al Hoceima city, one might see Spain on the horizon on a clear day.

Like a beautiful vista beckoning from not too far, the Spanish dream has seen many Moroccans cross over, with second generations playing football in the Spanish system.

For those like Brahim Diaz, Morocco’s lynchpin at the 2026 World Cup, it was a nudge from history and a push from geography that saw the influential Malaga-born forward returning to play for Morocco in 2023.

When Morocco broke Spain’s 15-match unbeaten streak record in 2025, the Real Madrid midfielder had been their top scorer, finding the net in every match till the semis of the African Cup of Nations. Then he botched a panenka penalty in the final against Senegal.

His origin story has a panenka backspin too, from Morocco to Spain, and back to Morocco. At least a dozen top footballers playing in Europe are of the same Rifian descent—like his father Sufiel Abdelkader, who was born in the Melilla district of Spain. However, Brahim’s mother, Patricia Diaz, came from Malaga on one of Spain’s many southern seacurves facing Morocco.

Melilla, the melting pot, even boasts of about 100 Hindu Sindhis — traders settled from 200 years ago, alongside Jews, Muslims and Christians. But it was its adjacency, a 10.3-km-long fenced land border to the Rif, where Moroccan Berber Arabs live, that made it wild and colourful.

In her 2017 *Qantara* piece on the northeastern Rif mountain people, Susanne Kaiser wrote on the black-market economy around Ceuta-Melilla. She wrote how Rif women set off early when the enclave gates opened, to buy up contraband cigarettes, alcohol and electronics from tax-free resales in the Spanish enclaves, and returned each evening carrying up to 90 kg on their backs. Often, this was the only source of income.

The Rif mountains, a dead end between the Mediterranean to the north, with Algeria to the east and the Atlantic to the west, had been even more notorious - it was the largest exporter of Hashish since 1980s, “even out-doing Afghanistan,” Kaiser writes.

Unemployment and lack of prospects meant fleeing to Europe - Spain was so close - became a perennial Rifian dream. Many Rifians had lived in Melilla for generations, even as the culture altered and it became a Spanish protectorate. Others shifted to Melilla before proceeding to the Spanish mainland. It’s how Brahim Diaz was born in Spain, but in proximity to his Moroccan heritage.

Through lineage, youth academies, development teams, first breaks and loan spells, Diaz’s journey can be traced from Morocco to Melilla to Malaga to Manchester to Madrid to Milan, back to Madrid, then to Morocco. Childhood visits to Nador in the Rif region influenced him enough when he had to choose between Spain’s U21 and Morocco. Now, Morocco is under his spell. He’s learning Arabic, heralded the coming of 5G to Morocco on billboards, and

left fans swooning when he celebrated a goal against Mali with a Rifian dance move from Nador.

Moroccan fans are now emboldened to think their team can even beat Brazil. On a vox populi by *BRFootball*, a fan explains, “They think it’s Pele’s Brazil and Ronaldo Nazario is still playing. Nah. We are the new Brazil. We are not African Brazil. We are the world’s Brazil.”

Morocco is Africa’s Spain, for sure — not a bad moniker either.



Brahim Diaz, expected to be Morocco’s lynchpin this World Cup, was born in Spain. AP

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At least a dozen top footballers playing in Europe are of Rifian-Moroccan descent.

Nicest among equals: Williamson exits stage as one of NZ’s greatest

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 12

WHEN TIME beckoned, he just knew. Unwilling to add “a couple of games” to his tally while not wholly committed, Kane Williamson on Friday brought the curtains down on his 16-year international career, midway through New Zealand’s three-Test England tour.

The 35-year-old cited the talent at the Kiwis’ disposal and the side’s potential trajectory in the days to come as factors that shaped his decision. He described his thoughts in the lead-up via a New Zealand Cricket (NZC) statement. “I take pride in knowing I’ve given it my all in every match I’ve played for New Zealand. Continuing with anything less wouldn’t be right, and I feel fortunate to step away on my own terms.”

Part of a team routinely dubbed as the ‘nice guys of cricket’, Williamson stood out as one of the most universally liked players the game has seen. In fact, he was the only ‘Fab Four’ (a term coined by the late Martin Crowe to refer to Williamson, Steve Smith, Joe Root and Virat Kohli) member who



Kane Williamson retired as New Zealand’s highest run-scorer across formats. REUTERS

had virtually no haters.

The former Black Caps captain retires as their most prolific run-getter in red-ball cricket with 9515 runs from 110 Tests, and across formats (19346 runs from 378 matches). The compact right-hander’s Test average of 54.06 is streets ahead of his compatriots, with Rachin Ravindra the next best (at least 20 innings) at 47.28. His 33 Test hundreds — 13 of them overseas — are also unmatched by a Kiwi, as Ross Taylor’s 19 tons stand second.

Though the timing of his swansong raised eyebrows, Williamson had gradually been get-

ting comfortable with the idea of retirement. The batting titan had not been centrally contracted with his national board for two years, picking and choosing international series while plying his trade in T20 leagues such as the SA20 and the Bangladesh Premier League.

As New Zealand skipper, he was effective and widely admired, leading to the perennial ‘dark horses’ witnessing a fruitful phase from 2016 to 2024. Under Williamson’s leadership, they made two ICC World Cup finals and three semis, apart from pipping India to win the inaugural ICC World Test Championship in 2021.

Tributes expectedly engulfed social media upon the retirement announcement, led by Kohli and Sachin Tendulkar. The ‘Master Blaster’ said Williamson’s balance and timing made his batting “one of the most consistently pleasing sights in world cricket”.

Virat chose to focus on his friendship with the fellow legend. “It’s been a pleasure watching you bat and compete against you over so many years but more than that I value our friendship,” Kohli wrote.

INDIA-AFGHANISTAN ODI SERIES

Rohit’s World Cup quest reaches critical juncture

Lalith Kalidas
Dharamsala, June 12

ROHIT SHARMA is 39. Thirty-nine years and 44 days old when India meet Afghanistan in the first ODI in Dharamsala.

He was also 20, in June 2007, when a quiet international debut slipped by in Belfast. He did not bat or bowl.

On Saturday, the chatter when he walks out to bat could centre on longevity and greatness — he will become the oldest Indian man to feature in the one-day game. It could just as easily drift toward the question of when to stop.

Is he stretching it too far? Can he carry himself through at 40 in the ODI World Cup in South Africa late next year? Has another modest IPL showing decoupled him from Virat Kohli in the veterans’ club?

Kohli’s supreme scoring glut in the recent IPL season has insulated him from any speck of apprehension over India’s ODI No. 3 slot. A hamstring injury suffered in the IPL final has ruled Kohli out of the series, but Rohit cannot move through the upcoming months with the same assurance, despite recovering from a similar



By the time the 2027 World Cup in South Africa rolls around, Rohit Sharma will be 40. His preparations start now. PTI

concern. Yashasvi Jaiswal waits — centurion in his last ODI appearance, now back in the squad only for Kohli’s absence.

Rohit managed 61 runs in the last home series against New Zealand in January — three forced fifts, three soft dismissals in what felt like uncertain territory. Coupled with 283 runs in nine innings in the IPL season, it has only added fuel for the detractors.

Judging the Rohit’s ODI left solely by those returns would be preposterous. His boundary-hitting rhythm remained intact — 21 sixes and as many fours for Mumbai Indians this season. A

factory line of fearless young openers in the IPL has pushed the limits of aggression. Dislodging Rohit in his most sublime format will still take some doing.

The original ‘Hitman’ — world cricket’s leading six-hitter — will still feel the heat when he takes guard against Afghanistan, bolstered by the return of Rashid Khan and their collective white-ball strength. It is not just the challengers for his spot that have thickened. Periodic reminders from the selectors and team management about meritocracy have eroded the comfort that once surrounded a white-ball giant,

even as he builds toward a World Cup under a young captain in Shubman Gill.

His run as the opening disruptor between 2022 and 2025 — smashing 2311 runs at an undisputed 112.84 strike rate — does not guarantee time anymore. Not unless the new regime chooses to sign on it.

And therein lies Rohit’s challenge, to reunite with his past versions that married consistency and colossal hundreds in the format despite the odds of recurrently modest IPL seasons, form or injury clouds. Even the training scenarios have deftly shifted. In Mohali on Wednesday, Rohit’s first session back was more about stillness — time at the crease and sharpening judgement outside off. The flourishing drives and lofted strokes came later, more measured rather than impulse.

Pacers’ floor test

It’s not just the old warhorse who will step out to reiterate his worth. The three ODIs double up as a floor test for a young seam attack in the absence of Jasprit Bumrah and Mohammed Siraj, all vying for the third and fourth pacer’s spots in a full strength squad.

Prasidh Krishna leads the attack — just 23 matches into his career — alongside left-armed Arshdeep Singh, who has picked up 25 wickets in 15 games. While Prasidh has glimpsed an ability to pick wickets in clumps, his 6.02 economy remains notorious.

There will also be intrigue around Prince Yadav, drafted into the ODI and T20I squads after an impressive domestic and IPL season. The Delhi seamer, with his high-arm release and solid wrist extension, has shown the ability to navigate lengths effortlessly.

Far from the T20 lens, Gurnoor Brar’s rise from relative obscurity has reinvigorated the draw of a selection punt. Despite his limited white-ball appearances (18 in six years), his hit-the-deck attributes suit the overseas conditions that India are building toward. Up on speed, Nitish Kumar Reddy’s resourcefulness as the floating seamer-batter will also be put to the test as India prepare for sound clarity around Hardik Pandya this time.

Afghanistan may not stretch India to the hilt. But for Gill, still chasing his first series win as captain, the road to a World Cup rhythm begins here.